# Young Women's Labour-Market Inclusion

Findings and cost of inaction, Ukraine

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2026-11-01

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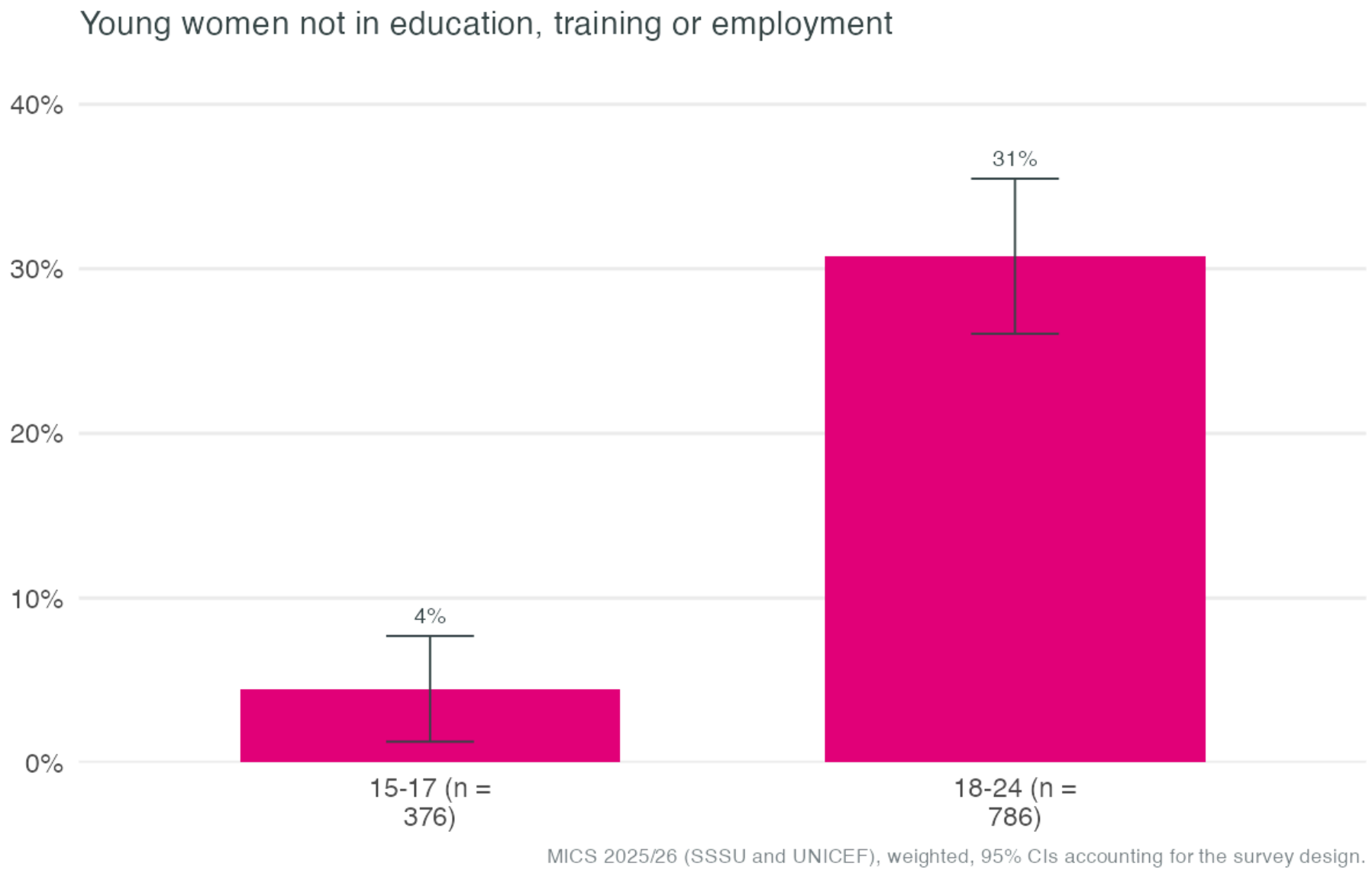
Appendix

# Data sources

- **Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS) 2025/26**, State Statistics Service of Ukraine with UNICEF: 23,708 households, 37,315 household members, 8,213 women aged 15–49 selected for interview, and children 5–17. There is no men's questionnaire. Main source for education, NEET and employment among young women, marriage, motherhood, disability, displacement, wealth and changes in households since the beginning of the conflict.
- **UNICEF Household Social and Economic Status Survey (HSESS)**, December 2023 to February 2024, Institute of Demography and Quality of Life Problems: 18,838 individuals in 8,024 households, all regions covered by the survey (Luhansk oblast is not included). Covers women and men: participation, employment, NEET, job quality, occupations, earnings and childcare.
- **SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021** (anonymised public-use file), collected in 2021: 265.6k interviews from 151.7k persons aged 15+. Shown for reference only.

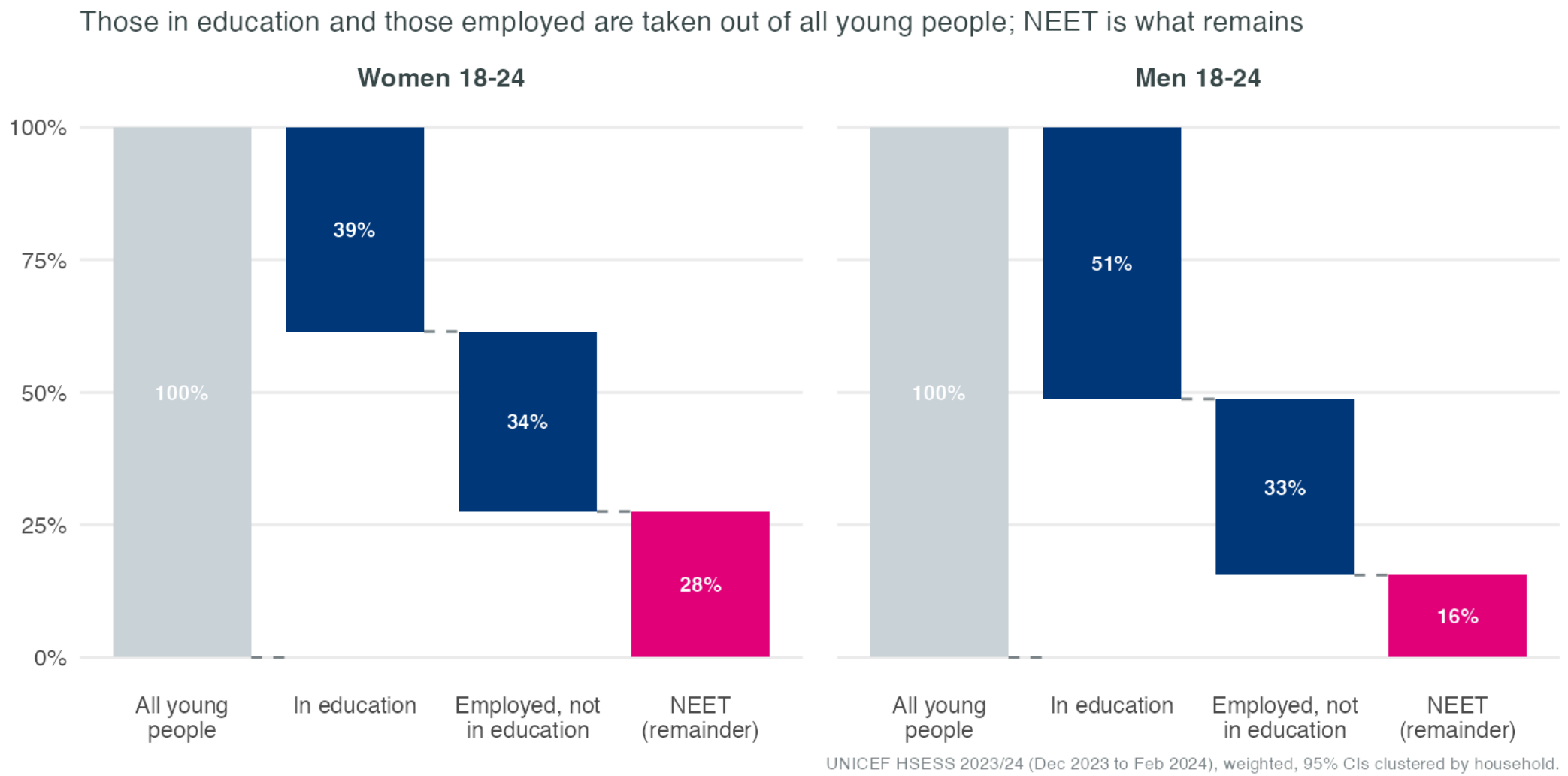
# 1 · The problem

# 31% of women aged 18–24 are NEET



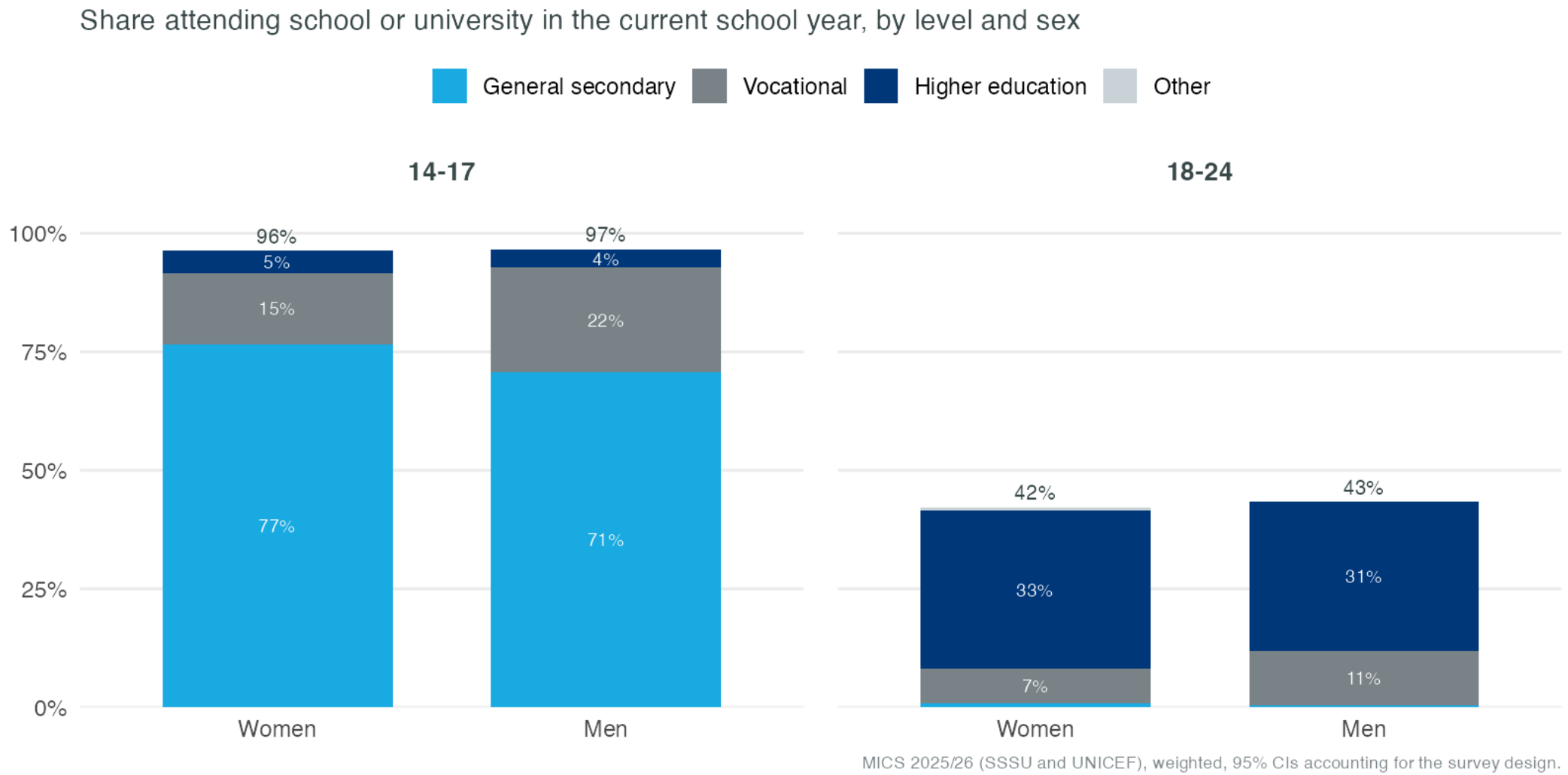

MICS 2025/26. NEET: not in education or training and not employed. At 15–17 the rate is 4%: almost all girls are still in education. The survey asks these questions to women from age 15, so NEET cannot be measured at 14.

# The gap with young men comes from education, not employment




HSESS 2023/24, ages 18–24. NEET: women 28%, men 16%. In education: women 38%, men 51%. Employed and not in education: women 34%, men 33%. NEET is what remains after education and employment.

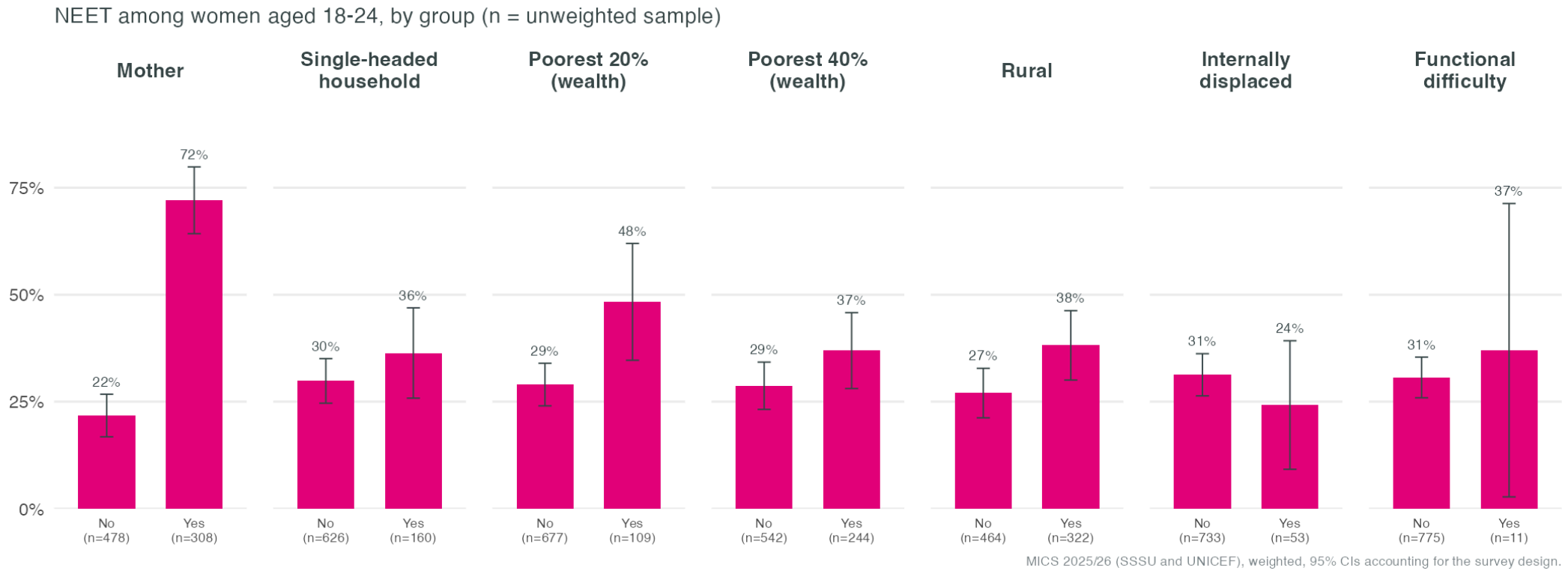
# At 14–17, almost all girls and boys are in school




MICS 2025/26, household members attending in the current school year. Ages 14–17: girls 96%, boys 97%. Ages 18–24: women 42%, men 43%. School attendance is available from age 14; NEET and employment only from age 15. MICS does not show the gap in education at 18–24 that HSESS shows; the surveys differ in date, respondent and definition.

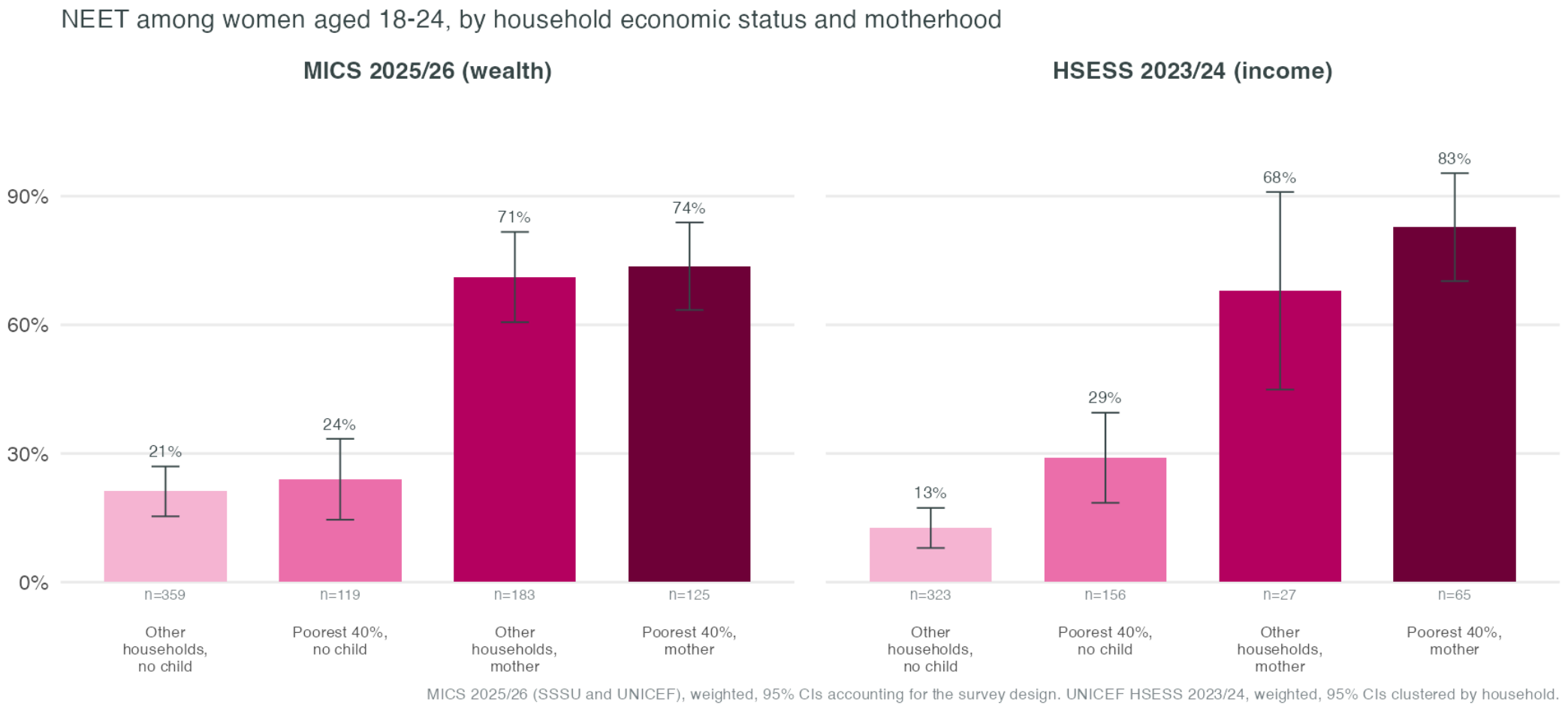
# 2 · Who is most affected

# Mothers and the poorest have the highest NEET rates



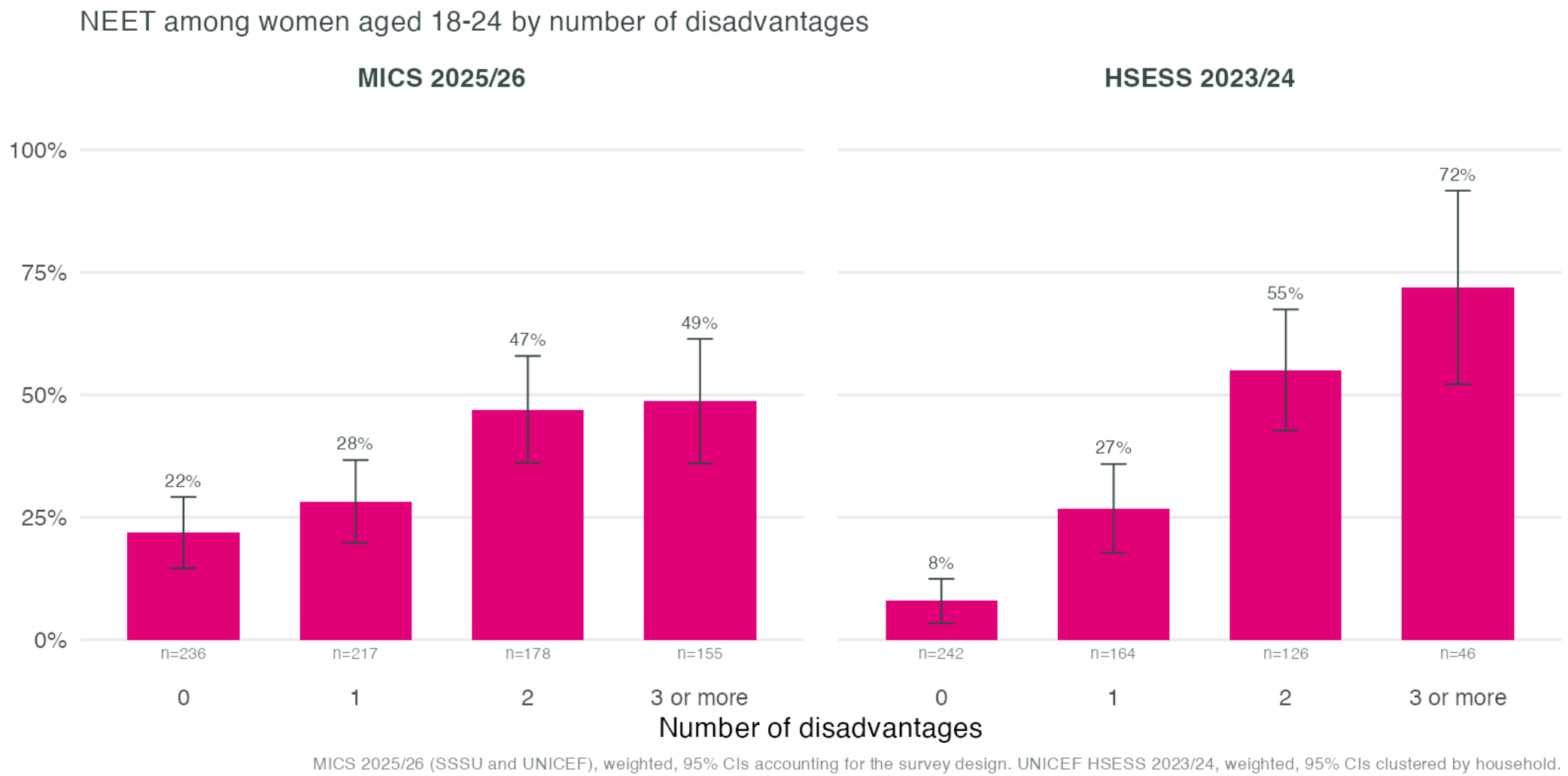

MICS 2025/26, women aged 18–24. Mothers 72% vs 22%; poorest fifth 48% vs 29%; single-headed households 36% vs 30%; internally displaced 24% vs 31%. Bars show 95% confidence intervals and the sample size; small groups should not be ranked.

# Among poor young mothers, NEET reaches 74% to 83%



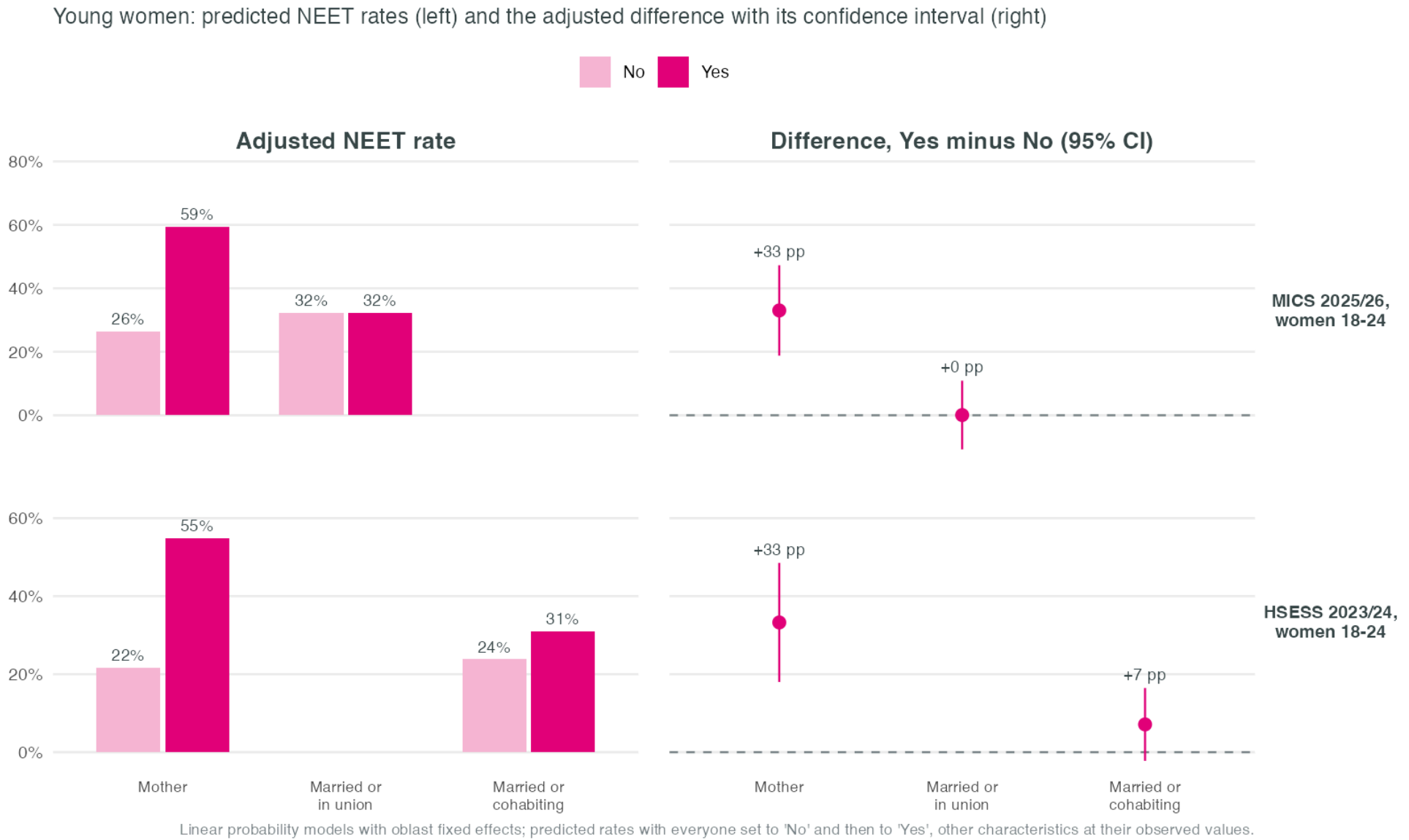

Women aged 18–24. Women with neither characteristic: 21% (MICS) and 13% (HSESS). Poor mothers are 16% of NEET young women in MICS and 30% in HSESS. Poorest 40% by wealth (MICS) or income per household member (HSESS).

# Disadvantages add up



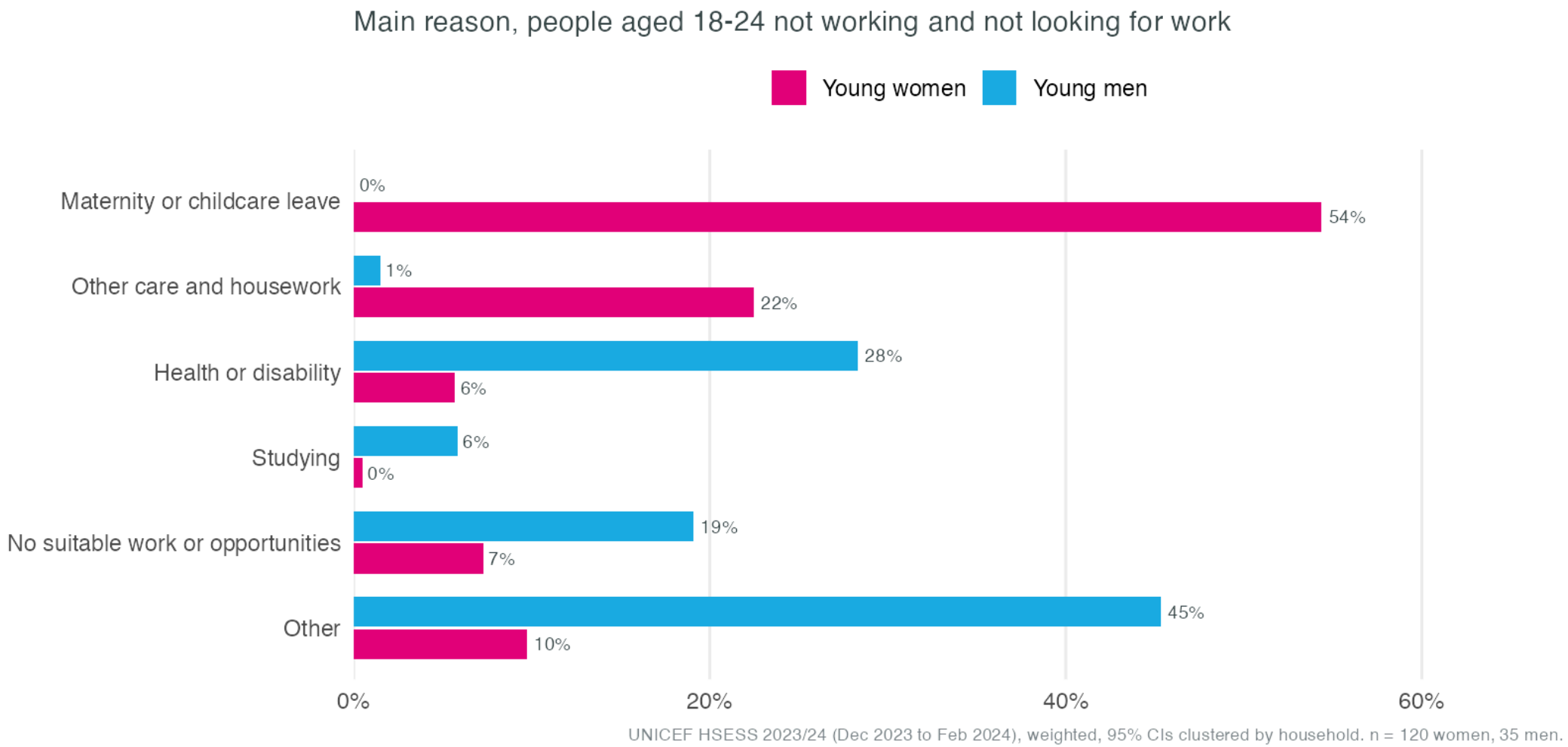

Women aged 18–24. With none of the five disadvantages, NEET is 22% (MICS) and 8% (HSESS); with three or more, 49% and 72%. Disadvantages: motherhood, poorest 40%, rural, displaced, single-headed household.

# Motherhood remains the main factor after adjustment



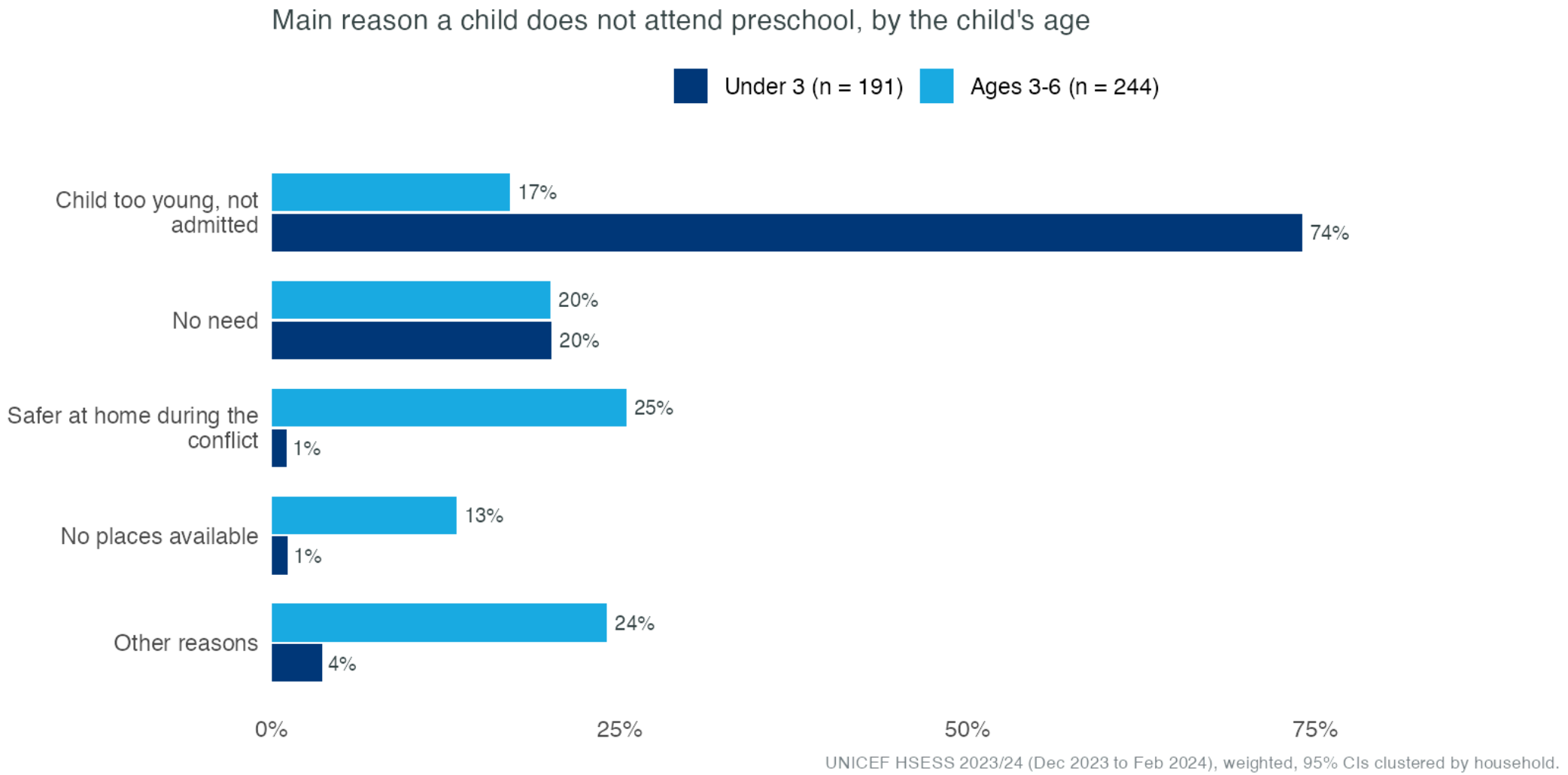

Women aged 18–24, both surveys. Left: predicted NEET rates for mothers and others, and for married women and others, holding age, area, education, income and displacement constant. Right: the difference with its 95% confidence interval. Associations, not causal effects.

# Why young women are not working or looking for work




HSESS 2023/24, people aged 18–24 who were not employed and not looking for work. Maternity or childcare leave is shown separately from other care and housework.

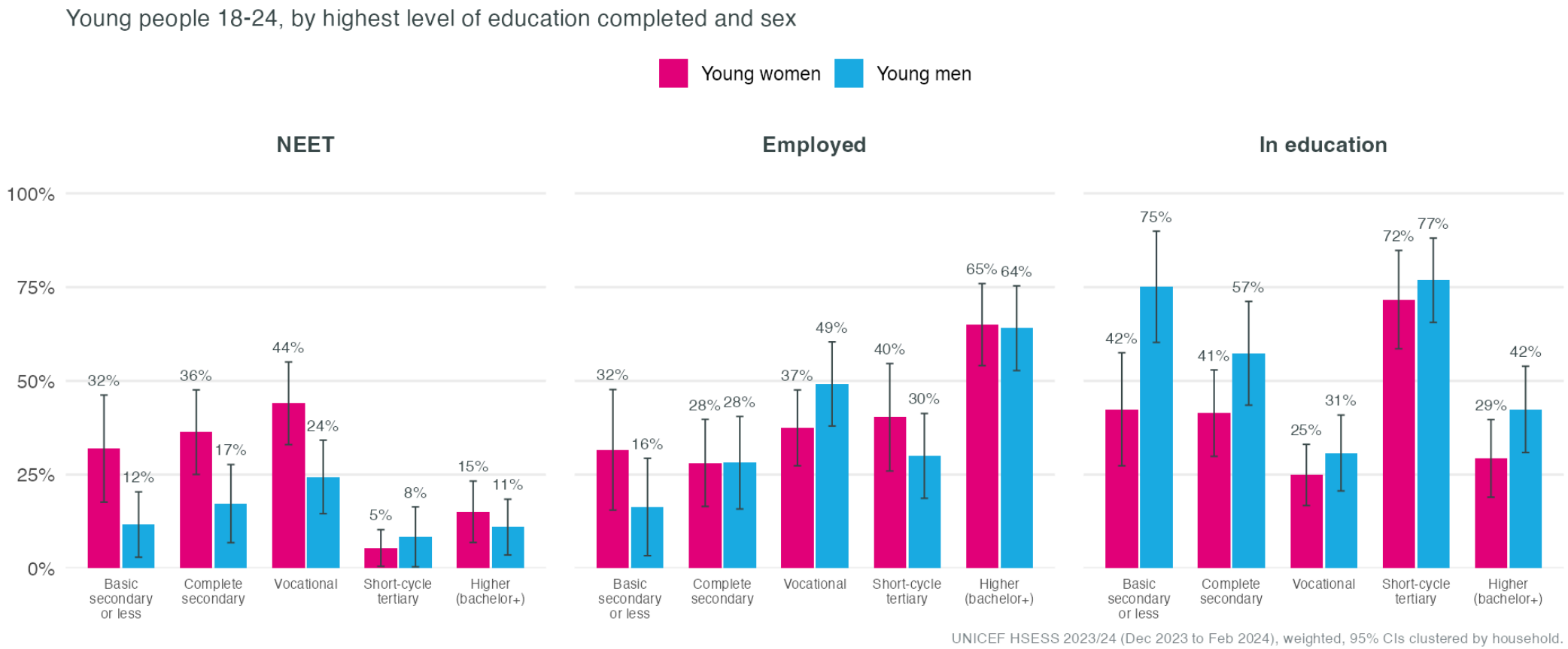
# Childcare barriers differ by the child’s age




HSESS 2023/24: main reason a child does not attend preschool, for children under 3 and aged 3–6. Preschool attendance at ages 3–5 is 60% (MICS 2025/26).

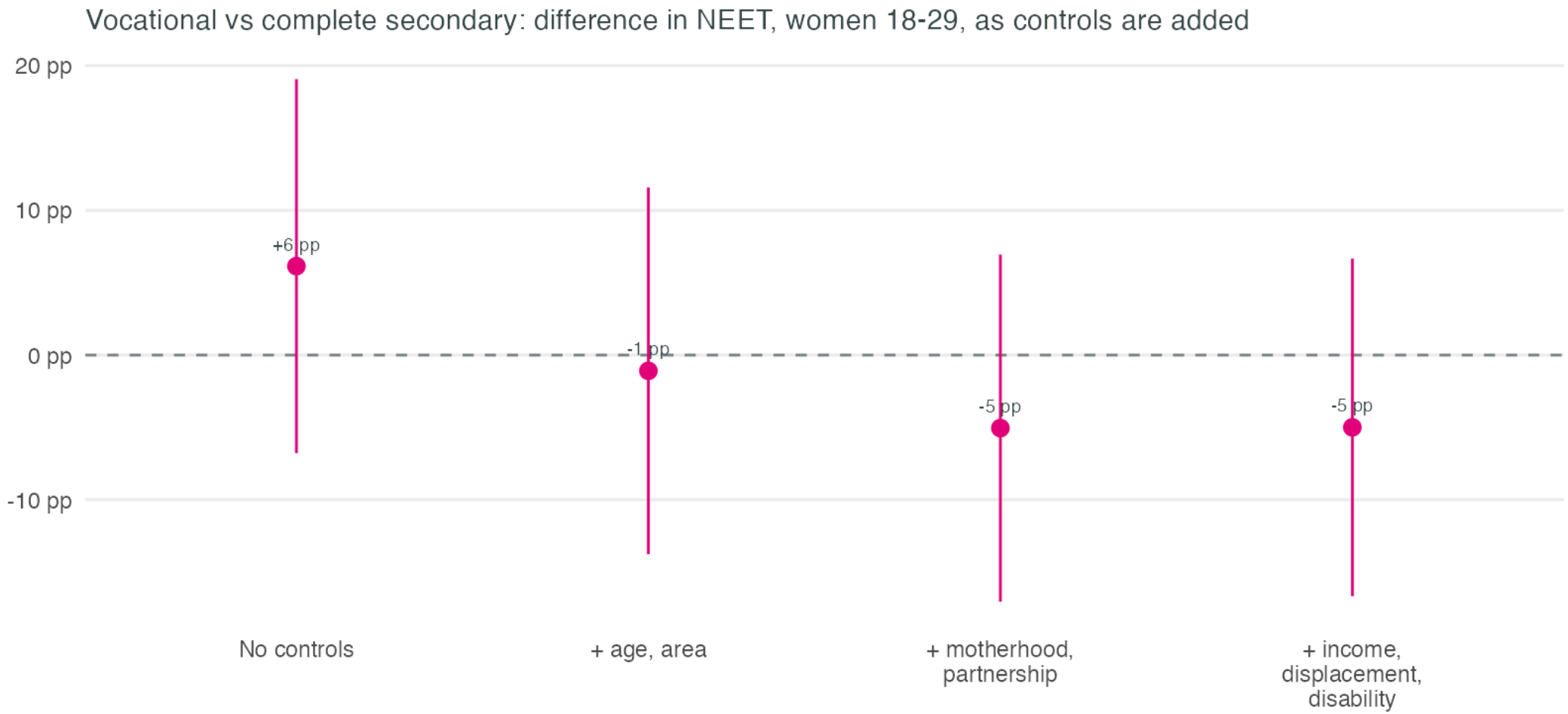
# 3 · From education to earnings

# NEET falls with education



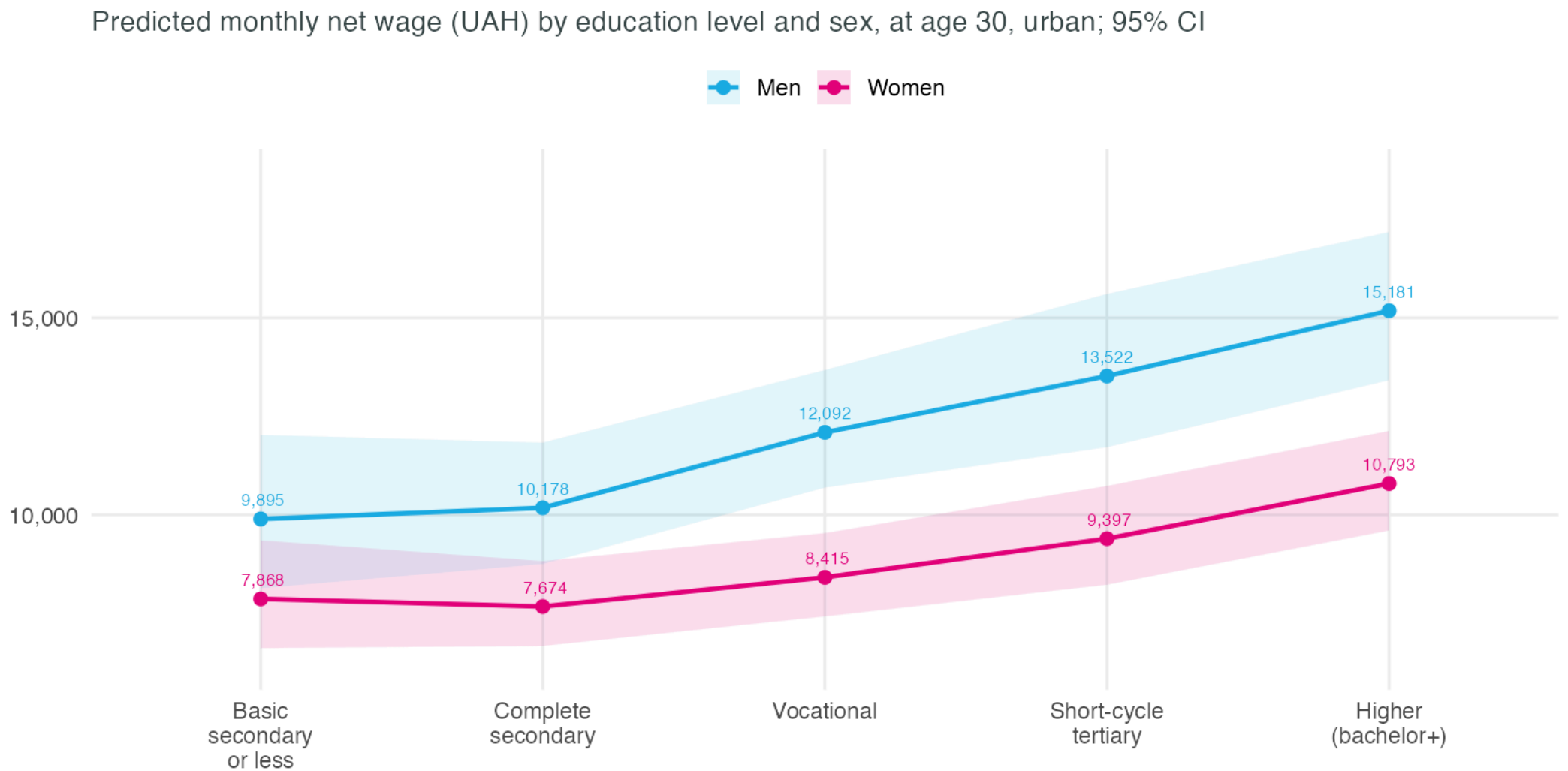

HSESS 2023/24, ages 18–24, by highest level completed. NEET among women: 15% with higher education, 36% with complete secondary. Many 18–24 year olds are still studying, so rates by level should be read together with the share in education.

# No significant NEET gap between vocational and secondary education




HSESS 2023/24, women aged 18–29. Each dot is a regression coefficient: the difference in the NEET rate between women with vocational and with complete secondary education (linear probability model, oblast fixed effects), with its 95% confidence interval, as controls are added. The difference is 6 pp without controls and -5 pp with all controls; no interval excludes zero, so the difference is not statistically significant in any specification. NEET by level: vocational 48%, complete secondary 44%, tertiary 30%.

# Women earn less than men at every level of education




HSESS 2023/24, wage earners aged 19–64. Predicted net monthly wage at age 30 in an urban area. Gap at comparable age and area: 25% with complete secondary, 29% with higher education. Each additional year of education is associated with 5.8% higher wages for women and 7.2% for men. Not adjusted for hours, occupation or sector.

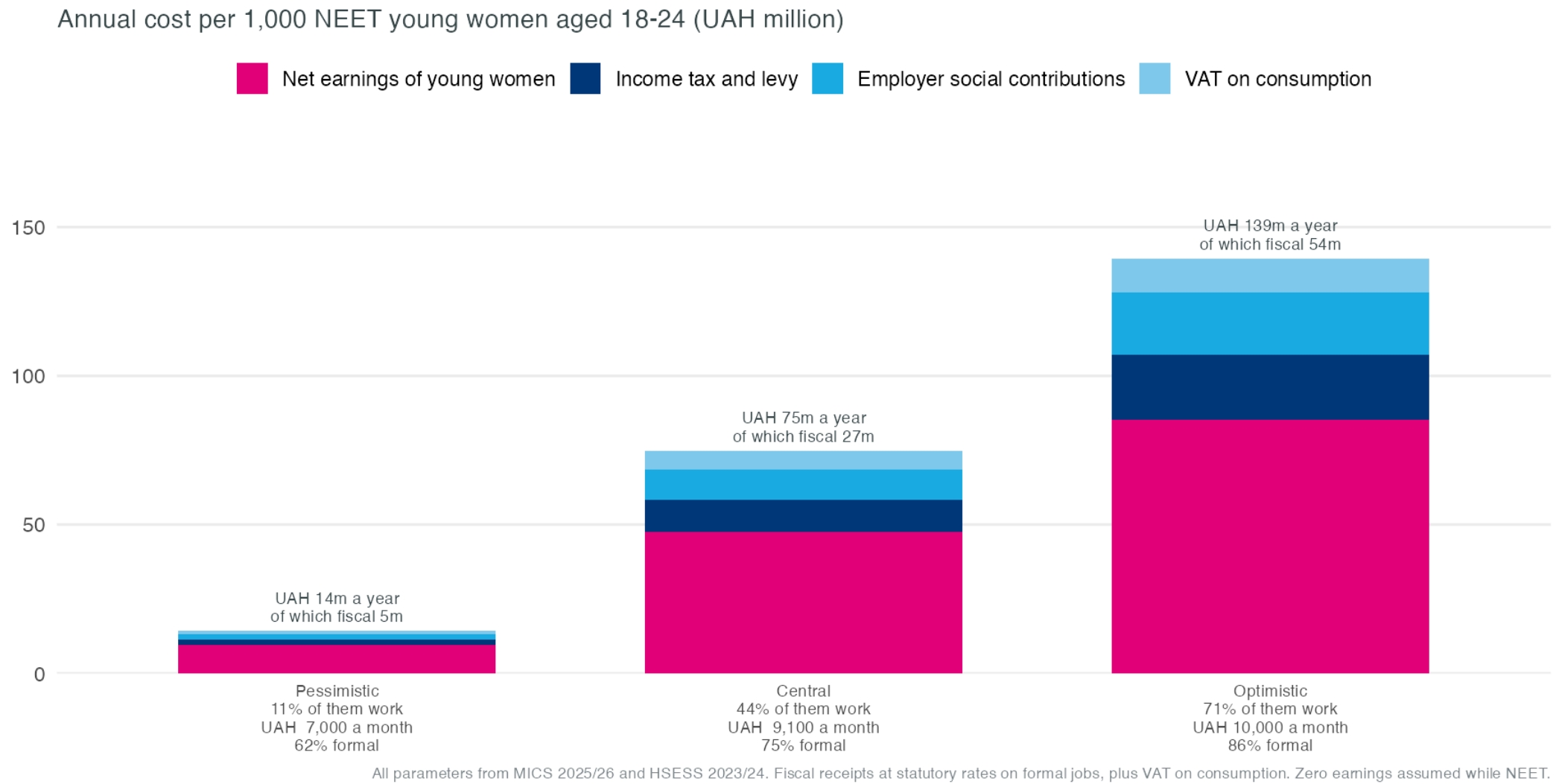
# 4 · The cost of inaction

# How the cost of inaction is calculated

| Step | What is used | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Who** | NEET women aged 18–24: 30.8% of young women | MICS 2025/26 |
| **2. What they could earn** | The wage predicted for each NEET young woman from her education, age and place of residence, using a wage equation estimated on employed women: UAH 9,078 a month on average | HSESS 2023/24 |
| **3. How many could work** | From 11% to 71% of NEET young women: those already looking for work, those needed to close the gap with young men, and those looking for work or kept out by care duties | HSESS 2023/24 |
| **4. How many jobs are formal** | 62% to 86%, the formal share among employed young women by level of education | HSESS 2023/24 |
| **5. Who gains** | Young women (net earnings) and the budget (income tax, military levy, employer social contribution, VAT) | Statutory rates |

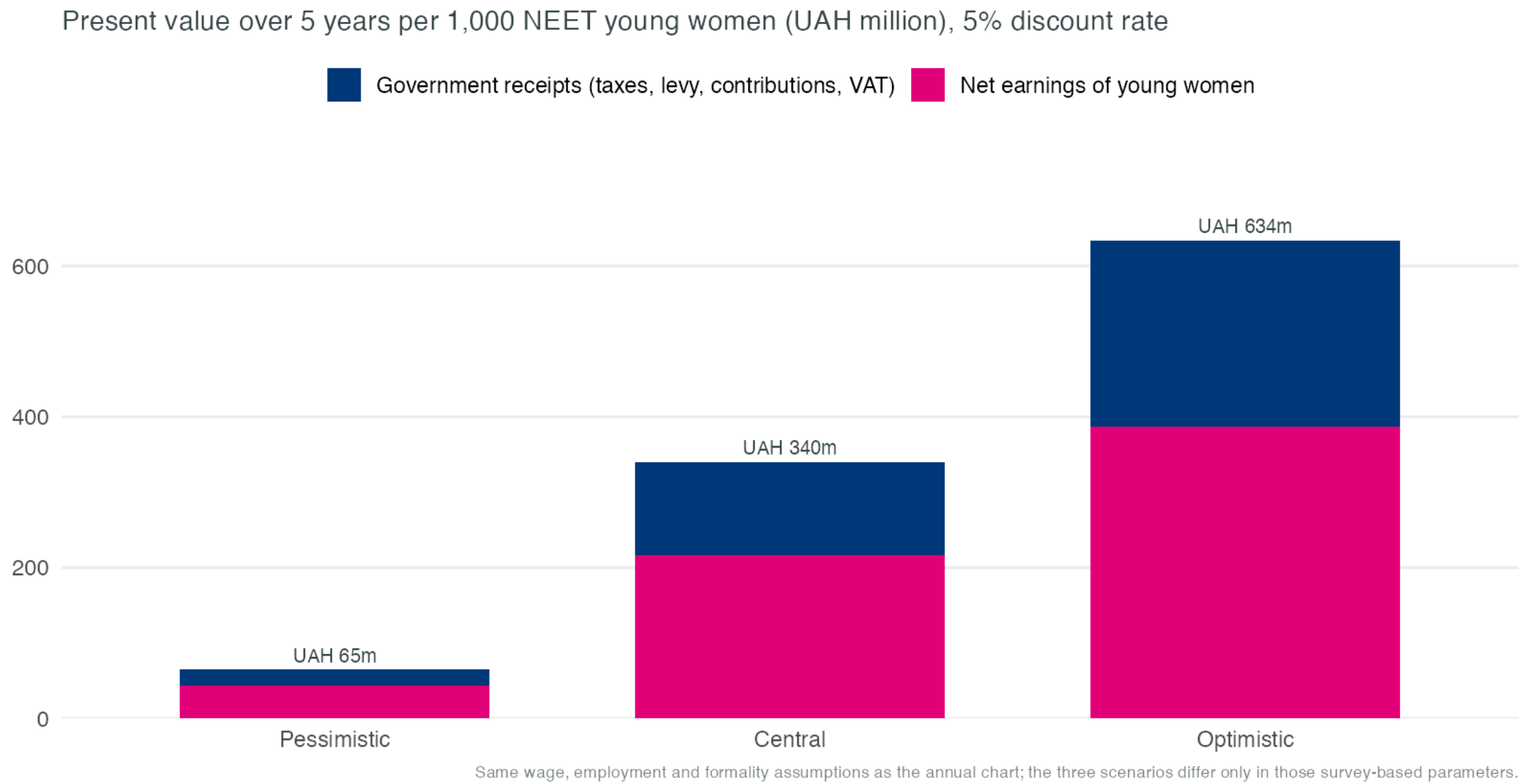
The cost of inaction is what is forgone each year that these young women remain NEET. Results are shown per 1,000 NEET young women, which is a unit of account, not an estimate of how many there are: every 100,000 women aged 18–24 include about 30.8 thousand NEET young women. Full assumptions and the wage equation are at the start of the appendix.

# Each 1,000 NEET young women cost UAH 75 million a year



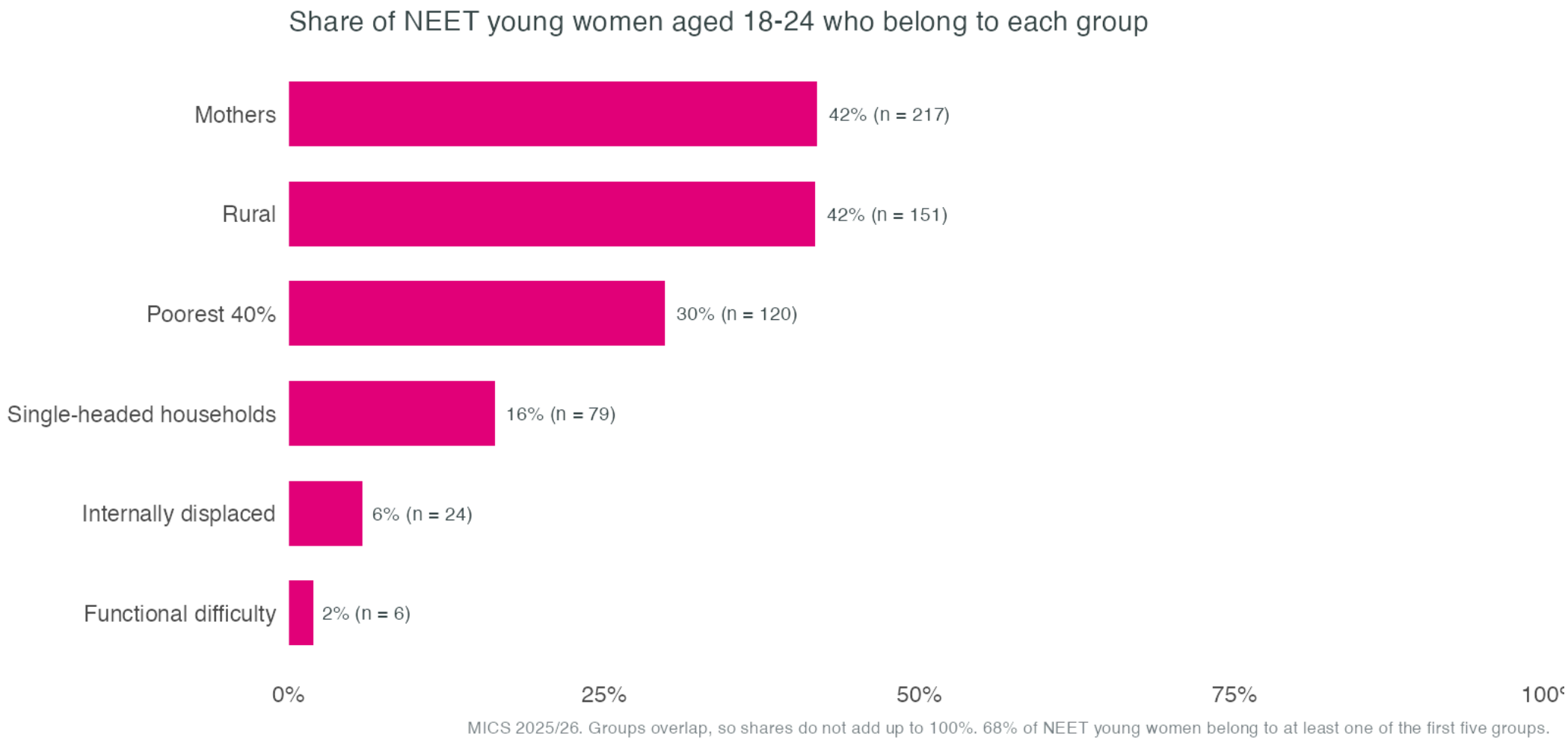

Central scenario, of which UAH 27 million would reach the budget. The pessimistic, central and optimistic scenarios (UAH 14, 75 and 139 million) combine the lowest, middle and highest values found in the surveys for the wage, the share who would work and the share of formal jobs; the labels under each bar show the values used. Per 100,000 women aged 18–24, the central cost is UAH 2.3 billion a year. A national total needs a 2026 count of women aged 18–24.

# Over five years, UAH 65 to 634 million per 1,000




Present value of five years at a 5% discount rate (UAH 340 million in the central scenario); the horizon and discount rate are the same in all three scenarios, which differ only in the survey-based parameters. A woman who remains NEET to age 60 forgoes about UAH 2.0 million in earnings and the budget UAH 1.1 million (present values, central wage).

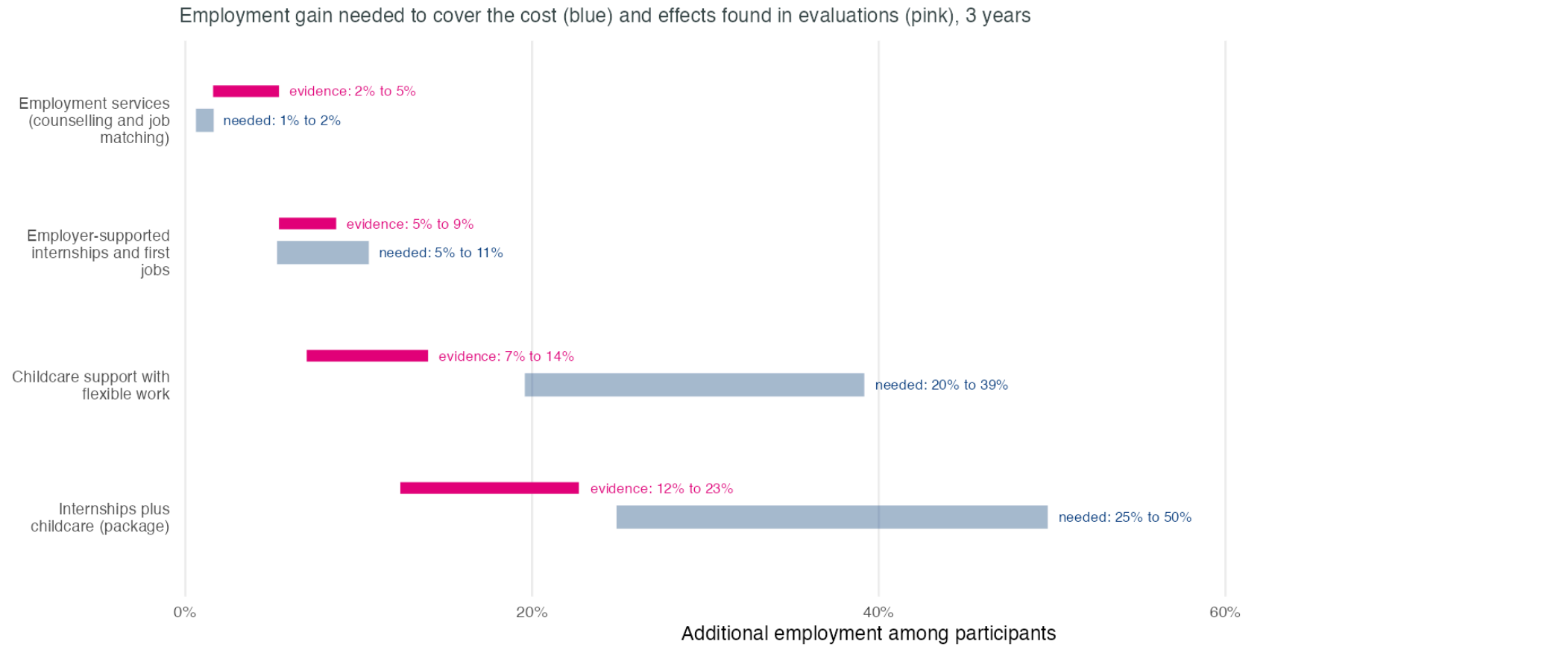
# Mothers are 42% of NEET young women




MICS 2025/26, women aged 18–24. This describes who the NEET young women are: the share of them in each group. Groups overlap, and 68% belong to at least one of the first five, so not every NEET young woman has one of these characteristics. Mothers are the largest identifiable group, so support that works for young mothers addresses the largest part of the cost.

# 5 · Investment options

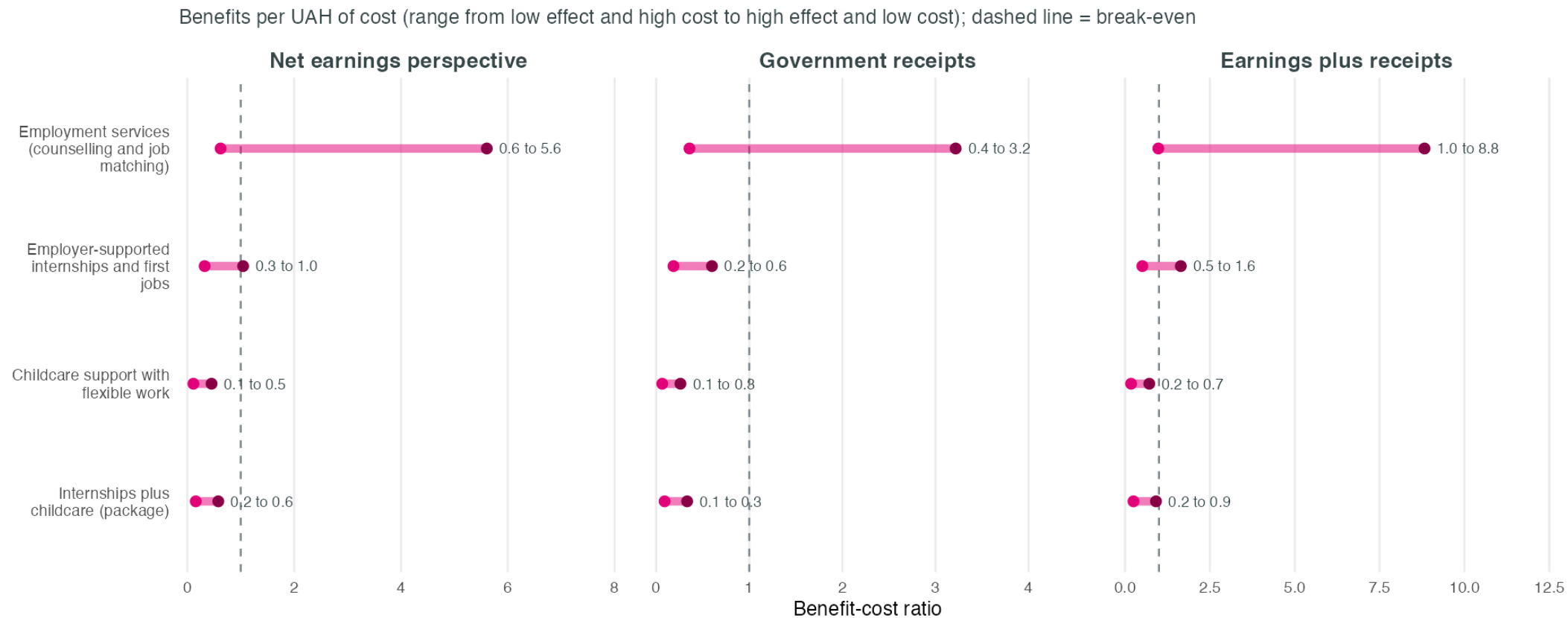
# What employment gain would justify each service?




ernment receipts, central-scenario wage and fiscal rates, 5% discount. Costs from Ukrainian programme amounts; effects from evaluations in other countries (sources in the appendix). Pink to the right of blue: pays off; overlap: depends on cost.

Blue: share of participants who must gain additional employment for three years to cover the cost. Costs use existing Ukrainian amounts: 3 to 6 months of the minimum wage (UAH 8,647) for first-job support and 12 to 24 months of the eYasla payment (UAH 8,000 a month) for childcare; the cost of employment services is an assumption. Pink: employment effects from evaluations in other countries (Card, Kluve and Weber 2018 for employment programmes; Berlinski and Galiani 2007 and Clark et al. 2019 for childcare). None of these evaluations comes from a country in conflict, so the pink ranges are indicative for Ukraine; sources and caveats are in the appendix.

# Illustrative returns by type of service




inian programme amounts where available (see appendix). Effects: evaluations in other countries. Benefits: additional employment sustained for 3 years at the central-scenario wage and fiscal rates, 5% discount. Employer returns not included.

Benefits per UAH of cost, from the least to the most favourable combination of cost and effect, for young women's earnings, government receipts and both. Same costs and evidence as the previous slide. Employment services need the smallest employment gains to pay for themselves and first-job support gains close to those found in evaluations; childcare support at the level of the eYasla payment needs larger or longer-lasting gains to pay for itself through earnings and receipts alone. Benefits to children and employers are not counted.

# 6 · Conclusions and recommendations

# Key messages

**1. The problem is large.** 31% of women aged 18–24 are NEET (MICS 2025/26); in HSESS, 28% of women against 16% of men.

**2. The gap is about education, not employment.** Young women and men work at the same rate (34% and 33%); fewer women stay in education (38% against 51%).

**3. Motherhood is the main factor.** NEET is 72% among young mothers against 22% among other young women, and the difference remains after adjusting for other characteristics.

**4. Poverty compounds it.** Among poor young mothers NEET reaches 74% to 83%; displacement is not associated with higher NEET.

**5. Inaction is costly.** Each 1,000 NEET young women forgo about UAH 75 million a year, of which UAH 27 million would reach the budget.

**6. Services differ widely in cost.** Employment services need small employment gains to pay for themselves; first-job support needs gains close to those found in evaluations; childcare support needs the largest.

# Priority 1: Learning-to-Earning (First Experience, Earning Engine)

| Finding | Recommendation, building on existing mechanisms | Who | What the model indicates |
|---|---|---|---|
| At 18–24, young women and men are employed at the same rate; the NEET gap (28% against 16%) mirrors lower education participation (38% against 51%) | Support young women to stay in education and training, and bridge the exit with first work experience (internships, apprenticeships, first-job support) through the State Employment Service and employers | Ministry of Economy; State Employment Service; employers; education and VET institutions; UNICEF (GenU) | The employment gain first-job support needs to cover its cost is of the same order as the effects found in evaluations; shorter subsidies pay off more easily |
| NEET is lower with tertiary education (30% against 48% vocational and 44% secondary, women 18–29); the vocational gap against secondary disappears once motherhood and area are accounted for | Do not treat vocational education as the cause: focus on the transition after it, especially for young mothers and rural women, and on guidance towards fields with employer demand | Ministry of Education and Science; VET institutions; State Employment Service; employers | Needs vacancy, pay and entry-requirement data by occupation (SES dashboard, SSSU) |
| Women earn less than men at every level of education (median wage gap at 18–24: 29%), although informal work is less common among women (25% against 36%) | Pair first-job pathways with formal contracts and decent-work standards; monitor the pay gap by occupation | Employers; State Labour Service; State Employment Service | Each formal job adds about UAH 62,505 a year to the budget |

# Priority 2: Inclusive Access and Navigation (protection and employment)

| Finding | Recommendation, building on existing mechanisms | Who | What the model indicates |
|---|---|---|---|
| Motherhood is the main factor: NEET is 72% among young mothers against 22%, and mothers are 42% of NEET young women | Build on eYasla (UAH 8,000 a month for parents who return to full-time work): combine it with flexible working arrangements and family-friendly workplace policies, and give young mothers priority in employment services | Ministry of Social Policy, Family and National Unity; local authorities; employers; UNICEF | Childcare support is the most expensive option: it pays for itself through earnings and receipts only if a large share of supported mothers would not have worked otherwise, or if their employment lasts longer than three years |
| Poverty compounds it: NEET is 48% in the poorest fifth against 29%, and 74% to 83% among poor young mothers; it is also higher in single-headed households (39% against 27% in HSESS) | Link social assistance for low-income and single-headed households with employment services (referrals, case management), so that benefits and job support reach the same young women | Ministry of Social Policy; State Employment Service; hromadas | Existing benefit registries can identify most poor young mothers |
| Displacement is not associated with higher NEET (24% against 31%); disability groups are too small to estimate | Keep inclusive outreach through existing services for displaced young women and young women with disabilities, without a separate programme stream | Hromadas; IDP councils; UNICEF and partners | Not estimated; track outcomes as programmes report |

# Appendix

# Cost of inaction: key assumptions

| Element | Assumption | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Population | NEET women aged 18–24: 30.8%. Results per 1,000 NEET young women (a unit of account) and per 100,000 women aged 18–24 | MICS 2025/26; a national total needs a 2026 population count (COI$pop_w1824) |
| Potential earnings | Central: wage predicted for each NEET young woman by the wage equation on the next slide (UAH 9,078 a month on average, n = 161). Bounds: 25th percentile and median wage of employed women aged 18–24 (n = 180) | HSESS 2023/24; nominal UAH, Dec 2023 to Feb 2024 prices; no wage growth |
| Counterfactual | Zero earnings while NEET | Assumption |
| Share who could work | Already looking for work: 11%. Closing the gap with young men (27.5% against 15.5%): 44%. Looking for work or out of work because of care duties: 71% | HSESS 2023/24 |
| Formal jobs | Formal share among employed women aged 18–24: 62% without tertiary education, 75% overall, 86% with tertiary education | HSESS 2023/24 |
| Government receipts | 18% income tax and 5% military levy on the gross wage; 22% employer social contribution; 20% VAT on 80% of net earnings (consumption share assumed) | Statutory rates |
| Time | Annual cost; present value over 5 years at a 5% social discount rate; lifetime to age 60 | Same discount rate as A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024) |
| Not included | Employer returns; women's work-related expenses; effects on children and other household members; wider economic effects | |

# Cost of inaction: the three scenarios

| Scenario | Monthly wage (UAH) | Wage basis | Share who work | Basis | Formal jobs | Formality basis |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pessimistic | 7000 | 25th percentile wage of employed women 18-24 | 11% | NEET young women already looking for work | 62% | Employed women 18-24 without tertiary education |
| Central | 9078 | Wage predicted for NEET young women (Mincer equation) | 44% | Closing the NEET gap with young men | 75% | All employed women 18-24 |
| Optimistic | 10000 | Median wage of employed women 18-24 | 71% | Looking for work, or out of work because of care duties | 86% | Employed women 18-24 with tertiary education |

For each parameter, the lowest survey-based value goes to the pessimistic scenario and the highest to the optimistic one. The horizon (5 years) and the discount rate (5%) are the same in all scenarios.

# Wage equations: specifications

**1. Wage equation used for the cost of inaction** (employed women aged 18–64, n = 3,112, $R^2 = 0.32$)

$\ln(\text{monthly net wage}) = \alpha + \beta \cdot \text{education level} + \gamma_1 \cdot \text{age} + \gamma_2 \cdot \text{age}^2 + \delta \cdot \text{rural} + \text{oblast effects} + \varepsilon$

Estimated by weighted least squares with the survey weights. The predicted wage of each NEET young woman is exp(prediction) multiplied by a smearing factor (the weighted mean of the exponentiated residuals), using her own education level, age, area and oblast.

**2. Returns to a year of education** (wage earners aged 19–64, women and men separately)

$\ln(\text{monthly net wage}) = \alpha + \rho \cdot \text{years of education} + \gamma_1 \cdot \text{age} + \gamma_2 \cdot \text{age}^2 + \text{oblast fixed effects} + \varepsilon$

Years of education are implied by the highest level completed (9, 11, 12, 13, 15, 17). $\rho$ is 5.8% for women and 7.2% for men. Standard errors clustered by household.

**3. Wages by education level and sex** (wage earners aged 19–64, pooled)

$\ln(\text{monthly net wage}) = \alpha + \text{education level} \times \text{woman} + \gamma_1 \cdot \text{age} + \gamma_2 \cdot \text{age}^2 + \delta \cdot \text{rural} + \text{oblast effects} + \varepsilon$

Predicted wages are shown at age 30 in an urban area. None of the equations adjusts for hours worked, occupation or sector, and none corrects for selection into employment.

# Wage equation for the cost of inaction: coefficients

| Term | Coefficient | SE | p |
|---|---|---|---|
| Constant | 8.456 | 0.110 | <0.001 |
| Education: Complete secondary | -0.010 | 0.044 | 0.817 |
| Education: Vocational | 0.087 | 0.039 | 0.027 |
| Education: Short-cycle tertiary | 0.181 | 0.046 | <0.001 |
| Education: Higher (bachelor+) | 0.323 | 0.038 | <0.001 |
| Age | 0.029 | 0.005 | <0.001 |
| Age squared | 0.000 | 0.000 | <0.001 |
| Rural | -0.212 | 0.019 | <0.001 |

Dependent variable: log of monthly net wage, employed women aged 18–64, HSESS 2023/24. Reference education level: basic secondary or less. Oblast effects not shown.

# Investment options: sources for costs and employment effects

| Intervention | Cost per participant (UAH) | Cost basis | Employment effect | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Employment services (counselling and job matching) | 3,000 to 8,000 | Assumption (no public unit cost found): UAH 3,000 to 8,000 per client; to be replaced with State Employment Service cost per client | 1.6 to 5.4 pp | Card, Kluve and Weber (2018), meta-analysis of 207 evaluations: +1.6 pp employment within a year, +5.4 pp after one to two years |
| Employer-supported internships and first jobs | 25,941 to 51,882 | 3 to 6 months of the 2026 minimum wage (UAH 8,647), the amount the State Employment Service already uses to compensate employers | 5.4 to 8.7 pp | Card, Kluve and Weber (2018): +5.4 pp after one to two years, +8.7 pp after more than two years |
| Childcare support with flexible work | 96,000 to 192,000 | 12 to 24 months of the eYasla payment (UAH 8,000 a month since January 2026 for parents returning to full-time work) | 7.0 to 14.0 pp | Berlinski and Galiani (2007), Argentina: +7 to 14 pp maternal employment; Clark et al. (2019), Kenya: +8.5 pp; Halim, Perova and Reynolds (2023): 21 of 22 studies positive |
| Internships plus childcare (package) | 121,941 to 243,882 | Sum of the two components above | 12.4 to 22.7 pp | Assumption: effects of the two components add up; no evaluation of the combined package |

Card, Kluve and Weber (2018), Journal of the European Economic Association 16(3); Berlinski and Galiani (2007), Labour Economics 14; Clark, Kabiru, Laszlo and Muthuri (2019), Demography 56; Halim, Perova and Reynolds (2023), World Bank Research Observer 38(1). None of these evaluations comes from a country in conflict. In Ukraine, labour shortages could make effects larger, while safety, displacement and childcare closures could make them smaller; Card, Kluve and Weber find larger effects for women and in weak labour markets. The ranges should be replaced with Ukrainian evidence, for example State Employment Service follow-up data, when available.

# How this builds on earlier investment cases

| | A Brighter Future (UNICEF Ukraine, 2024) | This analysis |
|---|---|---|
| **Focus** | Early childhood development: children under six | Young women aged 18–24 who are not in education, employment or training |
| **Question** | Returns to scaling up childcare, preschool, health, social protection and WASH services to 2050 | Who is excluded, why, what it costs each year, and what employment gain would justify each service |
| **Data** | National statistics, mostly from before 2022, and regional assumptions | Microdata collected since 2022: MICS 2025/26 and HSESS 2023/24 |
| **Link** | Estimates that expanding childcare would allow caregivers, mainly women, to return to work | Measures that link directly: motherhood and childcare are the main reasons young women are out of work |

The two are complementary: the earlier case argues for expanding early childhood services; this one identifies the young women who would use them and what their exclusion costs. Both use a 5% social discount rate.

# How the intervention parameters are built and updated

| Step | What was done | How the country office can update it |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Intervention types | Four types from the GenU priorities: employment services (counselling and job matching), employer-supported internships and first jobs, childcare services with flexible work, and a combined package for young mothers | Add rows to code/intervention_parameters.csv (one per intervention or package), with a target group |
| 2. Costs | Present value of the total cost per participant over the support period, low and high, from existing Ukrainian programme amounts where available | Replace with State Employment Service, partner and UNICEF unit costs |
| 3. Employment effects | Additional, sustained employment attributable to the intervention, low and high, from published evaluations in other countries (sources on the previous slide) | Replace with Ukrainian evaluations where available (for example SES programme follow-up data) |
| 4. Benefits | Effect multiplied by the annual value of a job (net earnings; income tax, levy, contributions and VAT) over the years sustained, discounted at 5% | Change wage, formality or duration in 04_cost_of_inaction.R to test scenarios |
| 5. Outputs | Benefit-cost ratios by perspective, break-even employment gains, and the comparison with the evidence range | Re-run bash UPDATE_RESULTS.sh; all slides update |

Employer returns (productivity, retention, vacancy costs) are not included and would be the next step for the private sector case.

# Age groups

| Age group | Used for | Why |
|---|---|---|
| **18–24** | Main group: NEET, employment, earnings, cost of inaction | In line with government statistics and UNICEF programming |
| **15–17** | NEET and employment among the younger group | MICS asks the NEET questions to women aged 15–24; HSESS asks employment questions from age 15 |
| **14–17** | School attendance | Available for all household members in both surveys |

MICS 2025/26 has no men's questionnaire, so NEET and employment in MICS refer to women; comparisons between women and men use HSESS 2023/24 and, for school attendance, the MICS household roster.

# Variables and definitions (1/2)

| Concept | Definition | MICS 2025/26 | HSESS 2023/24 | LFS 2021 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **In education** | Attending school or university in the current school year | ED9 (members 3–24); NE3 (women 15–24) | IND_A9 | reason_inactiv = 2 (inactive students) |
| **Employed** | Worked at least one hour for pay or profit in the reference week, or temporarily absent; production for own household use only is not counted | NE8–NE11, NE20–NE21 (women 15–24) | IND_B1 | labour_force = 1 |
| **NEET** | Not in education or training and not employed | NEET module (women 15–24) | IND_A9, IND_B1 | labour_force, reason_inactiv (upper bound) |
| **Labour-force participation** | Employed, or looking for work or starting a business | not available | IND_B1, IND_B21 | labour_force 1–2 |
| **Informal employment** | Verbal agreement, unregistered own-account work, or family farm work for sale | not available | IND_B3_1 | informal_empl = 1 |
| **Mother** | Has given birth (MICS) or lives with own child under 18 (HSESS) | CEB | household roster (IND_A1, ages) | not available |

# Variables and definitions (2/2)

| Concept | Definition | MICS 2025/26 | HSESS 2023/24 | LFS 2021 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Care work** | Caring for children or the sick in the past week (5–17); daily care of own children | CL11E, CL11F | IND_B28_1 | reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy) |
| **Internally displaced** | Self-reported IDP status | WB10A | IND_A19 | not available |
| **Disability** | Washington Group functional difficulty (18–49); any household member with disability | AF module | D1_Mult3/4 | not available |
| **Economic status** | Wealth quintile; household income per member | windex5 | V1 / household size | not available |
| **Years of education** | Years implied by the highest level completed (9 basic secondary, 11 complete secondary, 12 vocational, 13 short-cycle, 15 bachelor, 17 master) | welevel | IND_A7 | education |

# Key variables (1/2)

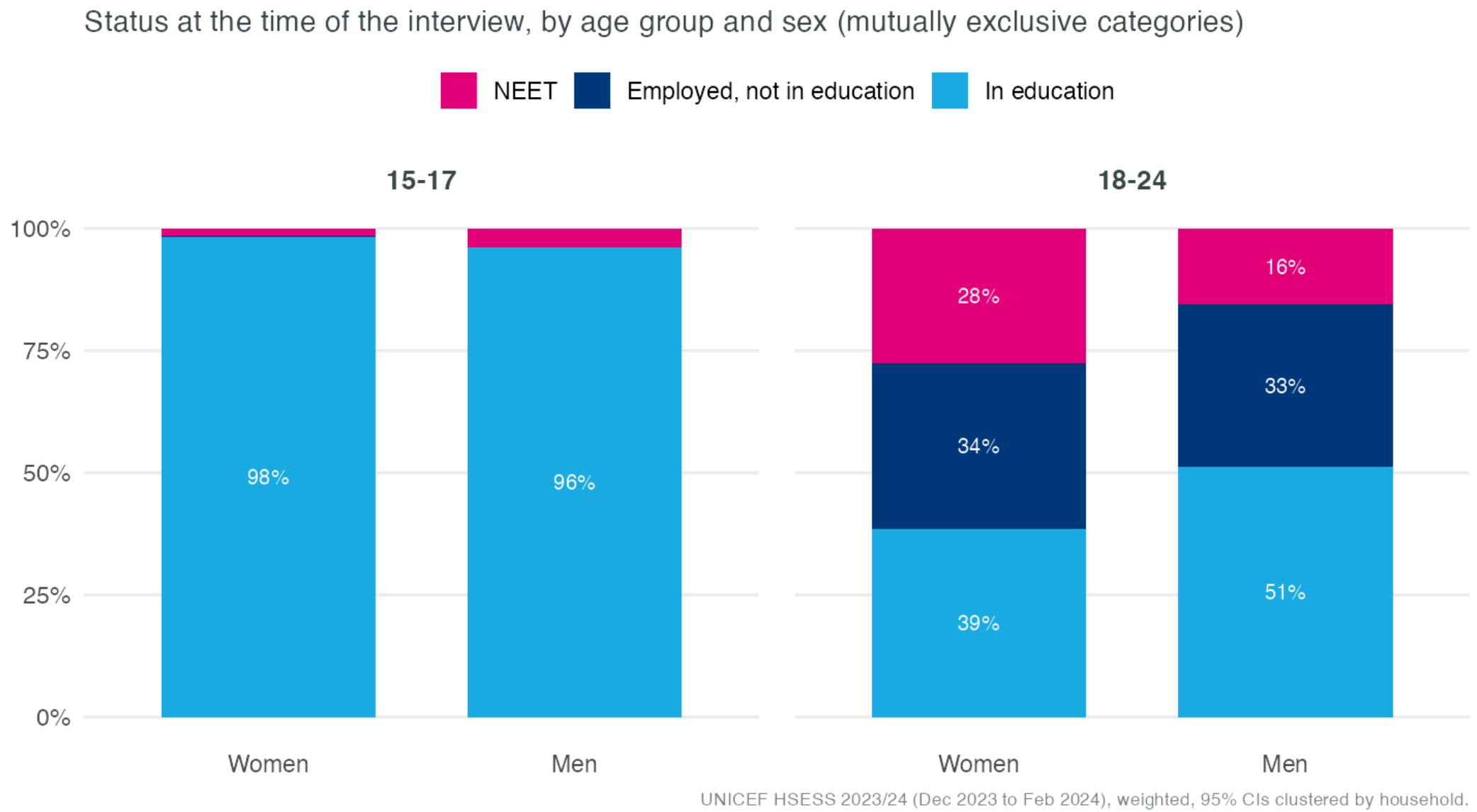
| Concept | Use | MICS 2025/26 | HSESS 2023/24 | LFS 2021 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Age | Groups 15-17, 18-24; 15-29 for NEET | HL6; WB4 (women) | IND_A2 age in years | age_gr (bands) |
| Sex | Breakdown by sex | HL4 (household members) | IND_A3 | sex |
| Survey design | Weighted estimates | hhweight, wmweight, fsweight; psu; stratum | Final weight; household key | weight_year; kod_res |
| Region / area | Regional and urban/rural breakdown | HH7 oblast; macroregion; HH6 | OBLAST; SETTL_TYPE | rg; tp_ar |
| Displacement | Breakdown by displacement | WB10A IDP status; PE3 household moved | IND_A19 IDP status | not available |
| Disability | Breakdown by disability | disability (functioning, 18-49) | D1_Mult3/4 household member | not available |
| Marital status | Household formation | MSTATUS | IND_A6 | marital_st |
| Motherhood | Breakdown by motherhood | CEB children ever born; WDOBFC | Own child under 18 (roster) | not available |
| Care work | Care responsibilities | CL11E/F caring for children or the sick (5-17) | IND_B28_1 daily care of own children | reason_inactiv = 3 (proxy) |
| Childcare access | Preschool attendance | ED9, ED10A (ages 3-5) | IND_A14 reason not attending | not available |
| Economic status | Breakdown by income or wealth | windex5 wealth quintile; PE20 income | V1 household income per member | not available |

# Key variables (2/2)

| Concept | Use | MICS 2025/26 | HSESS 2023/24 | LFS 2021 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Changes since 2022 | Household context | PE3 moved; PE5 dwelling damaged; PE12 members separated | not available | not applicable |
| Education level | Education-to-work transition | welevel; ED10A level attended | IND_A7 | education; special_dipl |
| In education | School attendance, NEET | ED9 (members 3-24); NE3 (women 15-24) | IND_A9; IND_A10 type | reason_inactiv = 2 |
| Training | NEET | NE6 courses or training (women 15-24) | not available | not available |
| Employment | Employment, NEET | NE8-NE11, NE20-NE21 (women 15-24) | IND_B1 | labour_force |
| Job search | Unemployment, participation | not available | IND_B21 | labour_force = 2 |
| Reason not working | Reasons for inactivity | not available | IND_B24 | reason_inactiv |
| Occupation / sector | Occupational distribution | not available | IND_B6_2; IND_B5_2 | occupation |
| Job quality | Informality, hours | not available | IND_B3_1; IND_B9_1; IND_B10_1 | informal_empl; actual_duration |
| Earnings | Wage differences, costing | not available | IND_V1_1_1 (wages) | not available |

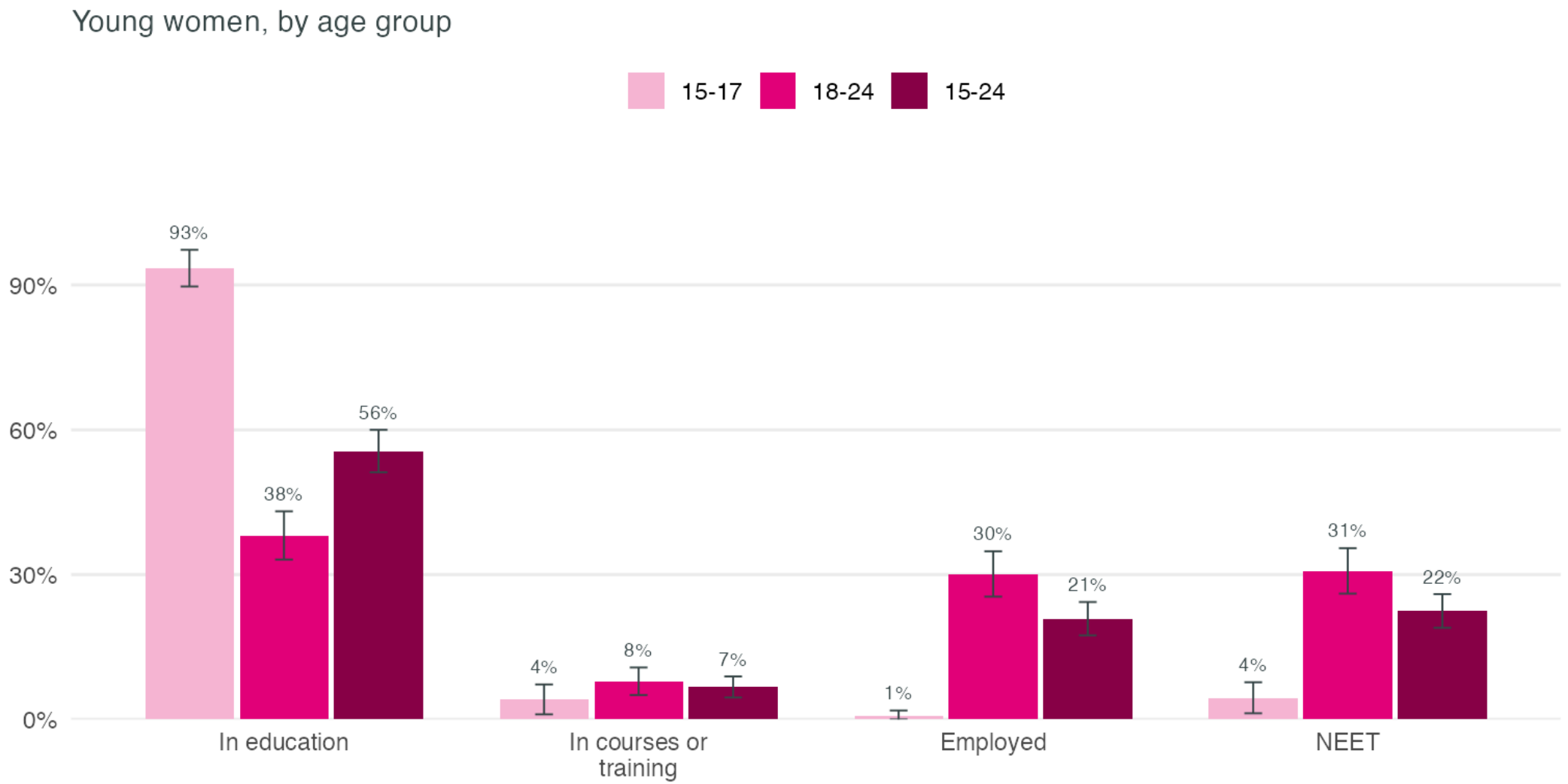
Variable codes as in each questionnaire. Full list of variables in every file: output/inventory/variable_report.xlsx.

# Status at 15–17 and 18–24 by sex (HSESS)



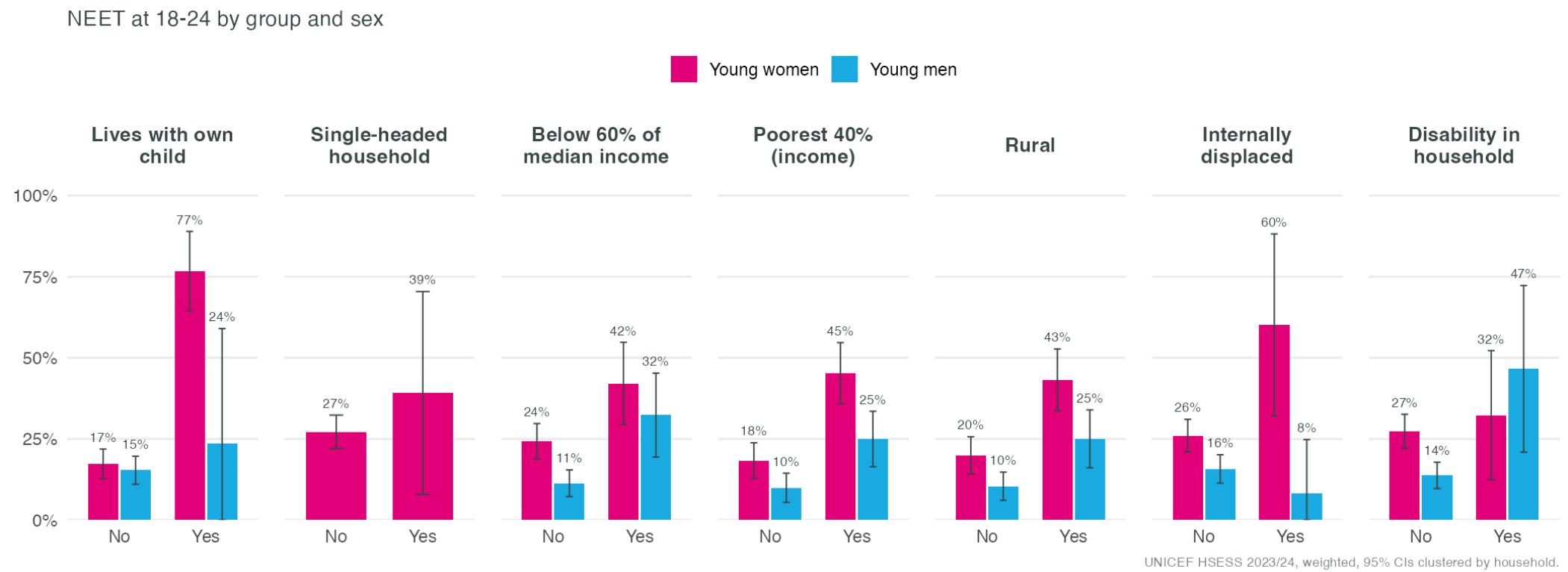

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# Young women by age: education, training, employment, NEET (MICS)



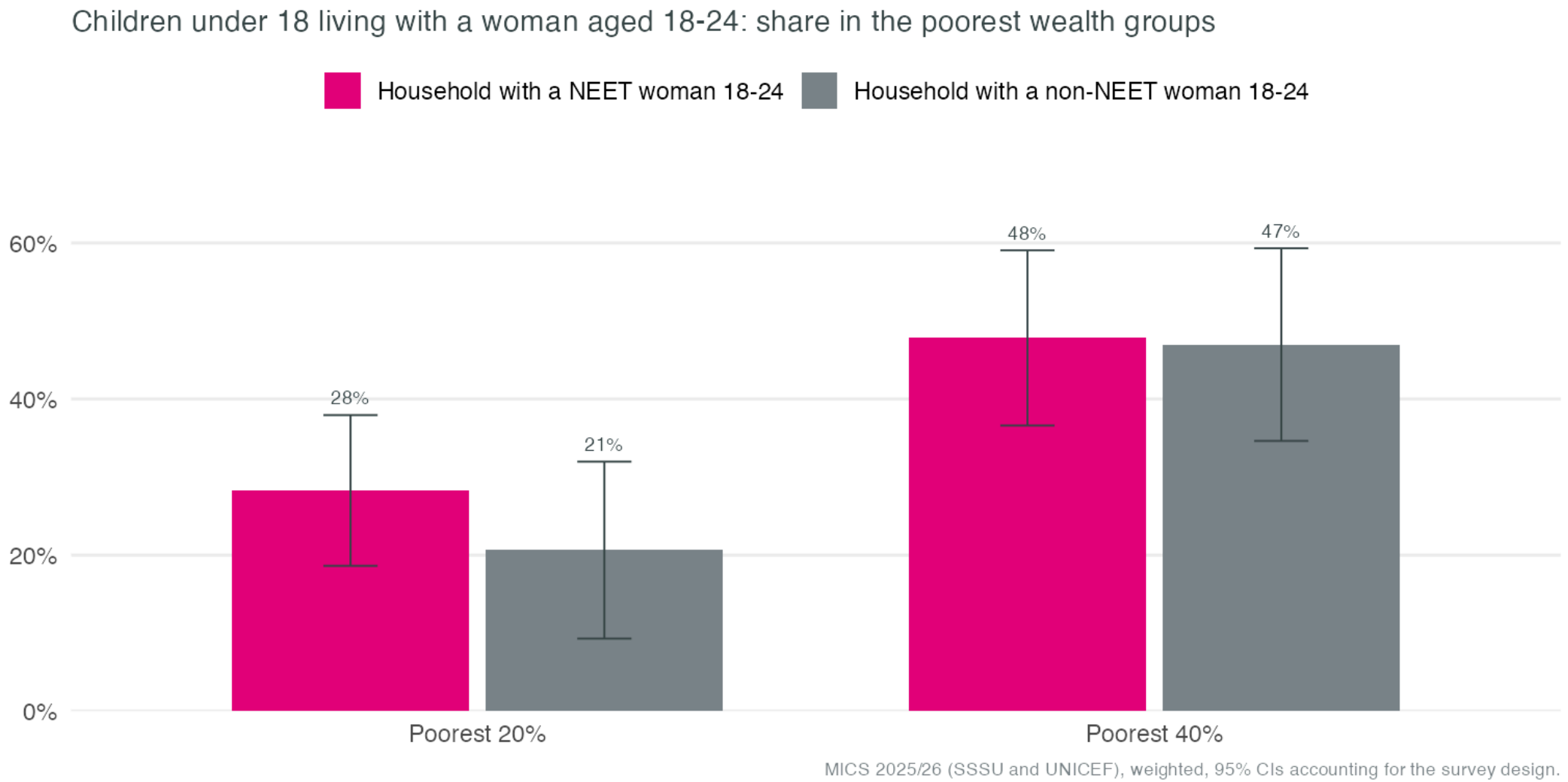

MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

# NEET by group, women and men aged 18–24 (HSESS)



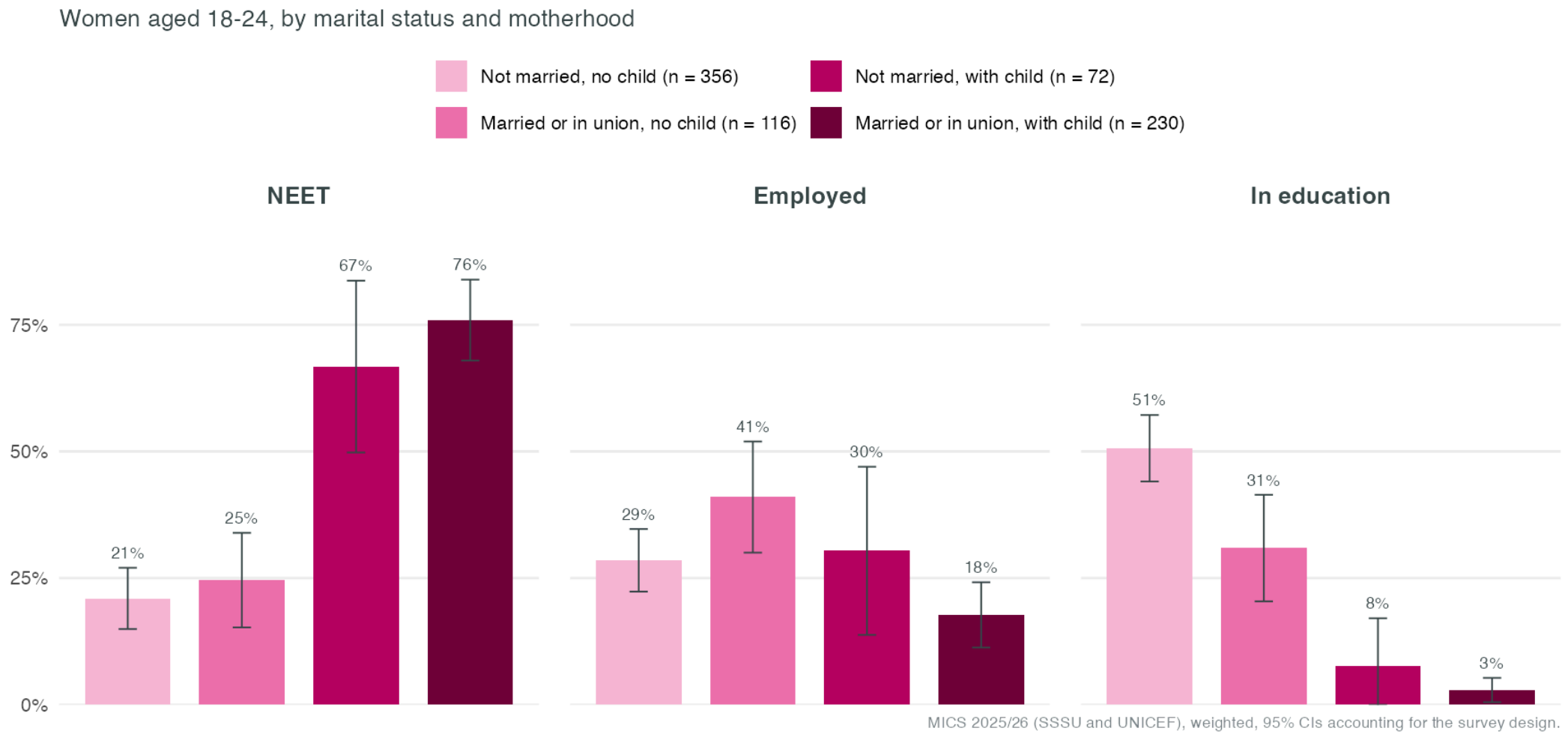

HSESS 2023/24. Below 60% of median income: women 42% against 24%. Single-headed households: 39% against 27%.

# Children in poor households, by the young woman’s NEET status (MICS)

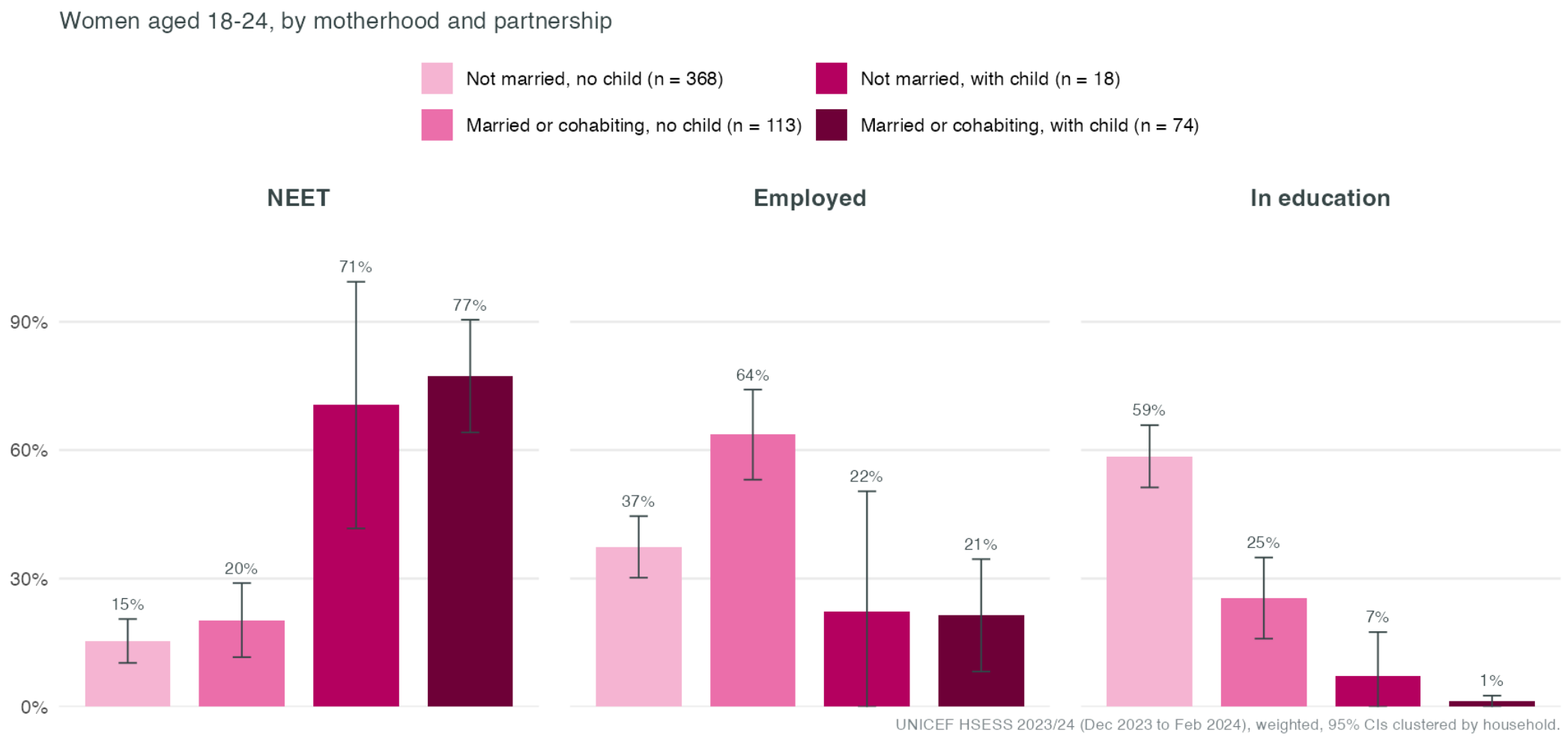



MICS 2025/26, children under 18 living with a woman aged 18–24. In the poorest 40%: 48% where she is NEET and 47% where she is not. The two are similar: children living with young women are more often in poor households regardless of her NEET status.

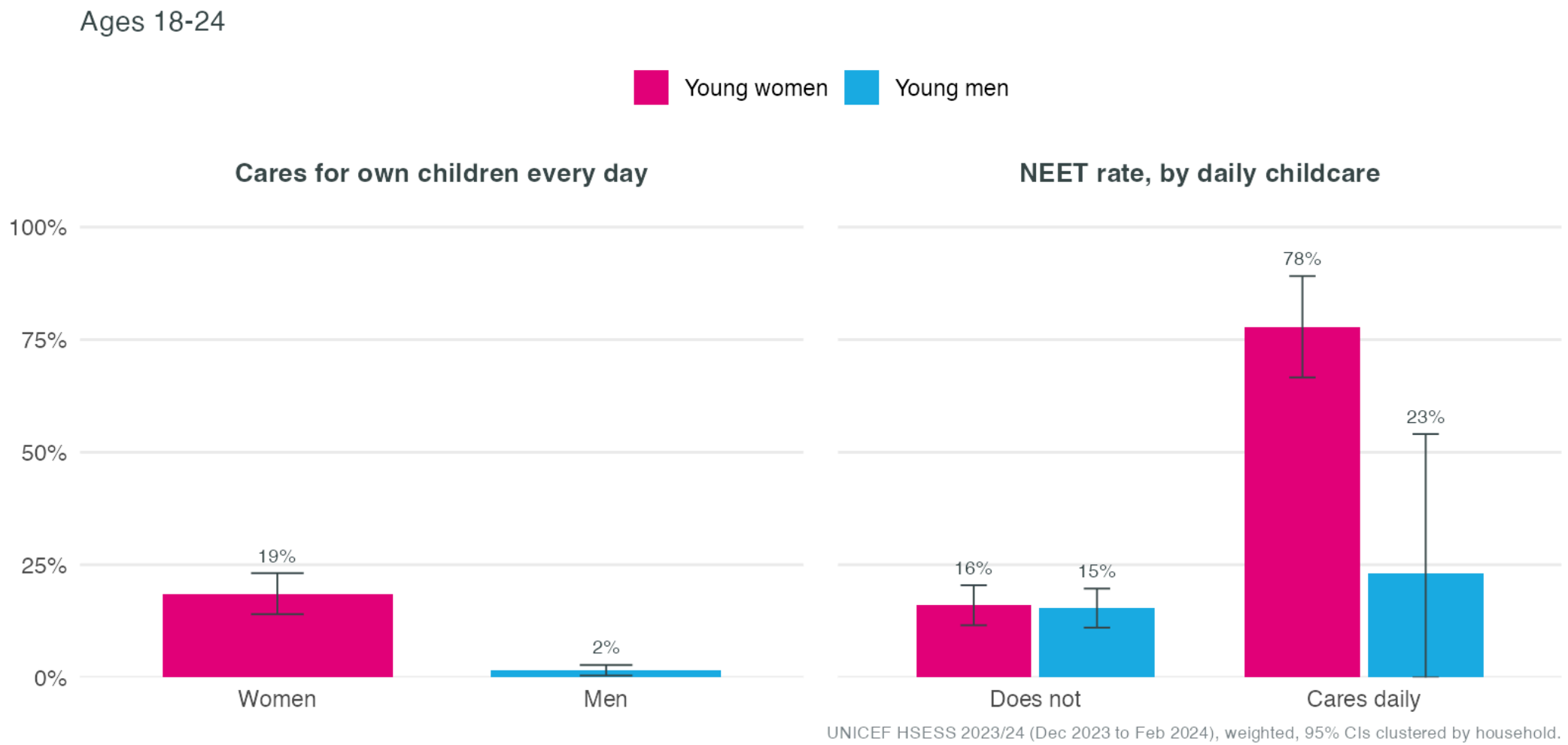
# Marital status and motherhood, women 18–24 (MICS)



# Motherhood and partnership, women 18–24 (HSESS)

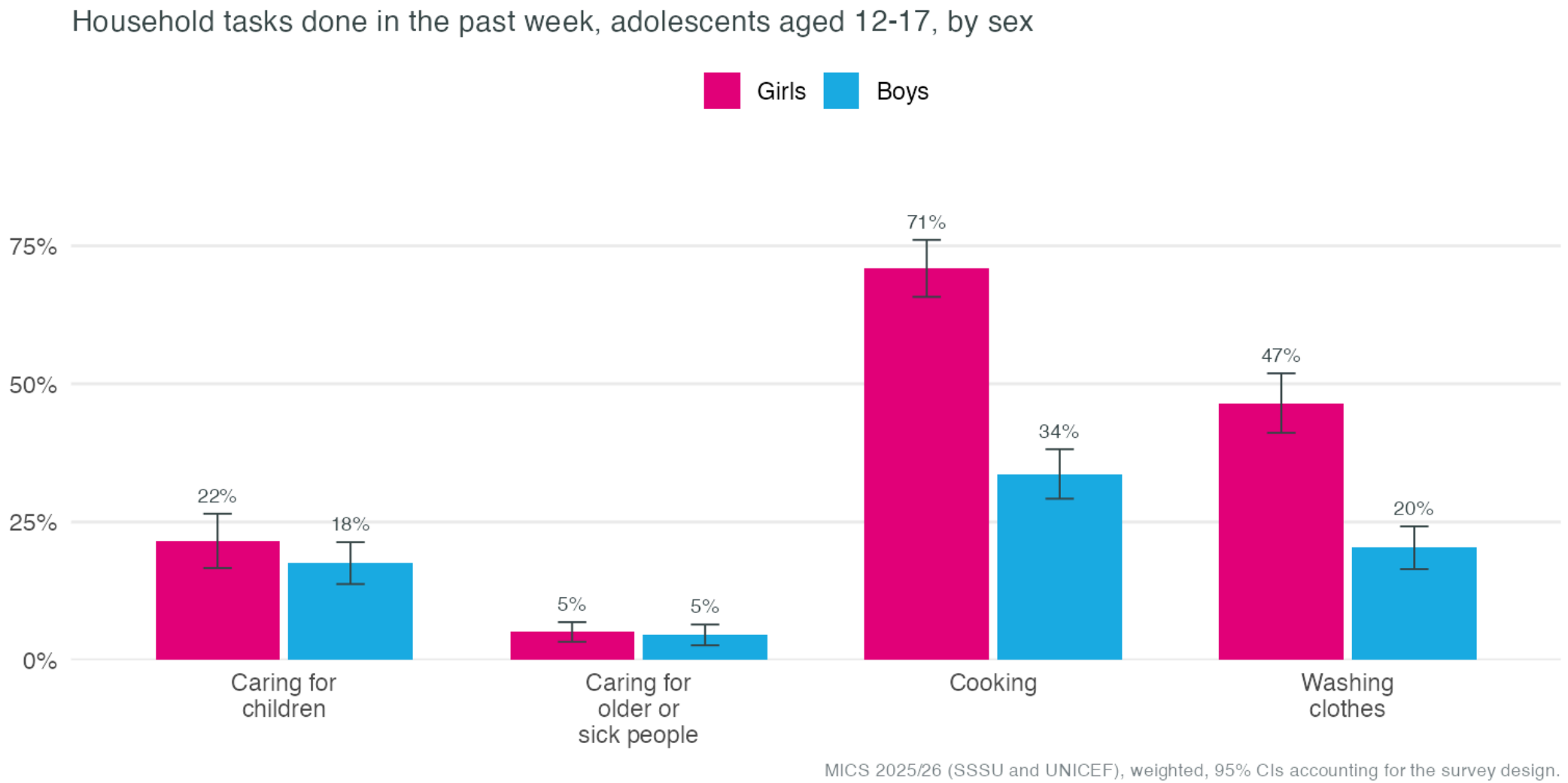


# Daily childcare and NEET at 18–24 (HSESS)



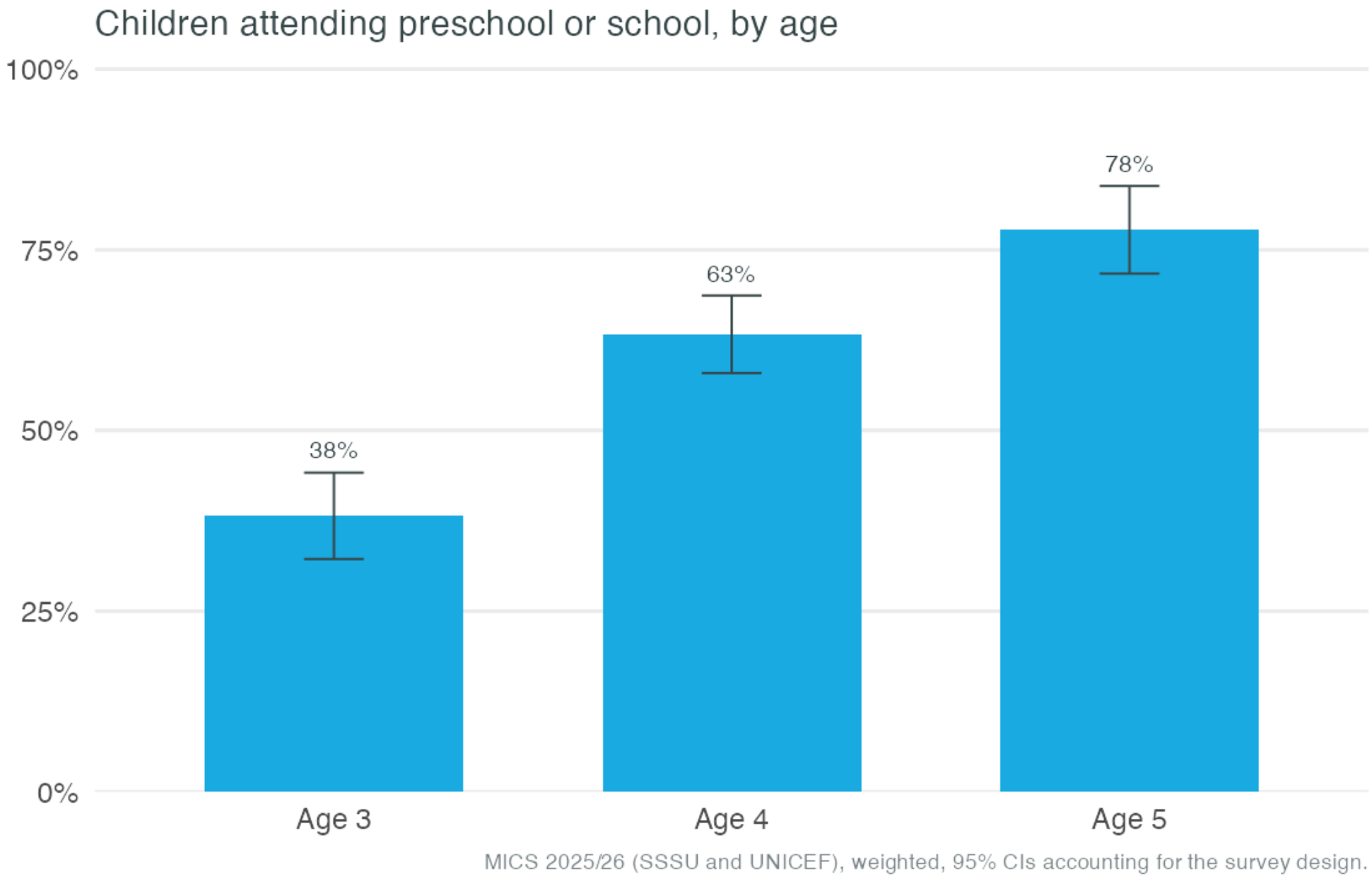

Daily care of own children: women 19%, men 2%. NEET among women who care daily: 78%; among others: 16%.

# Care work among adolescents aged 12–17 (MICS)

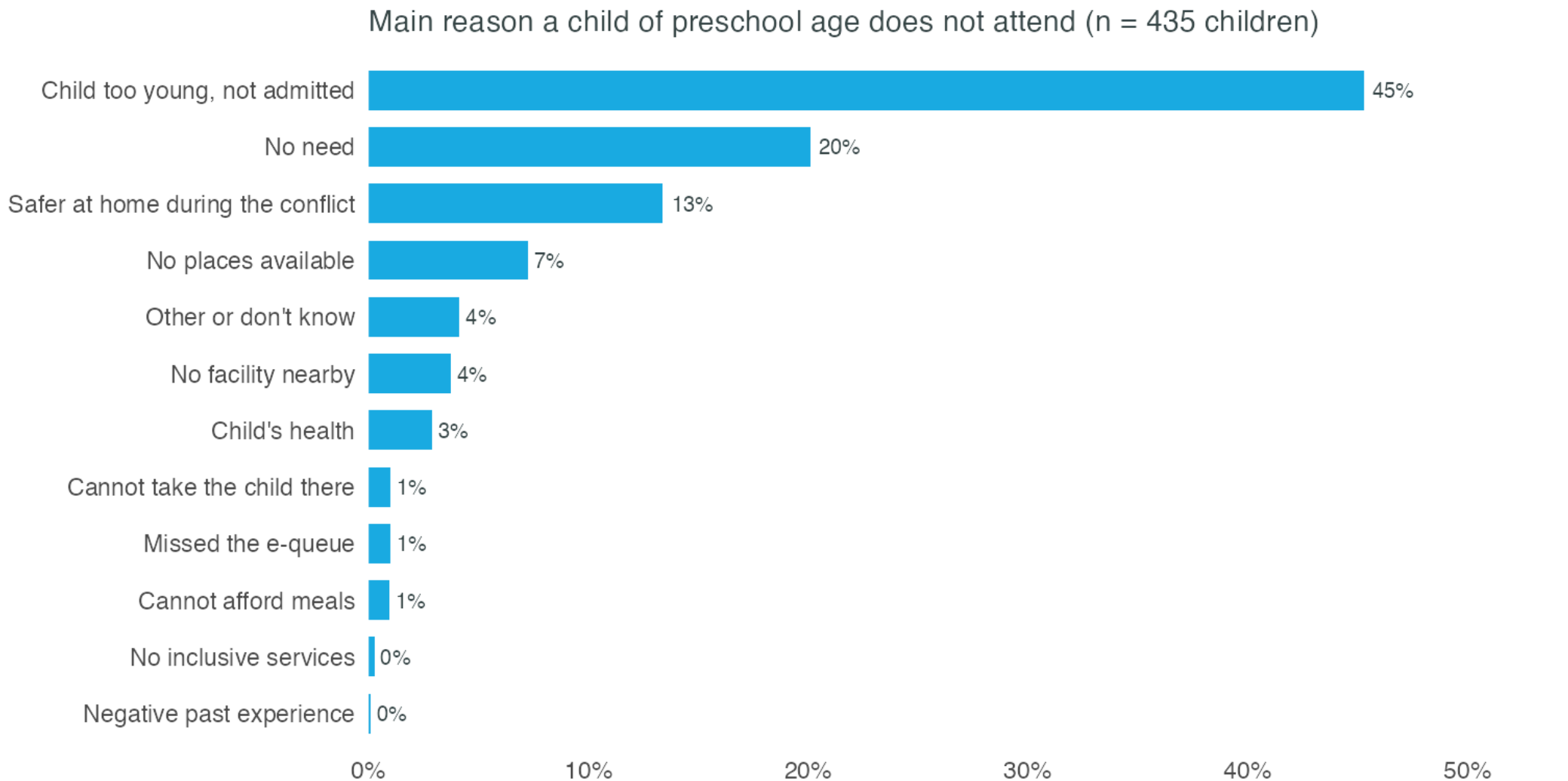



Cared for children in the past week: girls 22%, boys 18%.

# Preschool attendance by age (MICS)

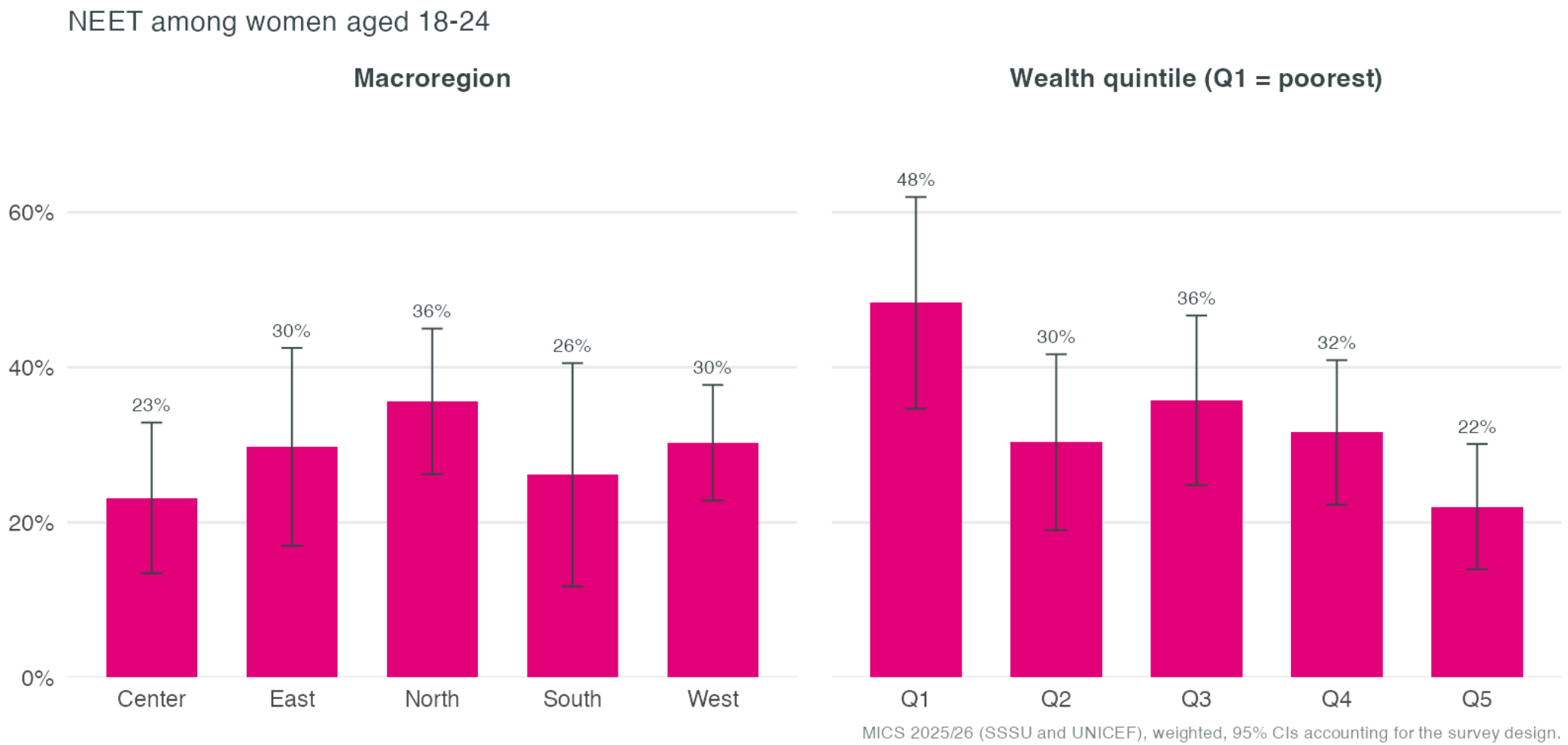


# Reasons for not attending preschool, all children (HSESS)



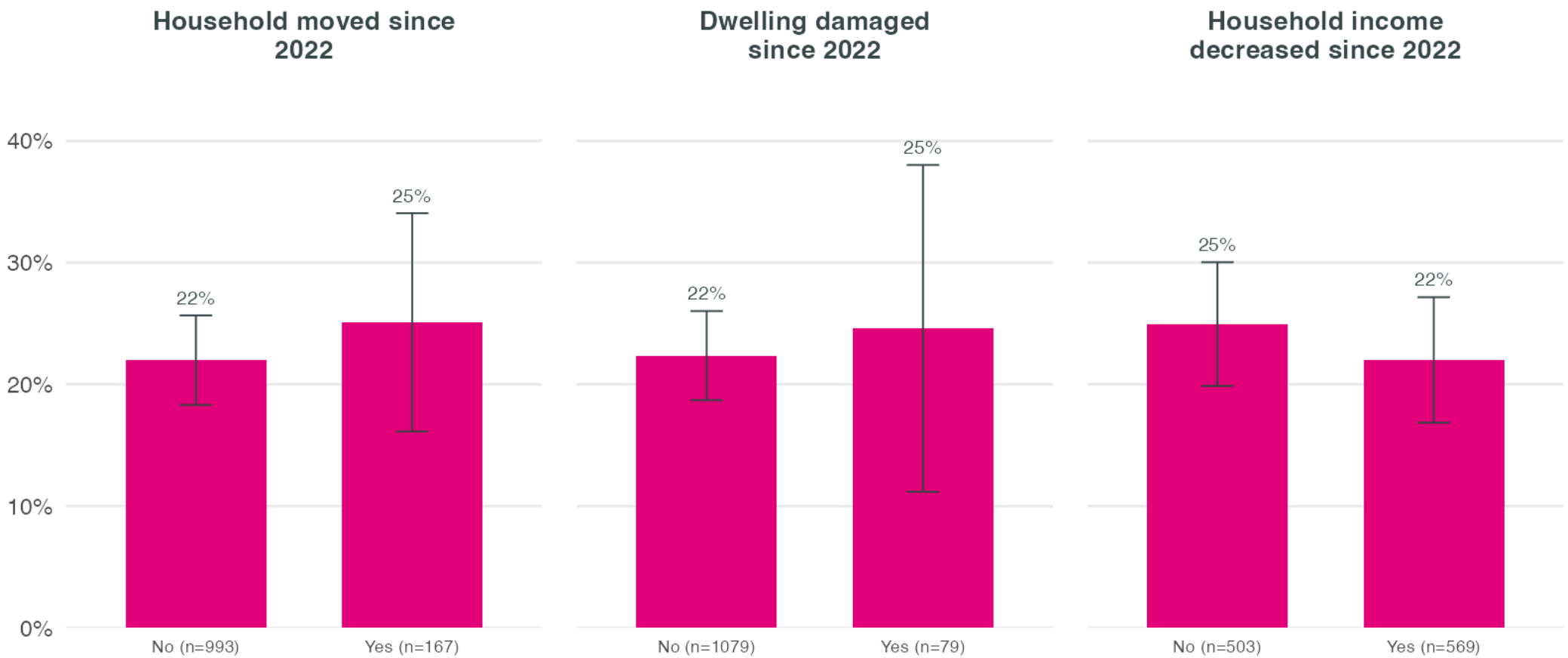

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# NEET by macroregion and wealth, women 18–24 (MICS)



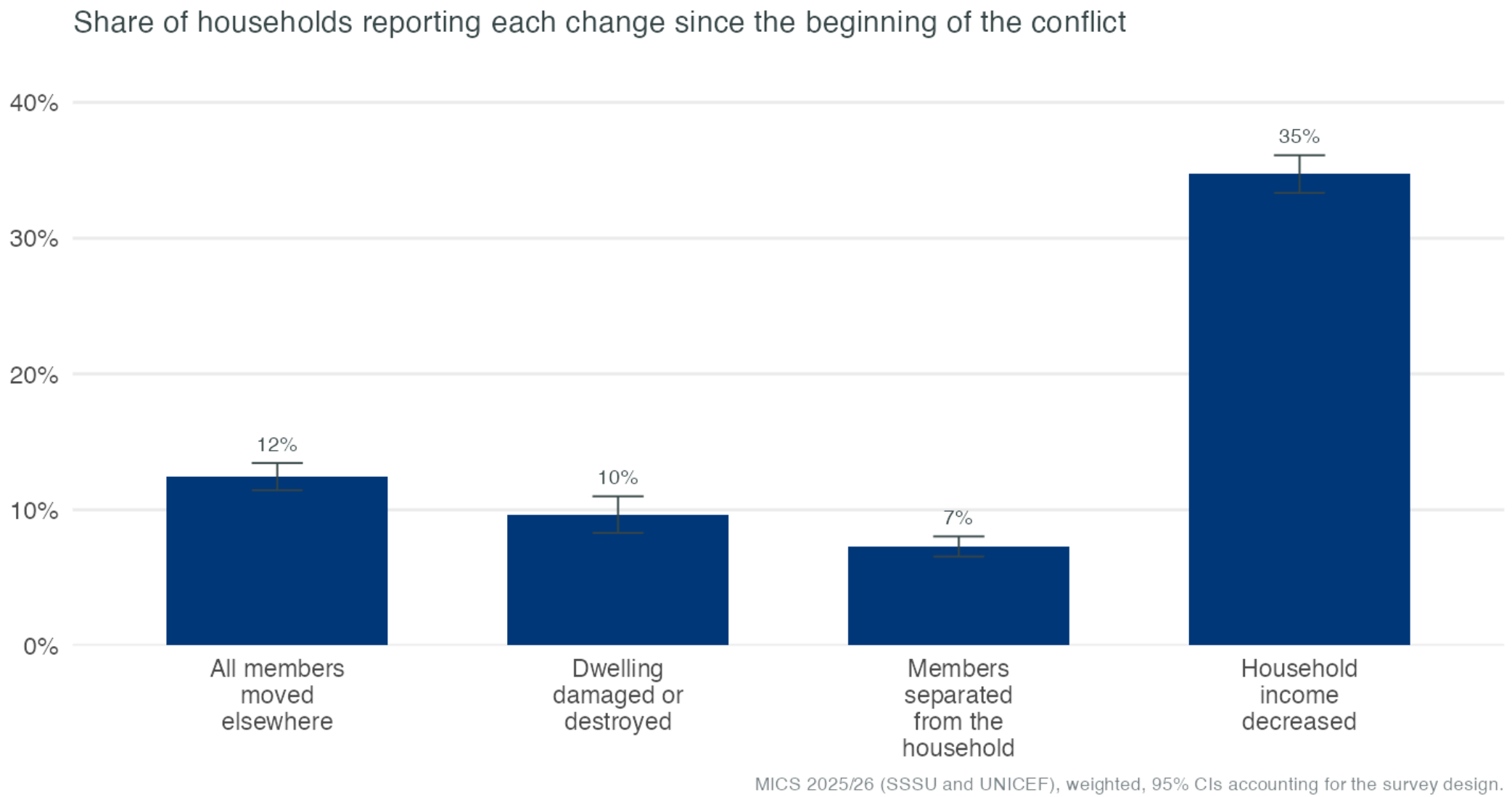
# NEET by household changes since the beginning of the conflict (MICS)

NEET among women aged 15-24, by household changes since the beginning of the conflict



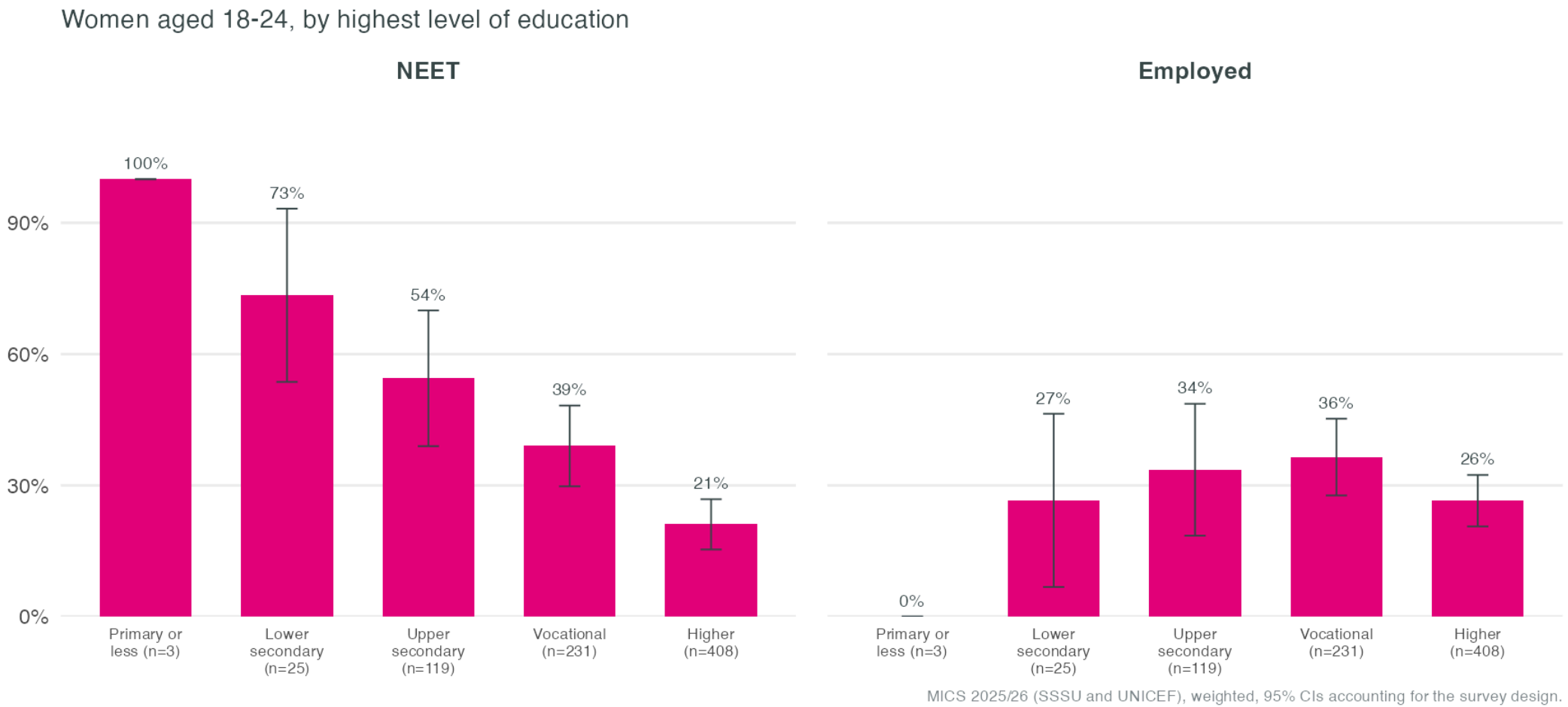

MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

# Households since the beginning of the conflict (MICS)



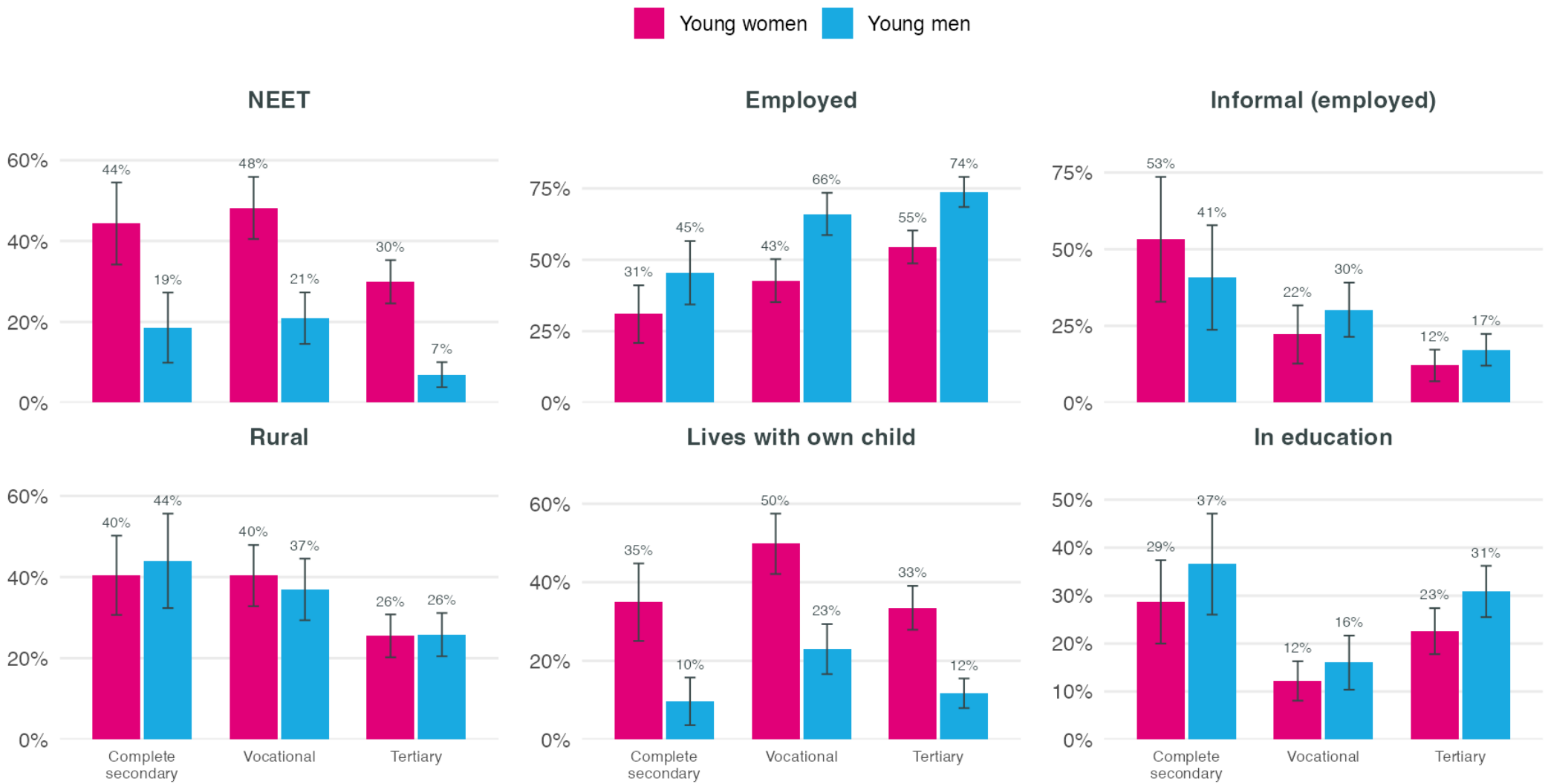

Moved: 12%. Lower income: 35%.

# NEET and employment by education, women 18–24 (MICS)



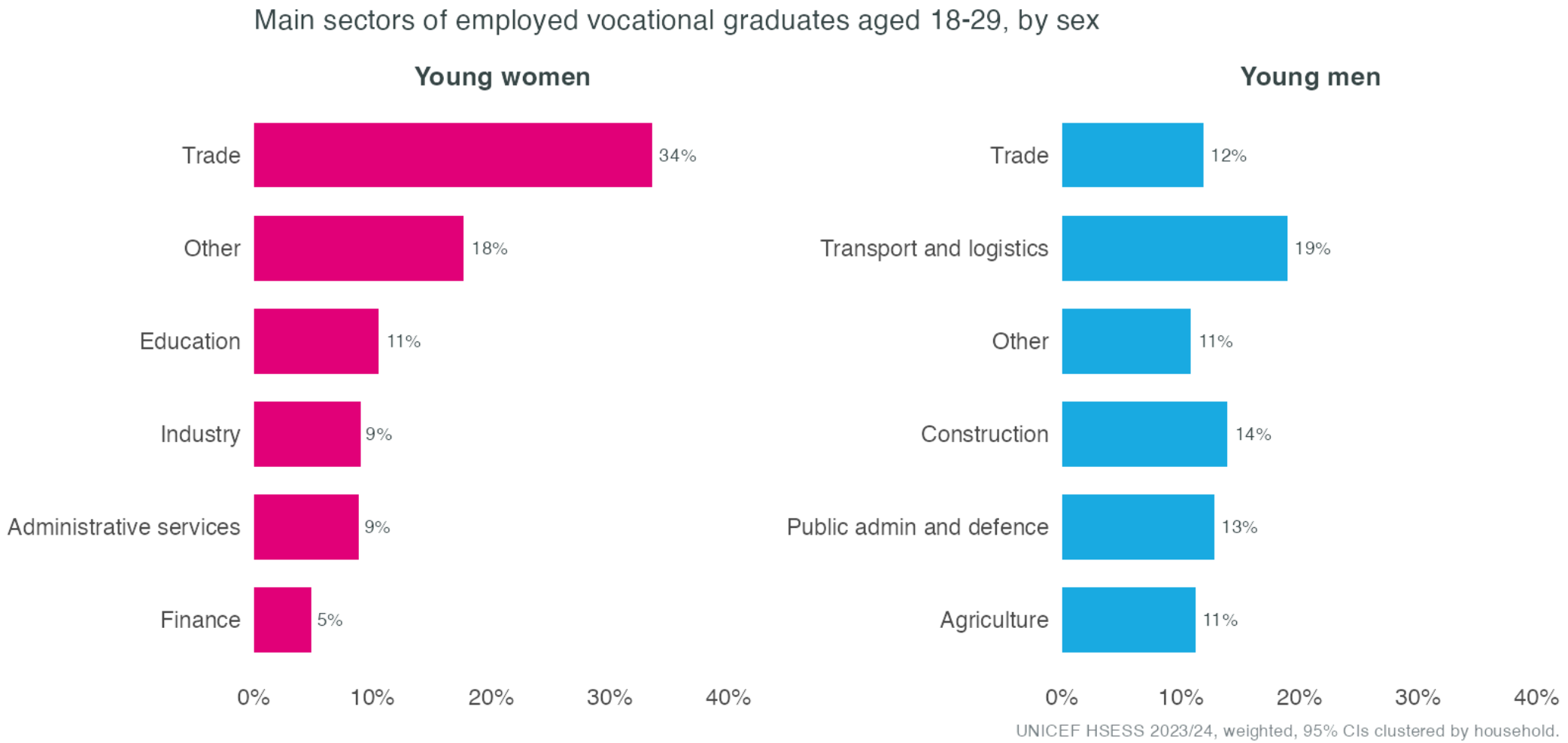
# Vocational graduates aged 18–29: profile (HSESS)

People aged 18-29 by highest level of education and sex



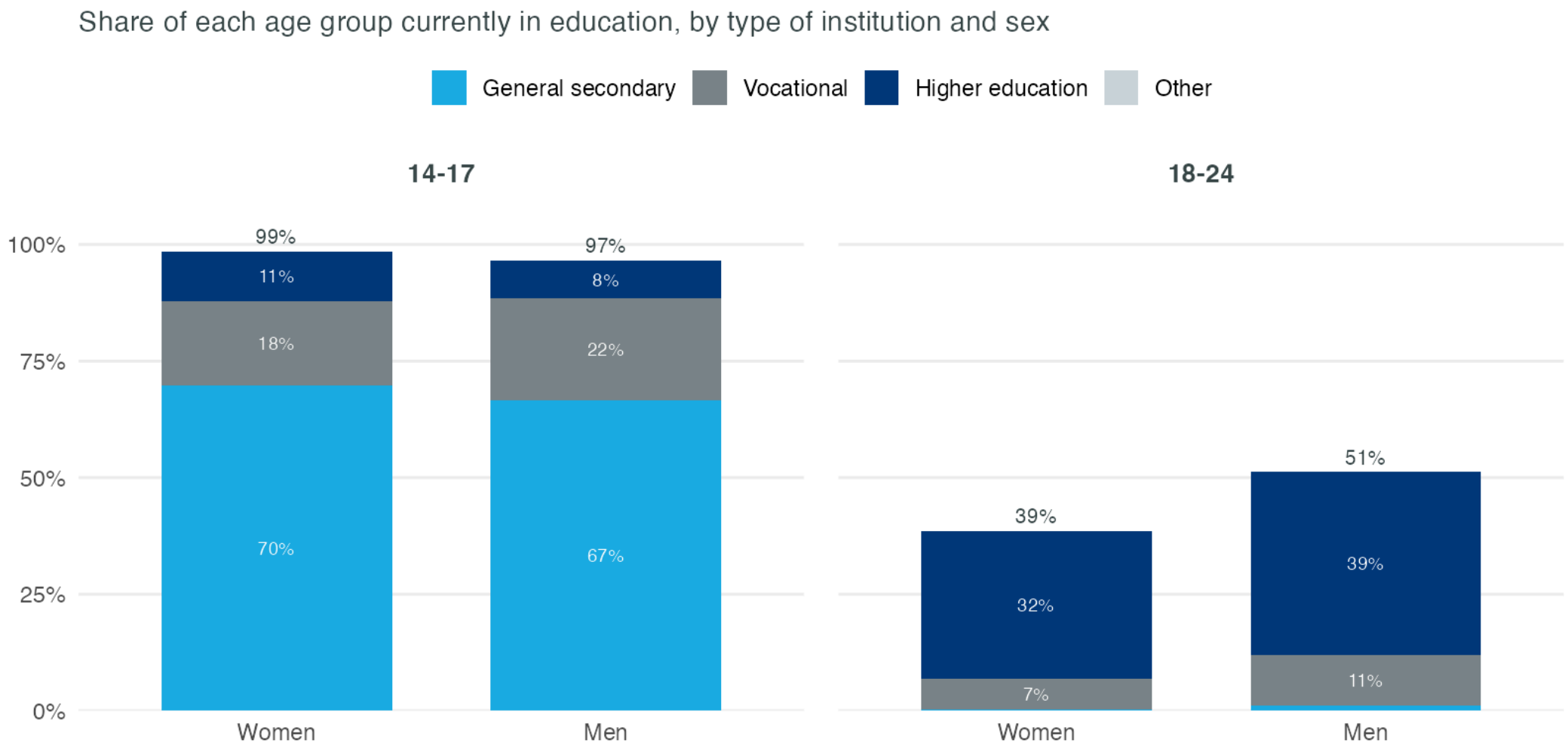

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# Sectors of employed vocational graduates aged 18–29 (HSESS)



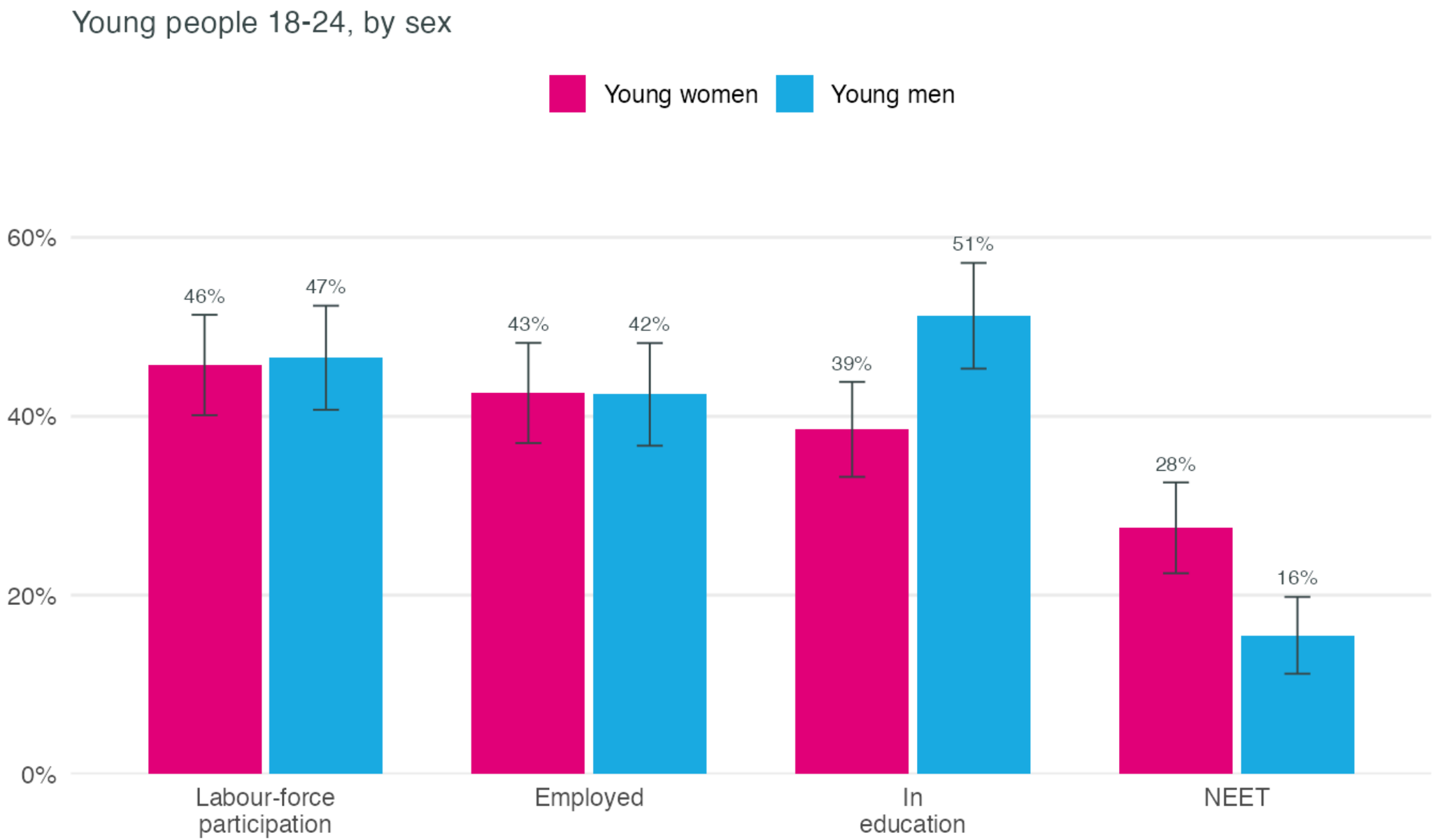

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# In education by type of institution (HSESS)



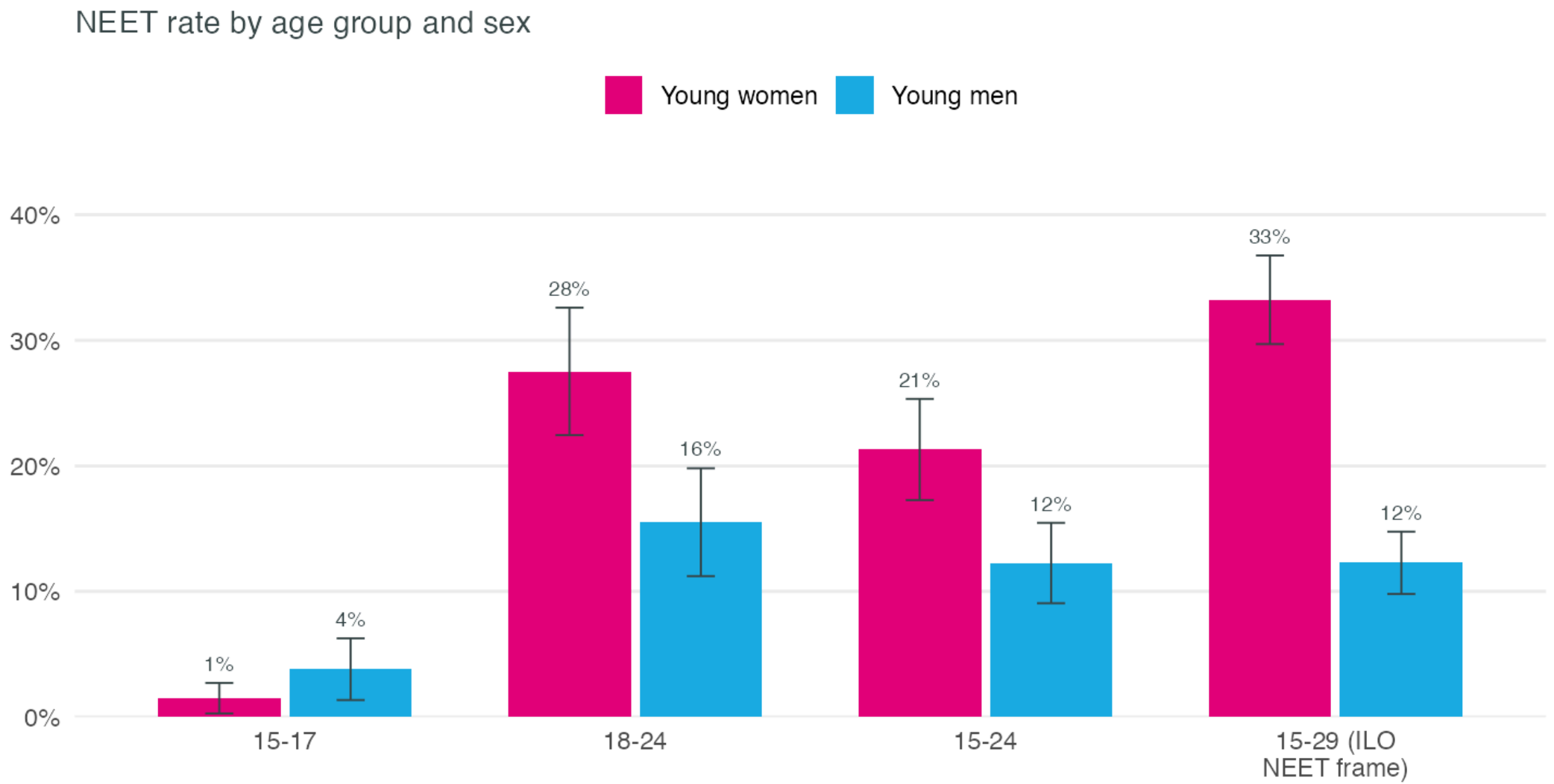

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# Participation, employment, education and NEET at 18–24 (HSESS)



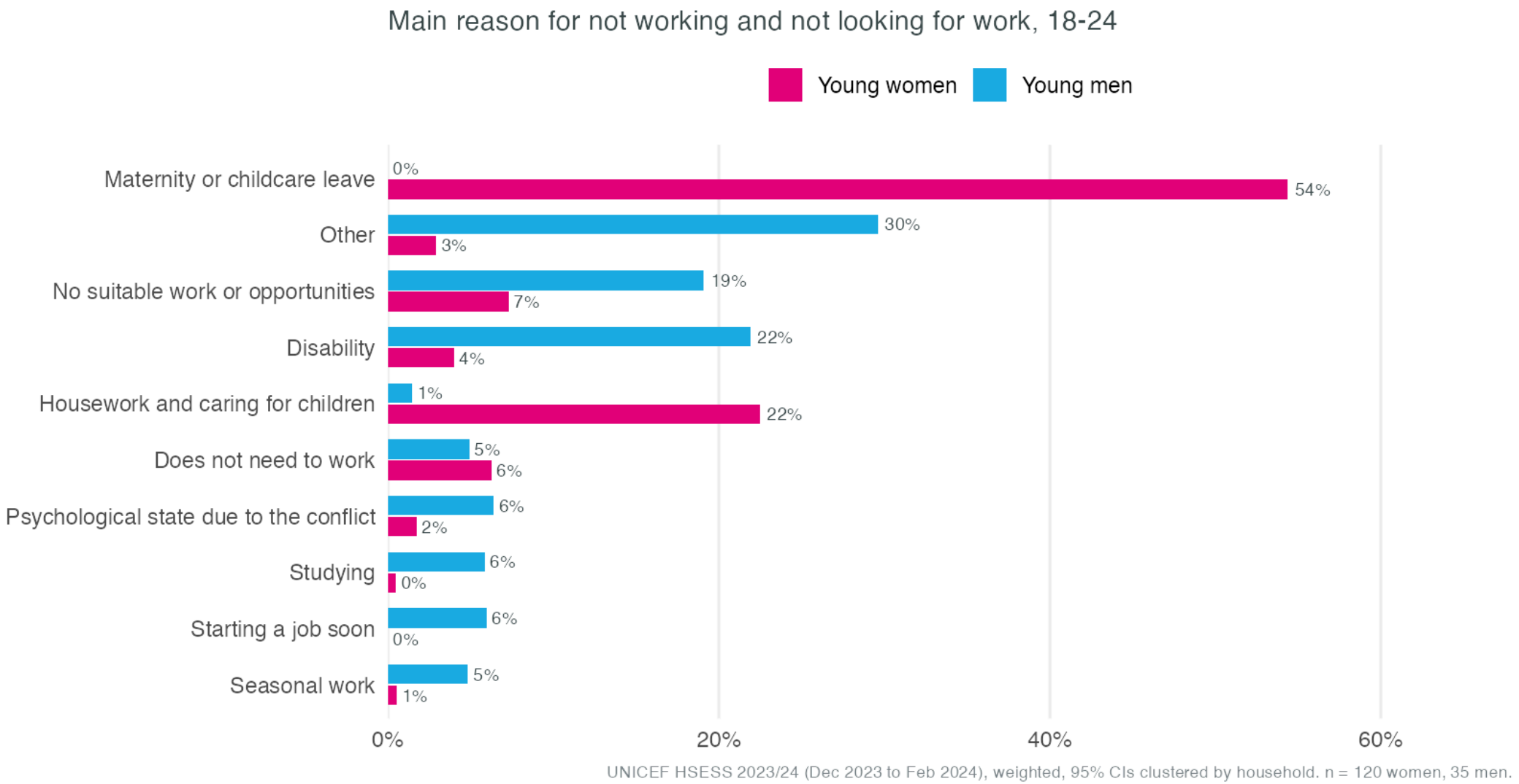

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# NEET by age group and sex (HSESS)



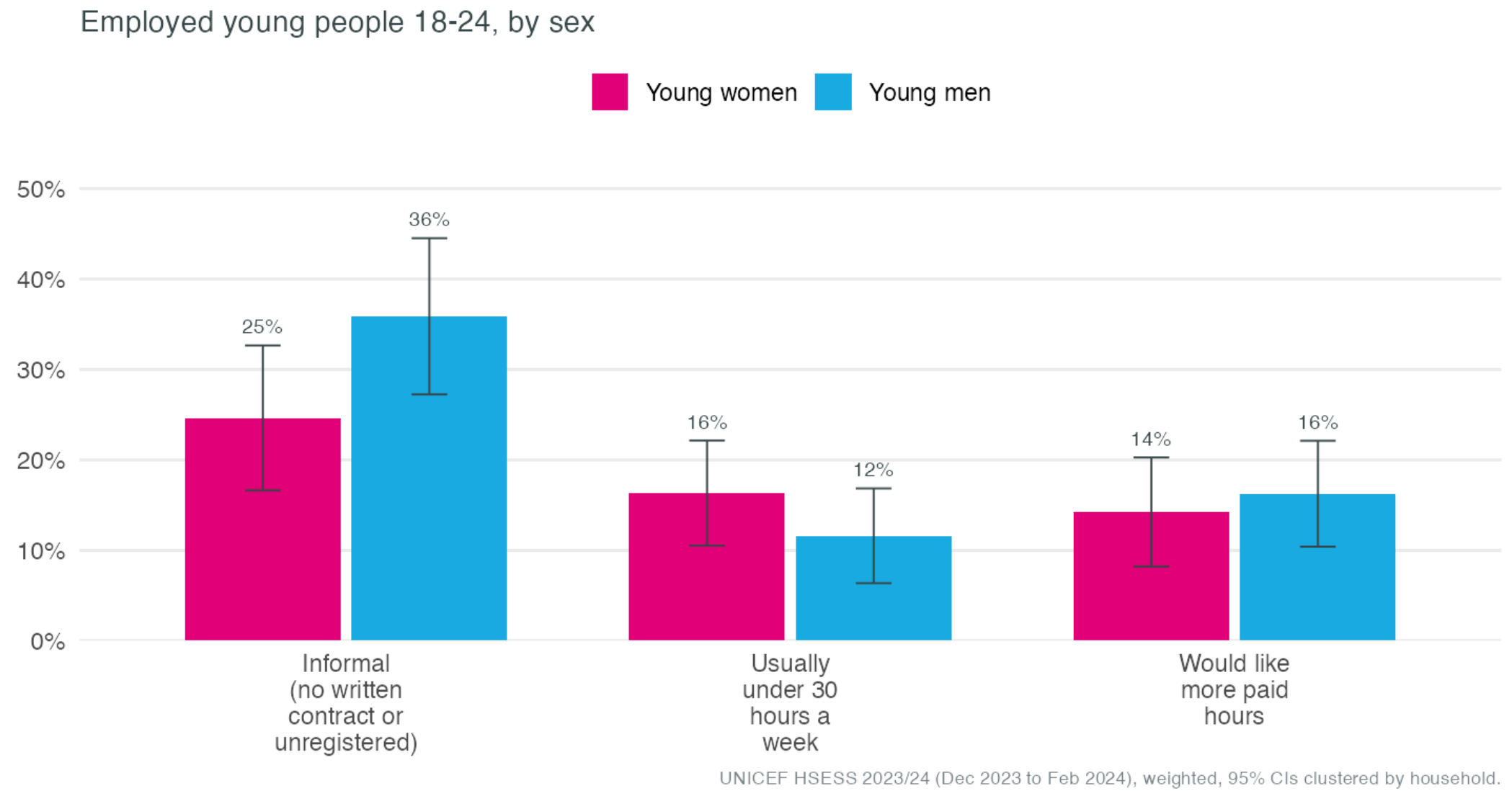

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# Reasons for not working, detailed (HSESS)



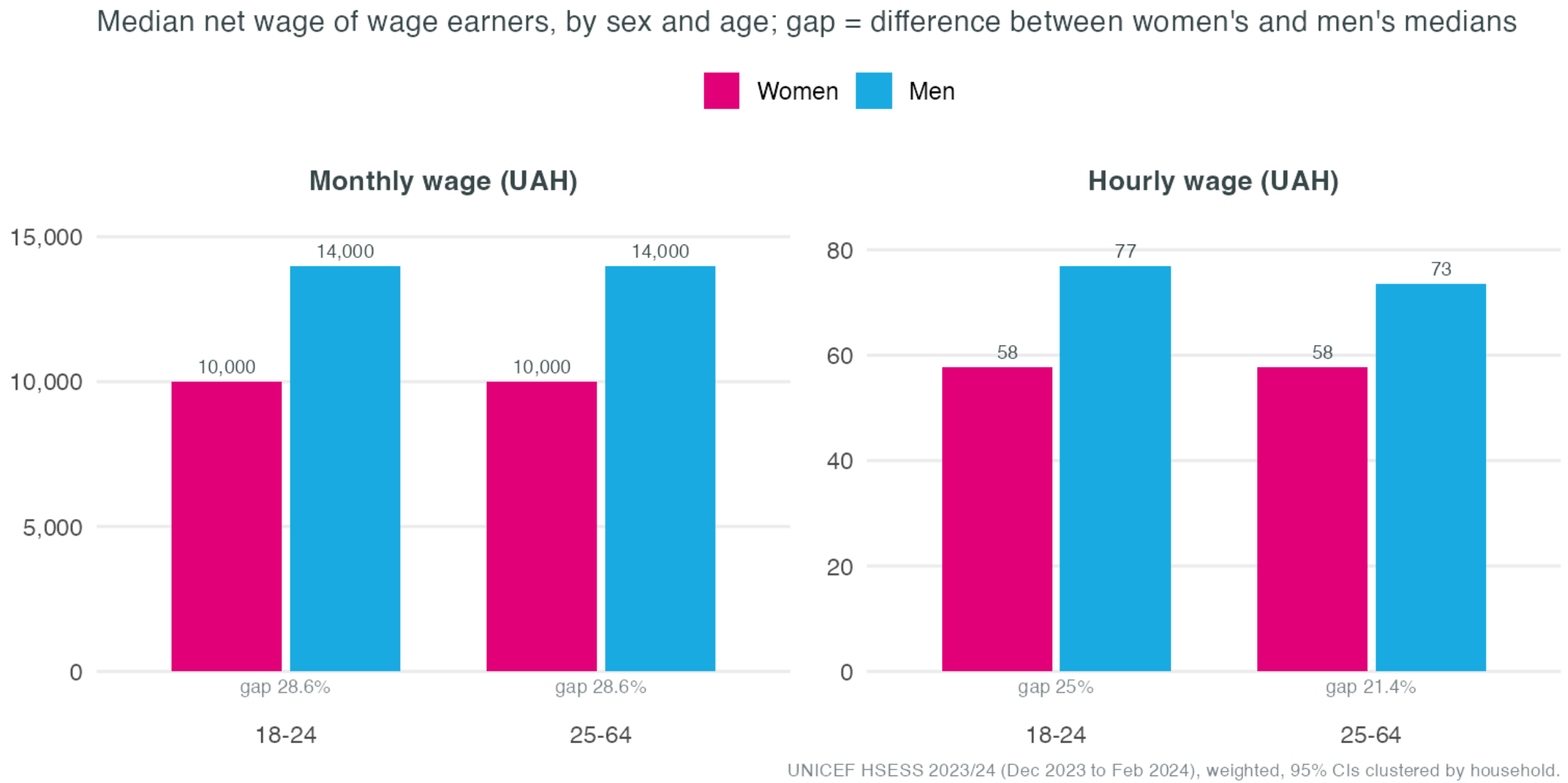

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household. n = 120 women, 35 men.

# Informality, hours and wish for more hours at 18–24 (HSESS)



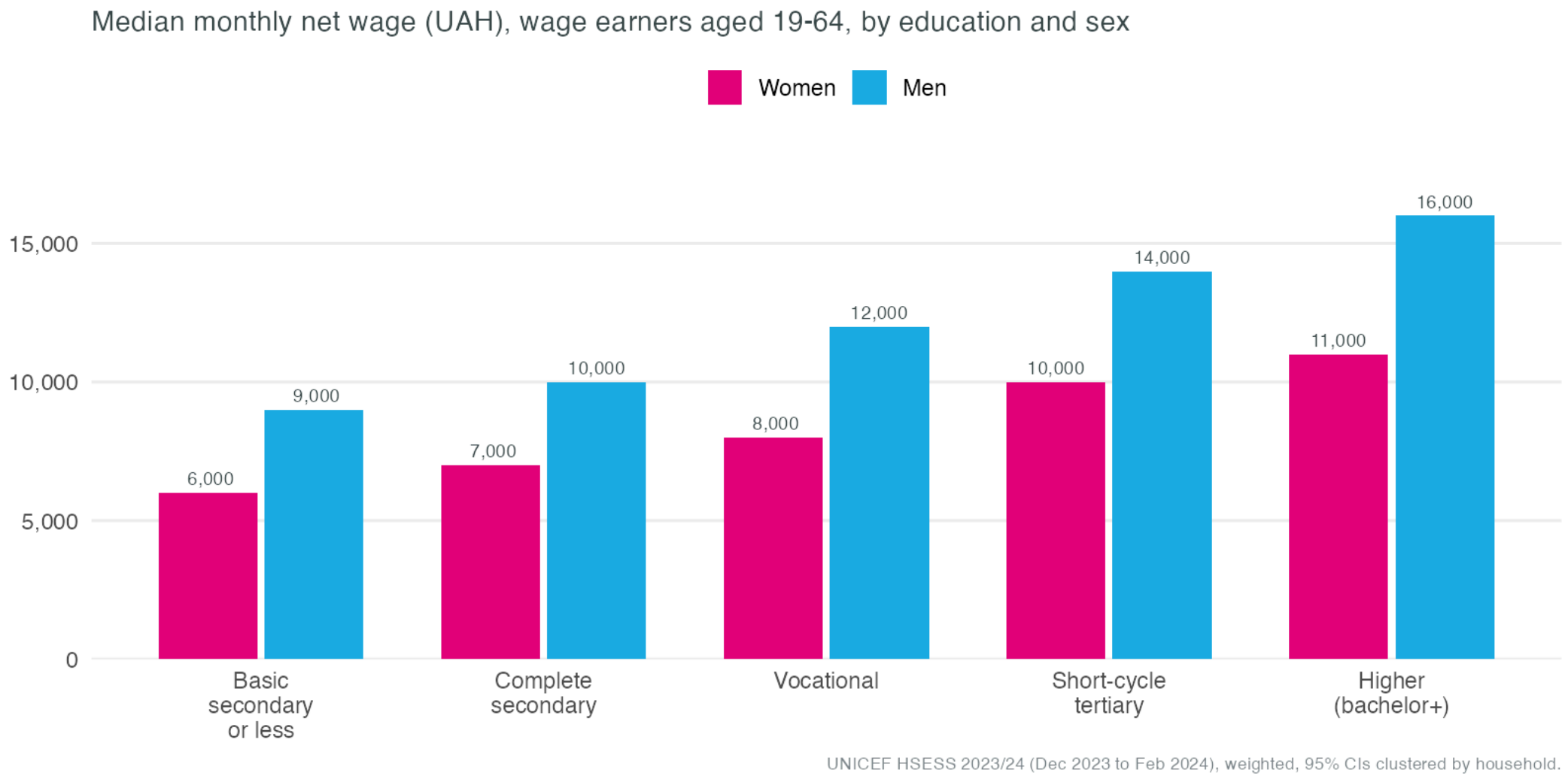

Informal: women 25%, men 36%.

# Monthly and hourly wage gaps (HSESS)



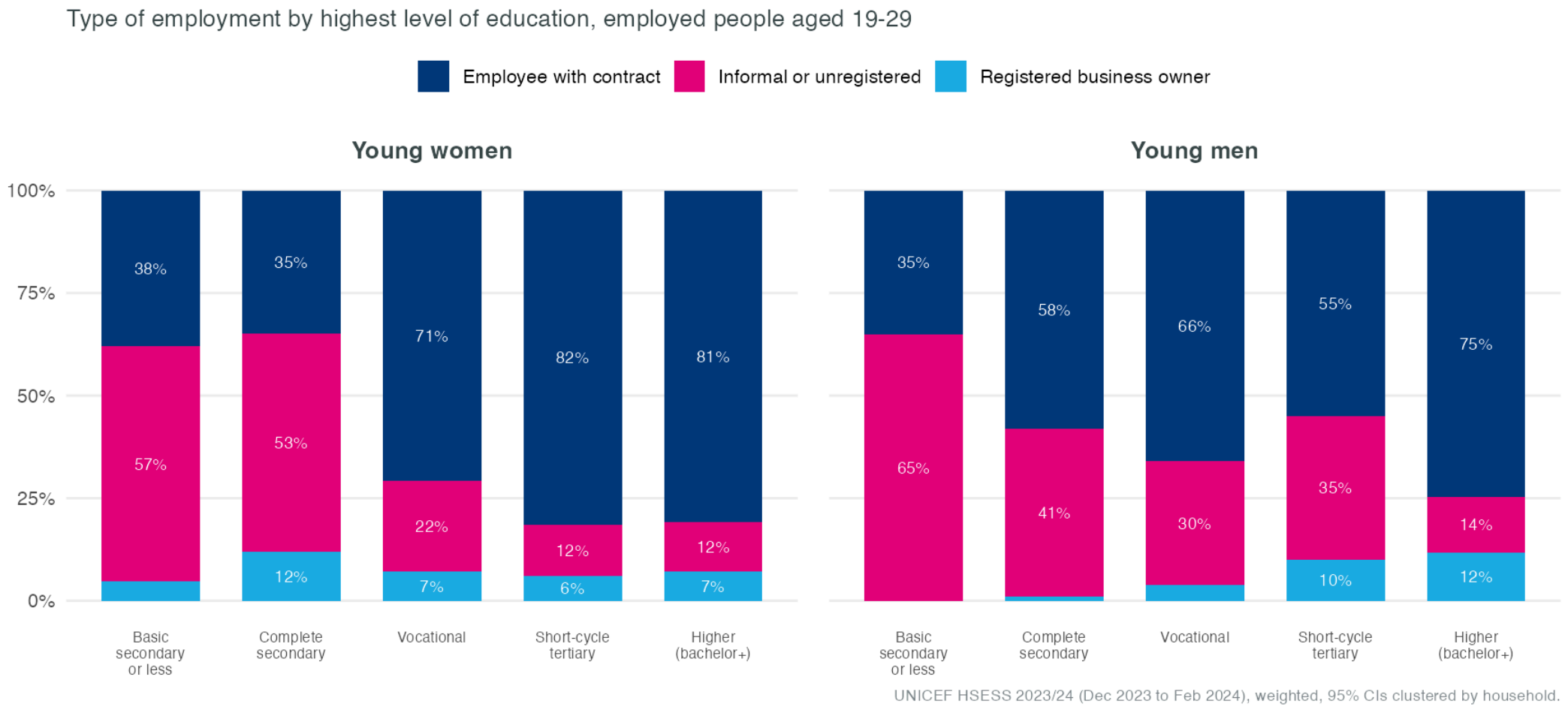

Hourly gap at 18–24: 25%.

# Median wage by education and sex (HSESS)

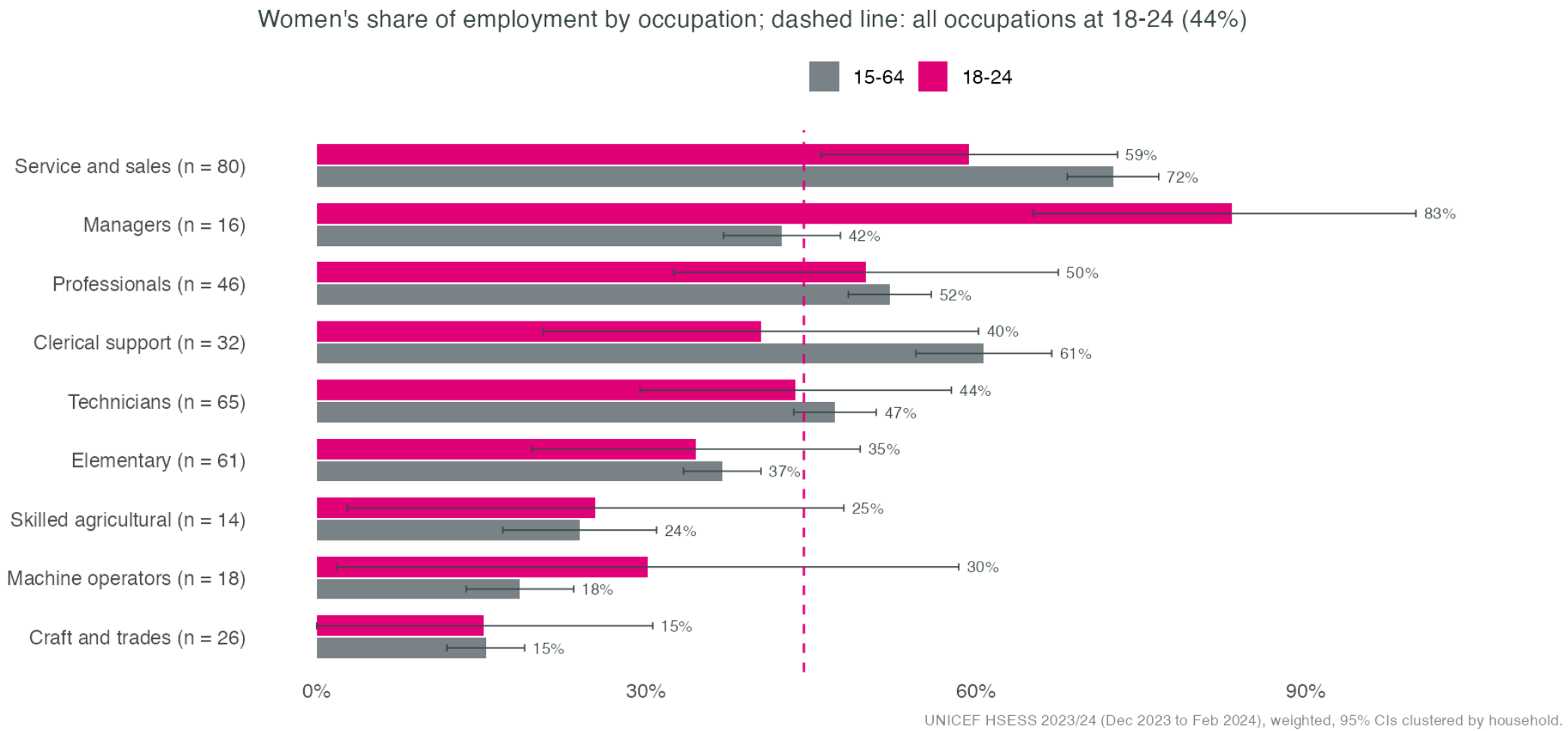



UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# Type of employment by education, employed 18–29 (HSESS)

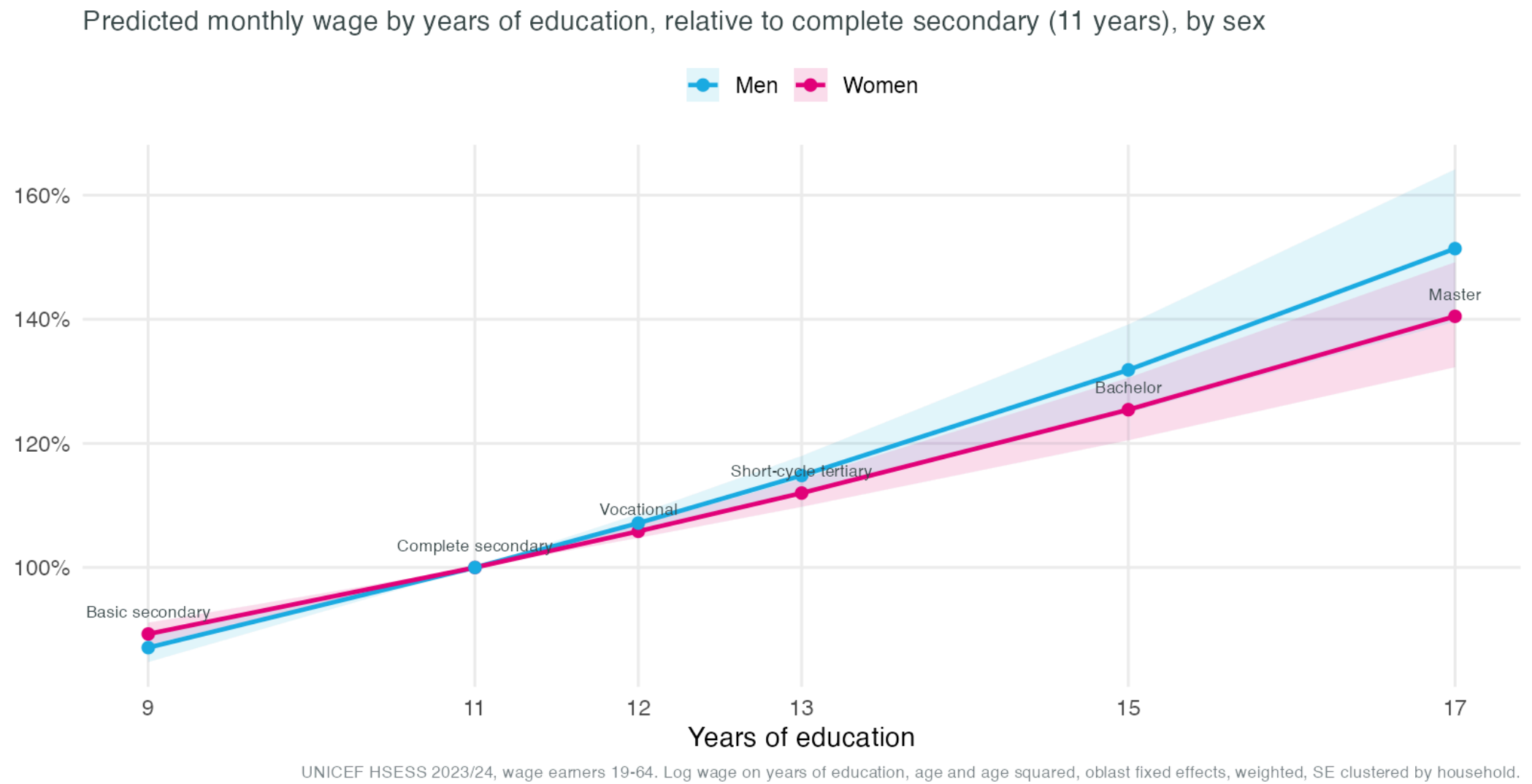


# Women’s share of employment by occupation (HSESS)



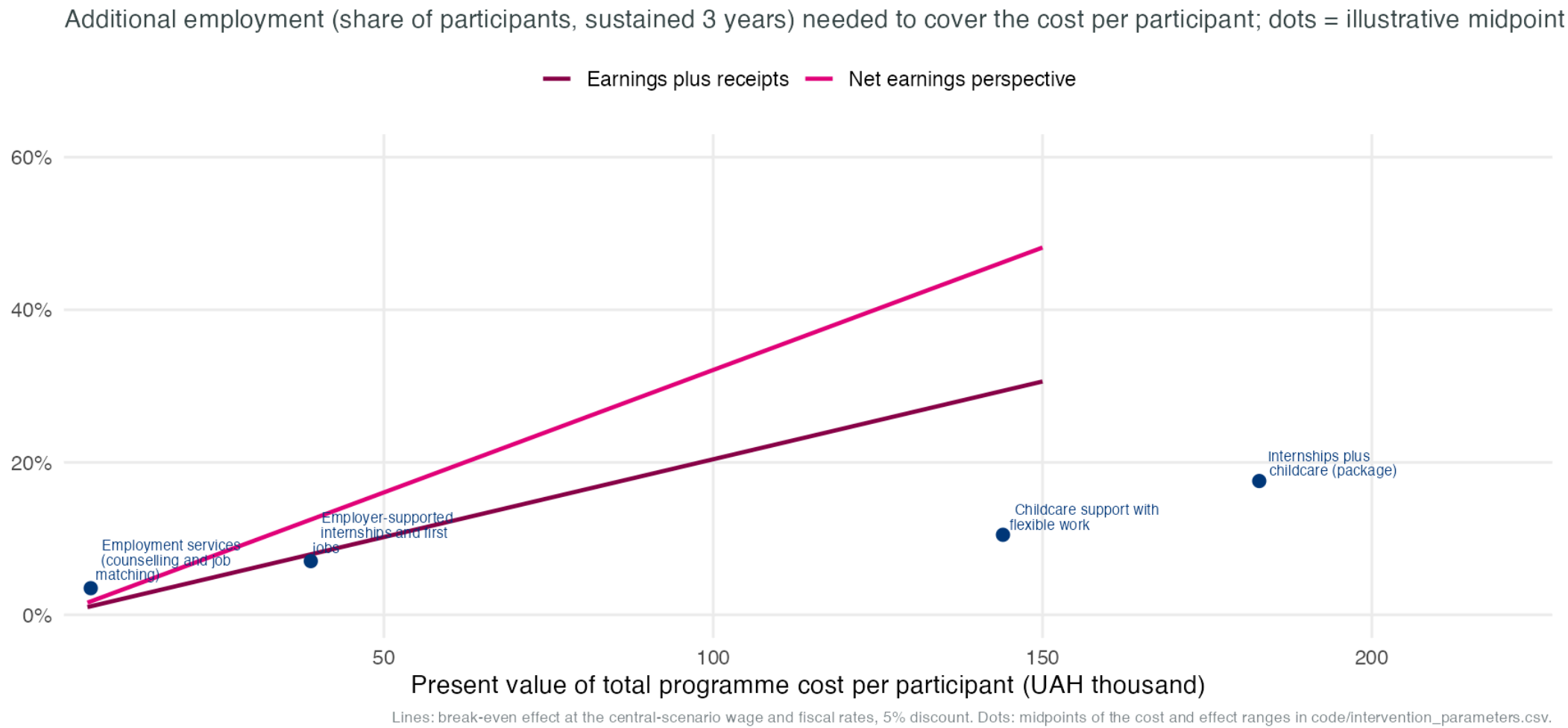

Occupation group as reported by the respondent; groups at 18–24 are small (n shown).

# Wages and years of education (HSESS)




Return per additional year: women 5.8%, men 7.2%.

# Break-even curves by cost per participant (illustrative)

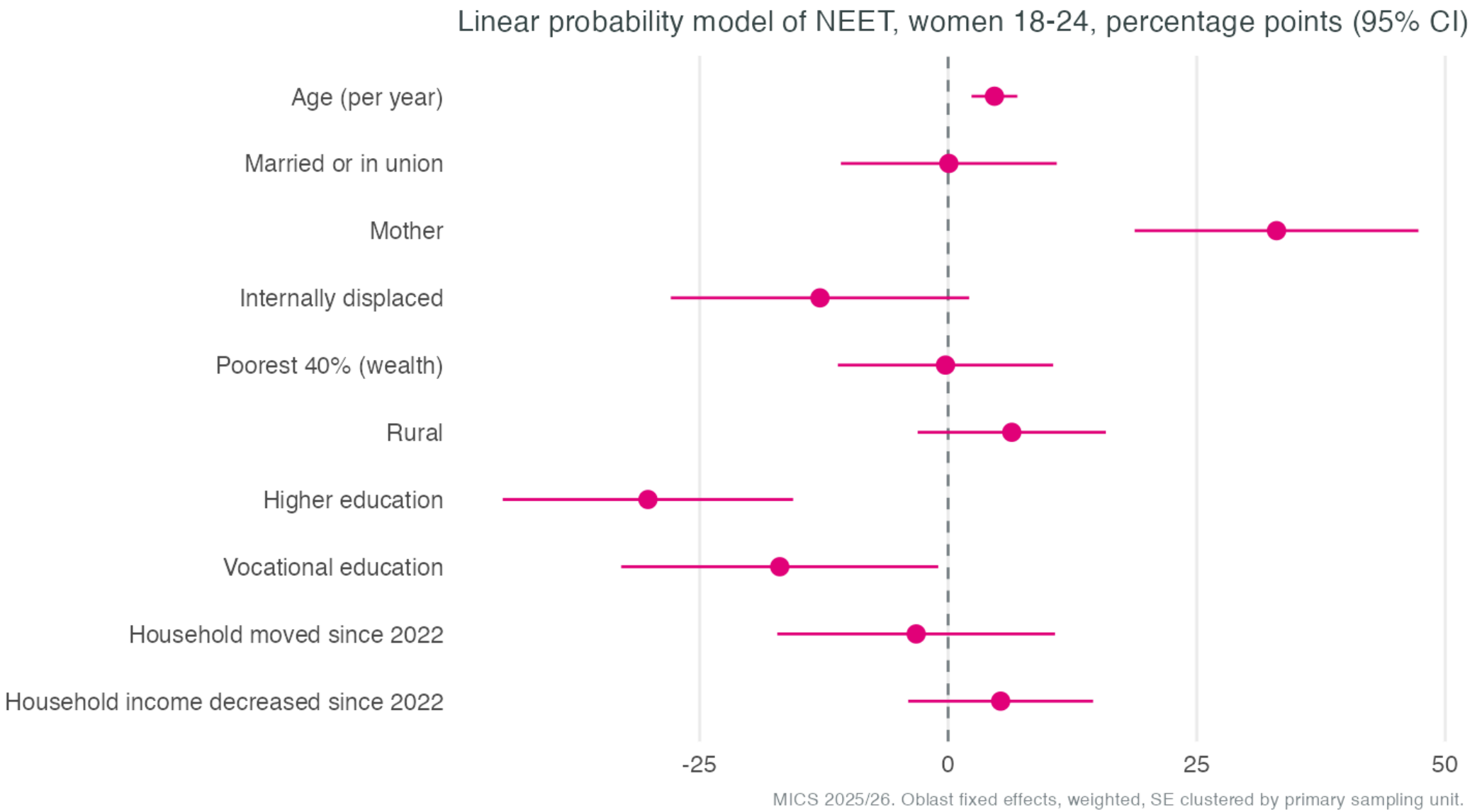


# Break-even applications by intervention, 1, 3 and 5 years

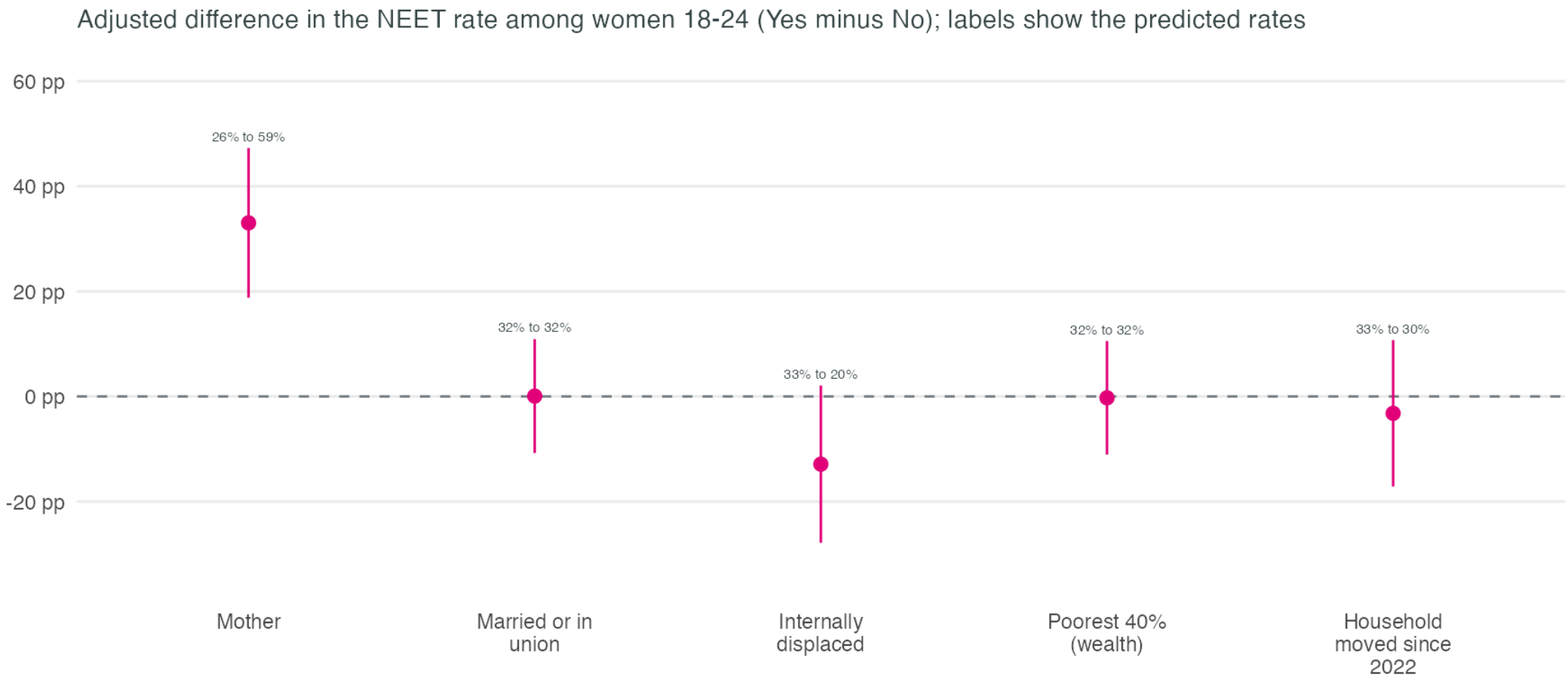
| Intervention | Target group | Years | Cost per participant (UAH) | Needed, net earnings | Needed, plus receipts | Evidence range |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Employment services (counselling and job matching) | All NEET young women | 1 | 3,000 to 8,000 | 3% to 7% | 2% to 5% | 2% to 5% |
| Employment services (counselling and job matching) | All NEET young women | 3 | 3,000 to 8,000 | 1% to 3% | 1% to 2% | 2% to 5% |
| Employment services (counselling and job matching) | All NEET young women | 5 | 3,000 to 8,000 | 1% to 2% | 0% to 1% | 2% to 5% |
| Employer-supported internships and first jobs | All NEET young women | 1 | 25,941 to 51,882 | 24% to 48% | 15% to 30% | 5% to 9% |
| Employer-supported internships and first jobs | All NEET young women | 3 | 25,941 to 51,882 | 8% to 17% | 5% to 11% | 5% to 9% |
| Employer-supported internships and first jobs | All NEET young women | 5 | 25,941 to 51,882 | 5% to 10% | 3% to 7% | 5% to 9% |
| Childcare support with flexible work | NEET young mothers | 1 | 96,000 to 192,000 | 88% to 176% | 56% to 112% | 7% to 14% |
| Childcare support with flexible work | NEET young mothers | 3 | 96,000 to 192,000 | 31% to 62% | 20% to 39% | 7% to 14% |
| Childcare support with flexible work | NEET young mothers | 5 | 96,000 to 192,000 | 19% to 39% | 12% to 25% | 7% to 14% |
| Internships plus childcare (package) | NEET young mothers | 1 | 121,941 to 243,882 | 112% to 224% | 71% to 142% | 12% to 23% |
| Internships plus childcare (package) | NEET young mothers | 3 | 121,941 to 243,882 | 39% to 78% | 25% to 50% | 12% to 23% |
| Internships plus childcare (package) | NEET young mothers | 5 | 121,941 to 243,882 | 25% to 49% | 16% to 31% | 12% to 23% |

“Needed”: share of participants who must gain additional employment, sustained for the number of years shown, for benefits to equal the cost per participant (from the low to the high cost). “Evidence range”: employment effects reported in evaluations in other contexts. Central-scenario wage and fiscal rates, 5% discount.

# Model of NEET, women 18–24 (MICS)

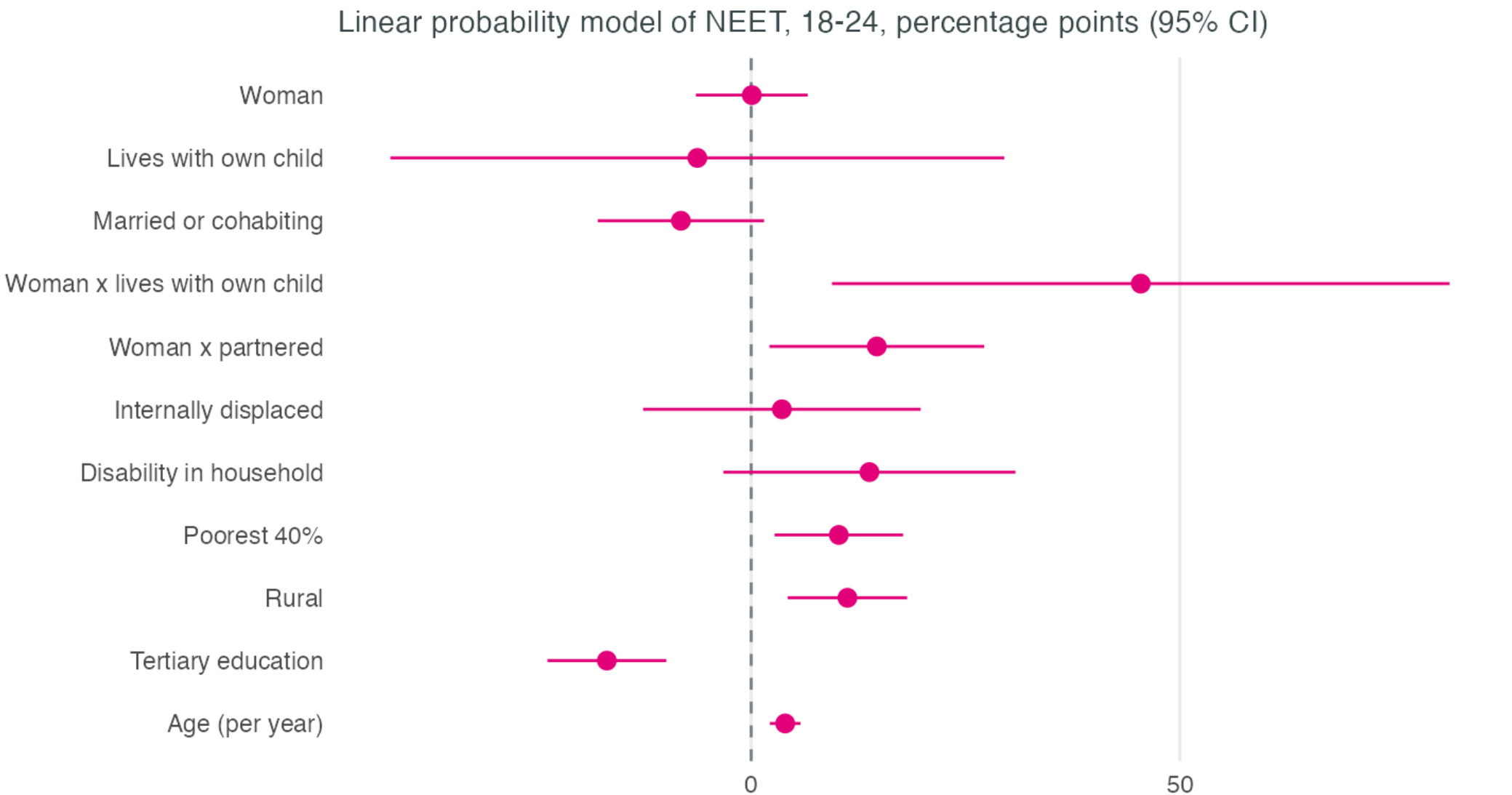


# Adjusted differences in NEET, women 18–24 (MICS)



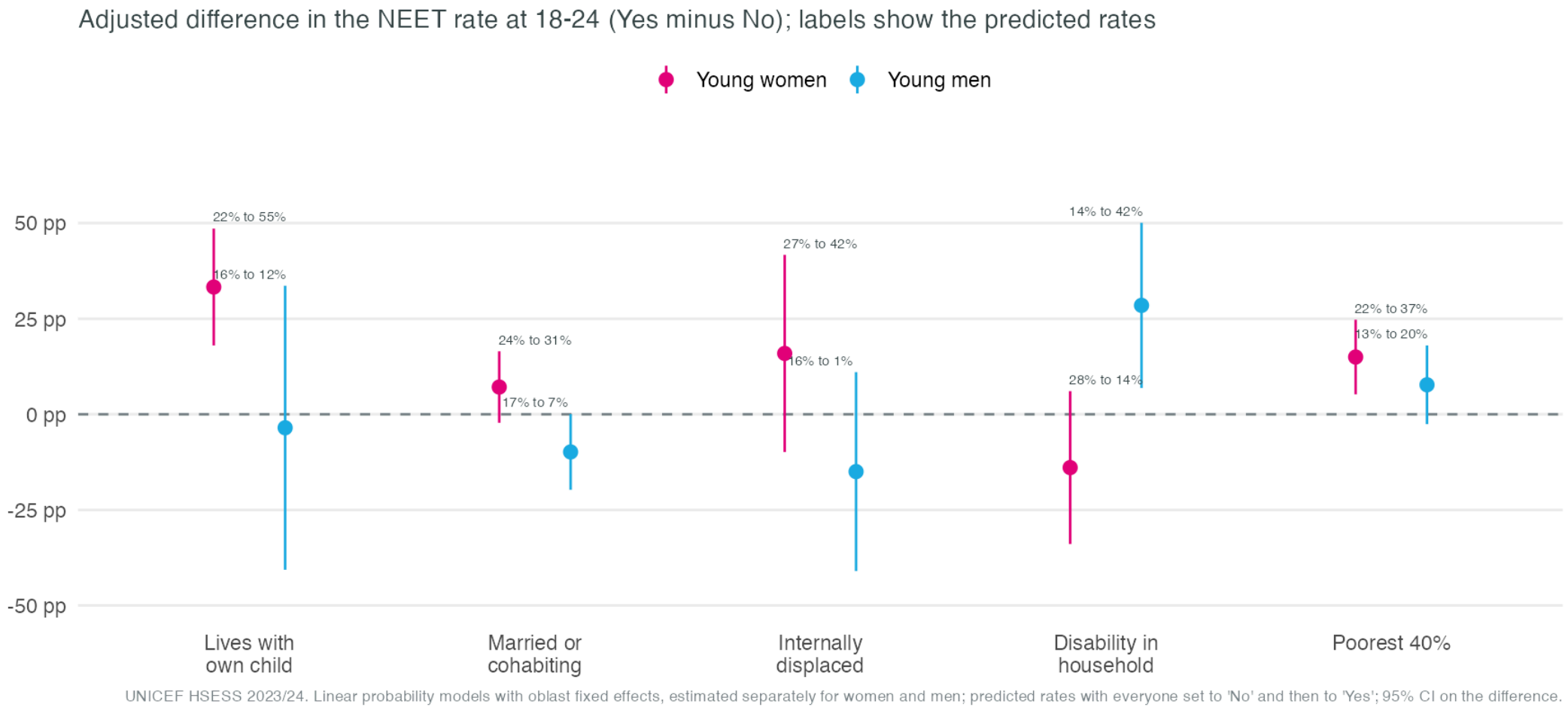

MICS 2025/26. Linear probability model with oblast fixed effects; predicted rates with everyone set to 'No' and then to 'Yes'; 95% CI on the difference.

# Model of NEET, ages 18–24 (HSESS)

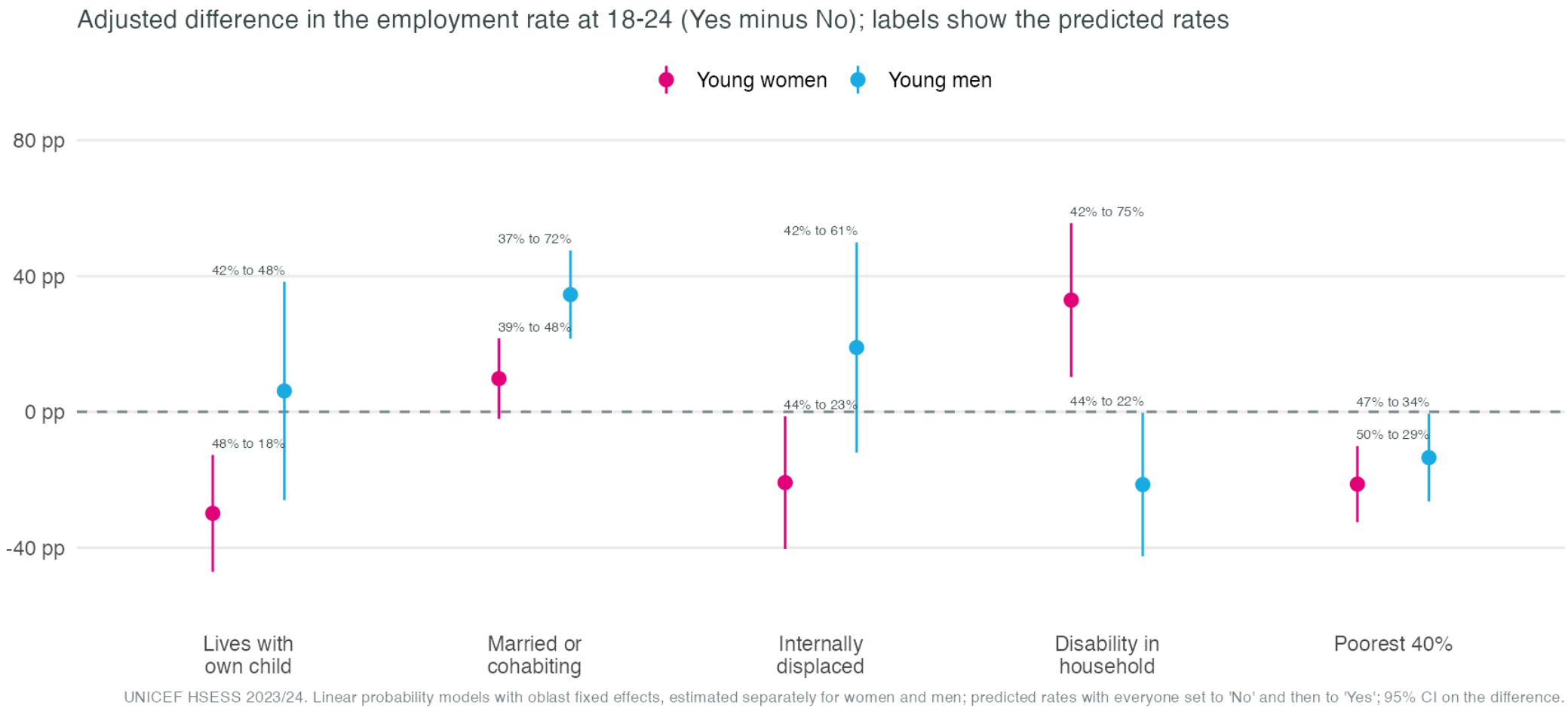



UNICEF HSESS 2023/24. Oblast fixed effects, weighted, SE clustered by household.

# Adjusted differences in NEET, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



# Adjusted differences in employment, ages 18–24 (HSESS)




UNICEF HSESS 2023/24. Linear probability models with oblast fixed effects, estimated separately for women and men; predicted rates with everyone set to 'No' and then to 'Yes'; 95% CI on the difference.

# Estimates, MICS 2025/26

| Estimate | Sample | Effect (pp) | SE | p | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| NEET: married or in union | Women 18-24 | 0.1 | 5.5 | 0.990 | 709 |
| NEET: mother | Women 18-24 | 33.0 | 7.3 | <0.001 | 709 |
| NEET: married x mother | Women 18-24 | 11.2 | 12.9 | 0.390 | 709 |
| NEET: internally displaced | Women 18-24 | -12.9 | 7.6 | 0.092 | 709 |
| NEET: poorest 40% (wealth) | Women 18-24 | -0.3 | 5.5 | 0.960 | 709 |
| NEET: rural | Women 18-24 | 6.4 | 4.8 | 0.180 | 709 |
| NEET: household moved since 2022 | Women 18-24 | -3.2 | 7.1 | 0.650 | 709 |
| NEET: household income decreased since 2022 | Women 18-24 | 5.3 | 4.7 | 0.260 | 709 |
| NEET: functional difficulty | Women 18-24 | 14.1 | 16.3 | 0.390 | 709 |

Effects in percentage points. Women aged 18–24. Controls: age, marital status, motherhood, displacement, poorest 40%, rural, education level, household moved and household income decreased since 2022, oblast fixed effects. Functional difficulty is estimated for women 18–24.

# Estimates, HSESS 2023/24

| Estimate | Sample | Effect (pp) | SE | p | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| NEET: women vs men | 18-24 | 6.3 | 3.0 | 0.033 | 1084 |
| NEET: woman x lives with own child | 18-24 | 55.1 | 17.9 | 0.002 | 1084 |
| NEET: woman x married or cohabiting | 18-24 | 21.3 | 6.7 | 0.002 | 1084 |
| NEET: internally displaced | 18-24 | 5.2 | 8.4 | 0.530 | 1084 |
| NEET: person with disability in household | 18-24 | 13.5 | 9.2 | 0.140 | 1084 |
| NEET: poorest 40% of households | 18-24 | 8.9 | 3.9 | 0.021 | 1084 |
| NEET: woman x poorest 40% | 18-24 | 7.7 | 6.7 | 0.250 | 1084 |
| NEET: rural | 18-24 | 12.9 | 3.6 | <0.001 | 1084 |

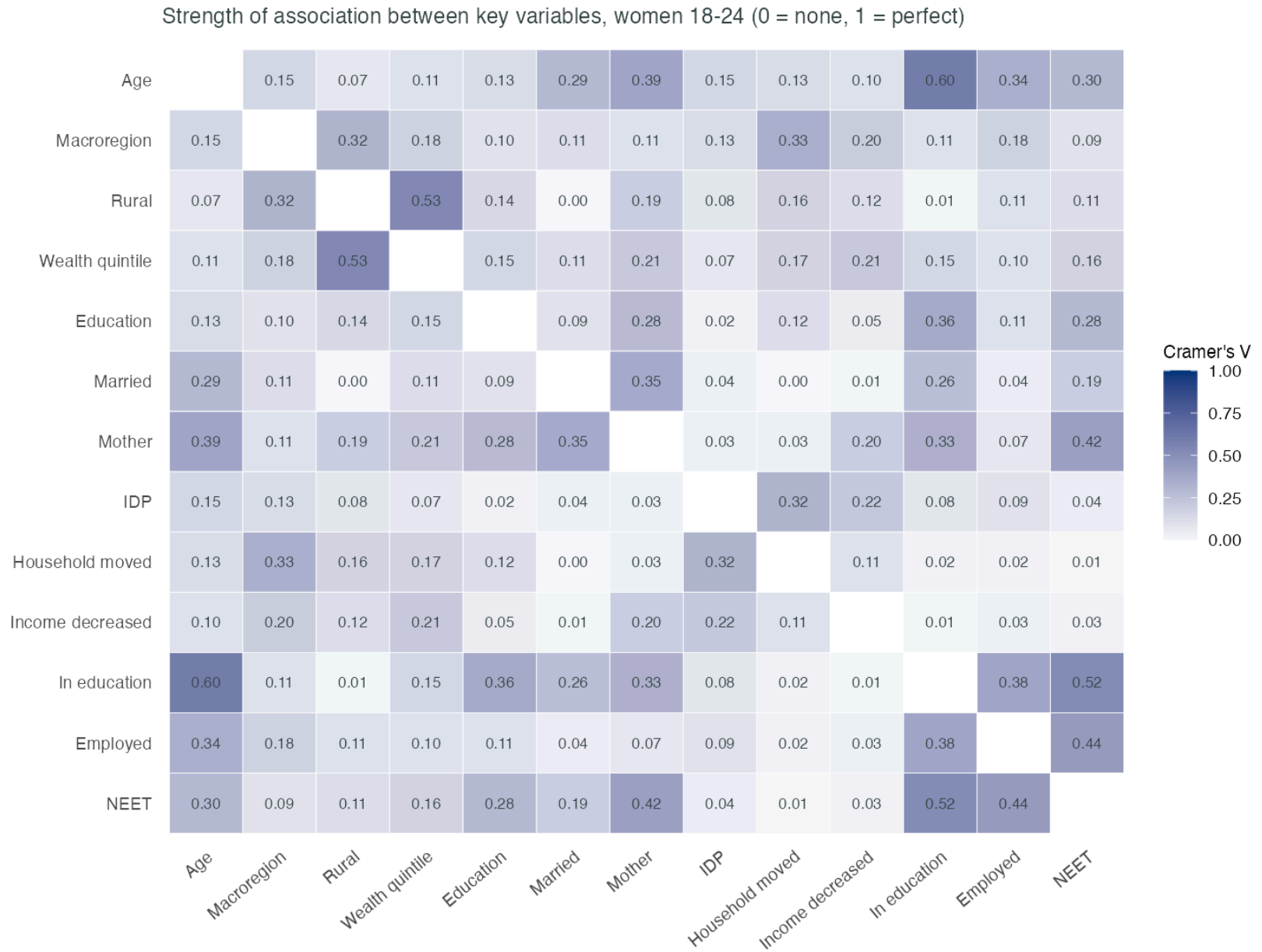
Effects in percentage points. Ages 18–24. Controls: age, rural, displacement, disability in household, poorest 40%, lives with own child, partnership and tertiary education (except where interacted), oblast fixed effects.

# Returns to education, HSESS 2023/24

| Sample | Return per year (%) | 95% low | 95% high | p | N |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Women 19-64 | 5.8 | 4.8 | 6.9 | <0.001 | 3112 |
| Men 19-64 | 7.2 | 5.7 | 8.6 | <0.001 | 2772 |
| Difference women vs men (interaction) | -0.9 | NA | NA | 0.230 | 5884 |

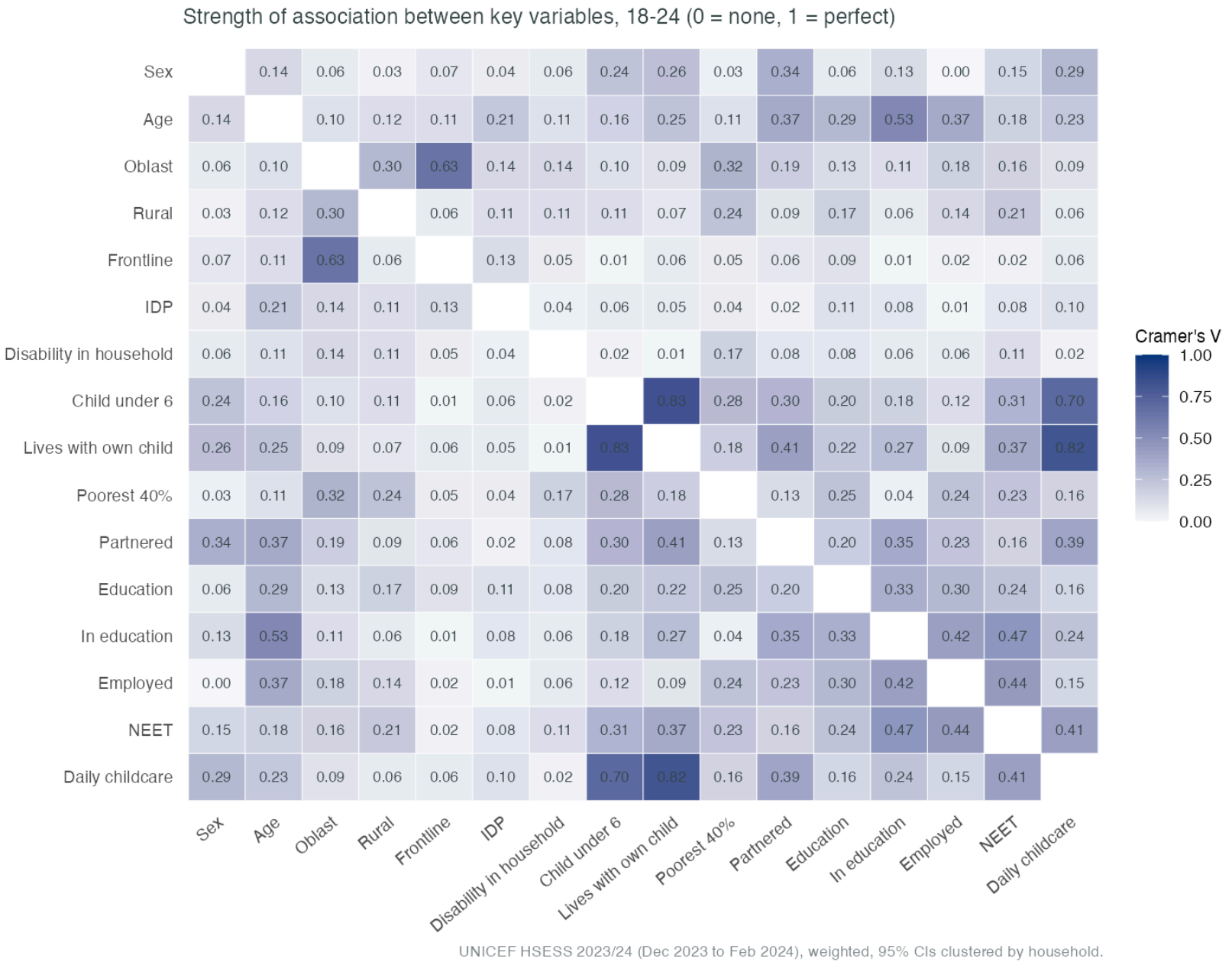
Log monthly net wage on years of education, age and age squared, oblast fixed effects, weighted, standard errors clustered by household. Wage earners aged 19–64.

# Association between key variables, women 18–24 (MICS)



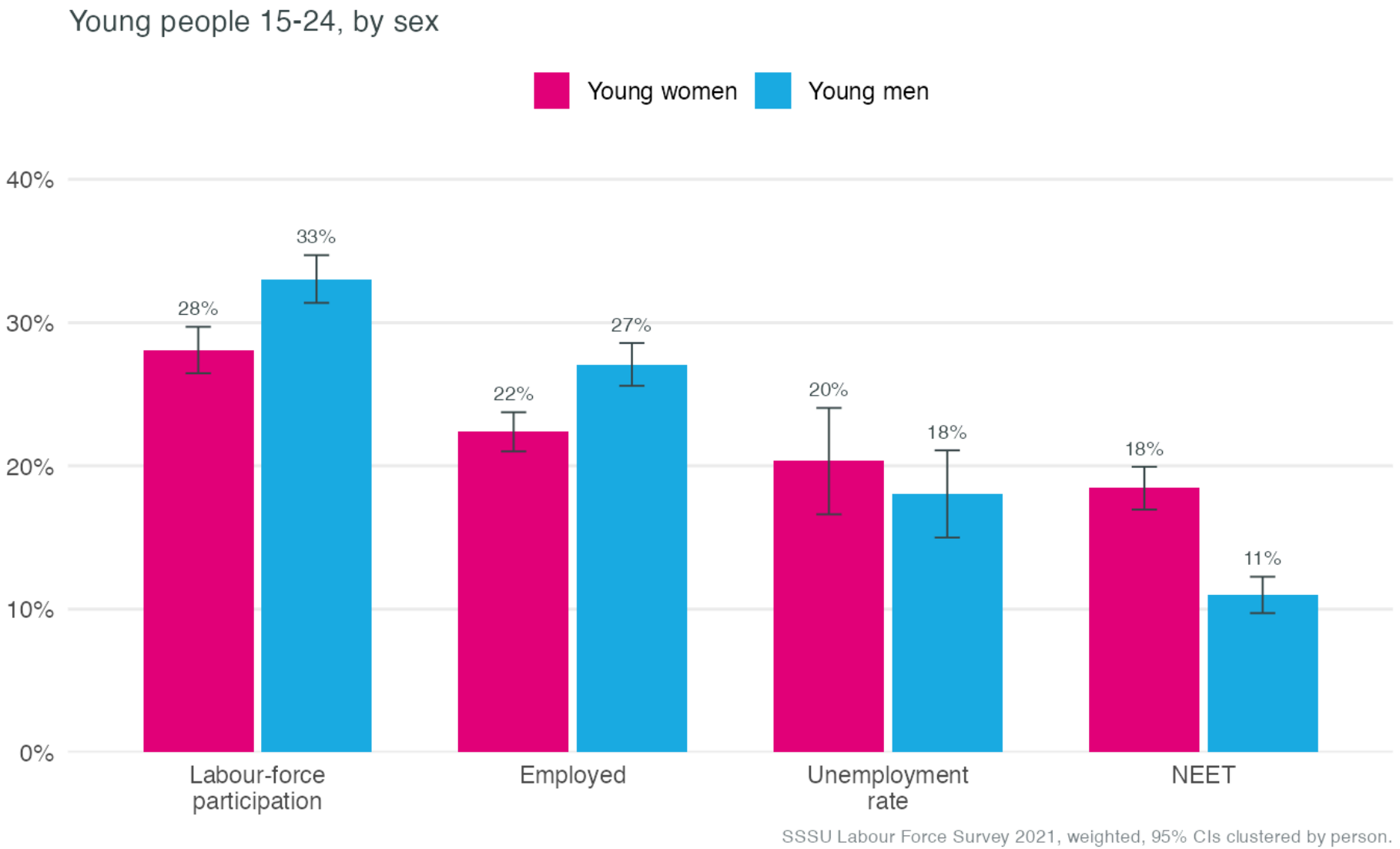

MICS 2025/26 (SSSU and UNICEF), weighted, 95% CIs accounting for the survey design.

# Association between key variables, ages 18–24 (HSESS)



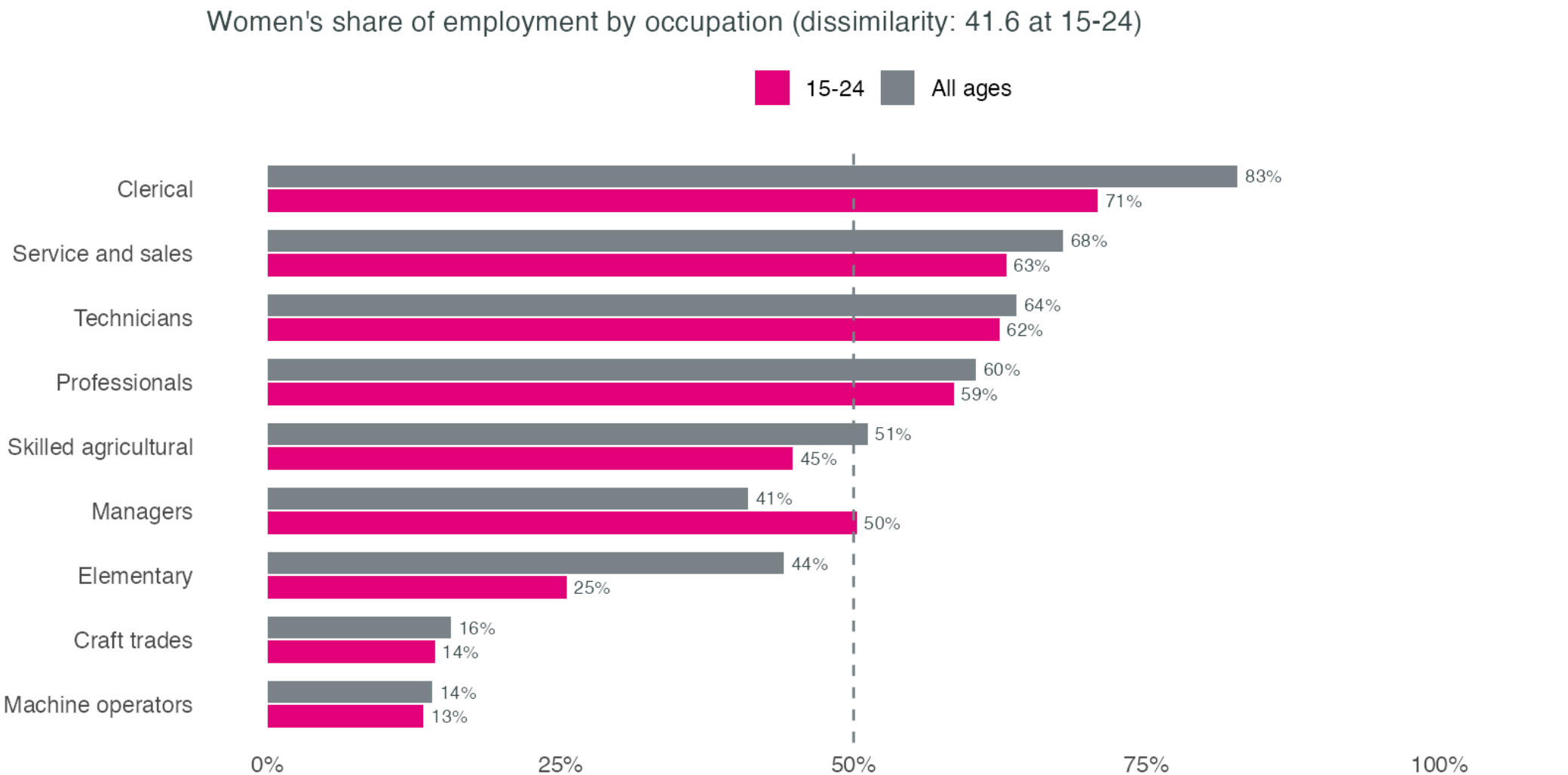

UNICEF HSESS 2023/24 (Dec 2023 to Feb 2024), weighted, 95% CIs clustered by household.

# Reference, Labour Force Survey 2021: outcomes at 15–24 (age released only in bands)




SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021. NEET: women 18%, men 11%. Age is released in bands, so 18–24 cannot be shown.

# Reference, Labour Force Survey 2021: occupations




SSSU Labour Force Survey 2021, weighted, 95% CIs clustered by person.

# HSESS variables used

| Variable | Code | Variable | Code | Variable | Code |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| key (ind) | questionnaire key | econ_status (ind) | IND_B1 | income_amount (ind) | IND_V1_1_1 |
| weight (ind) | final weight | job_type (ind) | IND_B3_1 | n_children (ind) | dity_n |
| oblast (ind) | OBLAST | sector (ind) | IND_B5_2 | hh_size (ind) | hh_size |
| settlement (ind) | SETTL_TYPE | job_title (ind) | IND_B6_1 | key (hh) | questionnaire key |
| relation (ind) | IND_A1 | occupation (ind) | IND_B6_2 | hh_income (hh) | V1 |
| age (ind) | IND_A2 | hours (ind) | IND_B9_1 | disab_adult (hh) | D1_Mult3 |
| sex (ind) | IND_A3 | attitude (ind) | IND_B10_1 | disab_child (hh) | D1_Mult4 |
| marital (ind) | IND_A6 | why_not_working (ind) | IND_B17_1 | idp_hh (hh) | D1_Mult9 |
| educ_level (ind) | IND_A7 | seeking (ind) | IND_B21 | veteran (hh) | D1_Mult10 |
| in_educ (ind) | IND_A9 | reason_inactive (ind) | IND_B24 | lost_home (hh) | G3_5_1 |
| institution (ind) | IND_A10 | care_children (ind) | IND_B28_1 | damaged_home (hh) | G3_5_2 |
| preschool_reason (ind) | IND_A14 | care_disabled (ind) | IND_B28_3 | wealth (hh) | V16 |
| moved (ind) | IND_A15 | care_elderly (ind) | IND_B28_4 | | |
| idp (ind) | IND_A19 | income_source (ind) | IND_V1_1 | | |

Codes as in the questionnaire and the “variables_ukr” sheet of each HSESS file; “ind” = individual file, “hh” = household file.